

**Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian
Affairs (OCHA):
Provision of Information Management and
Analysis Organizational
Review**

Final Report

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The opinions expressed in this report are those of the authors and do not necessarily reflect those of OCHA. Responsibility for the opinions expressed in this report rests solely with the authors.

TABLE OF CONTENTS

Executive Summary.....	v
1 Introduction.....	1
2 Background.....	1
2.1 OCHA's information management and analysis processes.....	1
2.2 Previously identified challenges.....	3
3 Subject of the Review.....	4
4 Review Features.....	6
4.1 Review Scope.....	6
4.2 Review Methodology.....	7
5 Findings.....	8
5.1 Analytical Services.....	9
5.2 Platforms, Products, and Tools.....	15
5.3 Leadership and Coordination.....	21
5.4 Organizational Implications.....	28
6 Conclusions and Recommendations.....	32
6.1 Conclusions.....	32
6.2 Recommendations.....	34
7 Annexes.....	1
Annex 1. Terms of Reference.....	1
Annex 2. Most Common Recommendations from Previous Reviews.....	10
Annex 3. Detailed Methodology.....	11
Annex 4. Review Matrix.....	26
Annex 5. Data Collection Schedule.....	29
Annex 6. Data Collection Tools.....	31
Annex 7. Persons Interviewed.....	43
Annex 8. Quantitative Data.....	44
8.1 OCHA IM Inventory Mapping.....	44
8.2 Quantitative Survey Results.....	55
Annex 9. Findings to Recommendations Linkages.....	57
Annex 10. Bibliography.....	68
Annex 11. Acronyms.....	71

List of Figures

Figure 1: The Information Management Cycle	1
Figure 2: The Analysis Spectrum	2
Figure 3: Timeline of IM and Analysis Relevant Review and Audits	3
Figure 4: The Humanitarian and OCHA IM and Analysis Ecosystems	4
Figure 5: The HPC and Information Management	5
Figure 6: Hierarchy of Priorities and Respondent Focus	9
Figure 7: Keyword Themes – Analytical Services	12
Figure 8: Keyword Themes – Data Platforms and Tools	16
Figure 9: Keyword Themes – Leadership and Coordination	22
Figure 10: Keyword Themes – Organizational Implications	29
Figure 11: Evaluation Methodology and Linkages	17
Figure 12: Overview of OCHA presence (2024)	21

List of Tables

Table 1: Summarized Conceptual Framework	6
Table 2: Linkages Between Systemic Factors and Observed Consequences	8
Table 3: Summary of Analytical Questions by Stakeholder Type	13
Table 4: Navigating Contradictory Pressures and Analytical Offerings	15
Table 5: Partial Inventory of Existing IM Tools, Platforms, Products, and Services	17
Table 6: Most commonly cited platforms and tools	17
Table 7: Navigating Competing Pressures and Tools, Products, Platforms, and Services	20
Table 8: Respondent Citations expected OCHA leadership and OCHA Coordination	23
Table 9: Stakeholder Expectations for OCHA Leadership	24
Table 10: Number and Percentage of Clusters with dedicated IMO Support	26
Table 11: Stakeholder Perceptions of OCHA Organizational Priorities	29
Table 12: Recommendations	1
Table 13: Most Common Themes in Recommendations from Previous Reviews	10
Table 14: Conceptual framework	12
Table 15: Stakeholder Classes and Role in Evaluation	14
Table 16: Interview Events & Types of Stakeholders	17
Table 17: Categorization of country offices	21
Table 18: Countries and Regional Offices Selected	22
Table 19: Limitations and mitigation measures	24
Table 20: Review matrix	26
Table 21: Data Collection Schedule	29
Table 22: Persons Interviewed	43
Table 23: OCHA IM Inventory	47
Table 24: Global Survey - Most Frequent Responses	56
Table 25: List of Findings, Conclusions and Recommendation	57
Table 26: Linkages from Recommendations to Conclusions to Findings	58
Table 27: Detailed Recommendation Actions	61

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Executive Summary

1. The United Nations Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs (OCHA) plays a pivotal role in responding to humanitarian crises through coordination, advocacy, information management (IM), policy, humanitarian financing and resource mobilization. In an increasingly complex operational environment and a fragmented and competitive geopolitical landscape, OCHA recently launched its new Strategic Plan covering the period 2023-2026. The plan addresses six transformational priorities, each with underlying IM and Analysis components.
2. The purpose of this third-party review was to assess the IM and analysis practices, products and systems to ensure that they are fit for purpose to support the implementation of the new Strategic Plan 2023–2026 and are aligned with the United Nations 2020-2022 Data Strategy. The review followed the Terms of Reference provided by OCHA.
3. Findings and recommendations from the review aim to help ensure that the humanitarian community can leverage OCHA's IM and data tools, services and capacities and strengthen OCHA's leadership position among humanitarian actors.
4. **Background:** OCHA's IM process transforms data into information and knowledge and then into action through six steps including planning, data collection, processing analysis, and communication and feedback.¹ The IM² function is foundational to a wide range of branches and services internal and external to OCHA.
5. OCHA plays a critical dual role for IM and analysis for the entire humanitarian community, including other United Nations (UN) agencies and international and national non-governmental organizations (NGOs). OCHA serves a role as both a coordinator of an IM and Analysis sector - supporting Agency, cluster, and NGO IM and Analysis - and as a provider of essential IM and Analysis services. OCHA's dual roles ensure the collection, aggregation, analysis, and data sharing on humanitarian situations, including needs, response, and actors' capacities, ensuring information underpins all OCHA functions and business processes.
6. There has been a long history of reviews, evaluations and audits which have included IM and Analysis components. At least 15 different reviews, forums, audits and evaluations with relevant IM and Analysis recommendations have occurred over the past decade, with earlier efforts stretching back to 2007 (Figure 3).
7. **Subject of review:** The subject of this review is OCHA's IM and analysis practices. The review assesses whether OCHA's current IM and analysis products and services meet the needs of the strategic and operational decision-makers OCHA should support (both OCHA decision-makers and decision-makers in the broader humanitarian community). The geographic scope includes global, regional, and country-level actors and decisions.
8. **Methodology:** The review was conducted using a comprehensive, mixed methods approach to evaluate OCHA's IM and analysis practices relying on desk reviews, semi-structured interviews (individual and group), an online survey, and selected site visits. The four review questions were:
 - i. Analytical Services: What analytical question should OCHA answer at the regional, country and headquarters levels?
 - ii. Platforms, Tools and Data: What common platforms, including data platforms, and data tools should OCHA provide to the humanitarian community? How does this ideal state align with the current state?

¹ <https://humanitarian.atlassian.net/wiki/spaces/imtoolbox/pages/219676845/IM+Process>

² For the purposes of this study, the six phases of the IM process are referred to as "IM and Analysis" per the TOR usage.

- iii. Leadership and Coordination: What is OCHA's role in ensuring a coherent suite of humanitarian data, IM services and products? What are the priority issues in the domain requiring coordination at the country, regional and global levels?
 - iv. Organizational Implications: What, if any, organizational shifts, including capacities and resources, does OCHA need to achieve the necessary common data platforms, answer analytic offering and successfully coordinate IM and Analysis services.
9. In total, 219 persons were interviewed. The collection of stakeholders covered the entire gamut of the humanitarian system including both technical and non-technical roles inside and external to OCHA ranging from global positions to actors associated with five humanitarian responses (country offices) and four regional sites were interviewed. An additional 117 responded to the global survey. A global workshop in Istanbul with 22 people representing different branches and levels of OCHA was held to review and reflect on the patterns and emergent themes from data collection activities.

Findings:

Review question summaries

10. **Analytical Services**: There is a broad consensus globally and within the humanitarian responses that OCHA's responsibility should be to facilitate inter-sectoral analysis using data from individual clusters, and integrating data from other agencies and organizations, as agreed upon globally and within humanitarian operations.
11. There is no agreement on the role that OCHA should play within the clusters in terms of data collection, methodologies, or information management of cluster-specific data, resulting in contradictory statements such as "OCHA should ensure data standards" and "OCHA should not dictate to clusters".
12. Respondents regularly expect OCHA to provide increasingly complex types of analysis, while OCHA staff are also expected to devote significant time and effort to provide basic descriptive data analysis.
13. The emergence of specialist NGOs for IM and Analysis are considered pivotal for providing quality IM and Analysis services within humanitarian responses. However, there is no current mapping of what sort of coverage there is of these NGOs in humanitarian responses and limited OCHA staff capacities to provide strategic attention to these NGOs and their inclusion in country operations. As a consequence, these NGOs were both seen as crucial for, and marginalized from, IM and Analysis functions in country operations.
14. **Platforms, Tools and Data**: Respondents focus on the features of tools, platforms, and services more than the types of data within these platforms; with an emphasis on user-centred, adaptable, and good data quality. Respondents appreciated available platforms and tools with seven being the most frequently cited. The emerging technology governance board is seen as a positive initiative to streamline the current portfolio.
15. Stakeholders do experience a plethora of platforms, tools, and data, resulting in data fatigue and the inability to analyse or digest the magnitude of data that is produced. OCHA uses a combination of external public-facing platforms and internal solutions. Internal and external platforms and tools create demands on country offices and humanitarian operations to provide data, as well as difficulties in determining where to get data. Interoperability and automation, in which data can be easily exchanged between platforms and tools, were widely positioned as a mitigating technique to counter proliferation and fragmentation. The absence of a data strategy and a single universal inventory hampers the rationalization of existing tools, products, and services.
16. **Leadership and Coordination**: Stakeholders distinguished between the respective roles of leadership and of coordination within IM and Analysis. Stakeholders broadly expected OCHA leadership roles in areas of data analytics, and OCHA coordination roles in areas related to analysis

and decision-making. OCHA was expected to take leadership (provide active products and standards) on issues related to data quantity and data quality, and to coordinate (convene actors to ensure functions are carried out by the actors themselves) for analysis and decision-making. There is a significant expectation from external stakeholders that OCHA should also fill gaps caused by Agency gaps in staffing IM capacity for their clusters.

17. Priority issues included setting the overarching strategic vision for IM and Analysis in the humanitarian community; highlighting funding gaps and unmet needs; facilitating data sharing and data standardization; facilitating IM surge capacity for sudden onset emergencies; and coordinating the inclusion of specialist NGOs in the collection, analysis, and dissemination of quality products.
18. In the absence of a humanitarian IM and Analysis strategy, competing and diverse stakeholder expectations impede the rationalization of OCHA's expected leadership and coordination roles leading to stakeholder perceptions of OCHA as reactive rather than proactive in IM and Analysis. Consequently, individual humanitarian responses are dependent on specific leadership and agency conditions; leading to substantive variations in the structure and function of IM and analysis among responses. The decentralized management structure of IM and Analysis also leads to the proliferation of disconnected working groups, delayed updates to global guidance, and limitations to the successful inclusion of complementary actors, such as specialist NGOs.
19. **Organizational Implications:** The IM and Analysis function within OCHA has become increasingly dispersed across the organization with IM and analysis functions integrated into multiple discrete branches and divisions. Externally, there has also been an increase in IM and analysis capacities of Agencies, and the rise of specialist NGOs engaged in data collection and analysis. This dispersion of IM and Analysis functions within the organization has led to ambiguities and overlap among the global, regional, and country IM and Analysis roles. Externally, the evolution of external capacities of UN agencies and NGOs and the advancements in technologies and techniques has created increasing and more sophisticated demands on OCHA staff capacities.
20. Respondents perceived the ideal OCHA organizational structure for supporting IM and Analysis would involve i) distinguishing and clarifying the respective roles and responsibilities of IM and Analysis at global, regional and country levels as an internal enabler; ii) supporting increasingly specialized functions (analysis, surge capacity, data quality assurance, etc.); while iii) promoting an organizational culture emphasizing both innovation and standards.
21. The decentralized IM and Analysis structure and the resourcing allocation processes impede the rationalization of strategic planning processes for IM and Analysis and create perverse incentives that impede collective action.

Factors affecting patterns

22. **Challenges to IM and Analysis coherence are persistent across time within OCHA.** There have been at least 19 reviews, evaluations and audits with components related to IM and Analysis with 15 of these coming in the past decade. The recommendations across these previous reviews fall into six thematic categories.

1. Leadership and governance
2. Data quality and standardization
3. Data platforms and technology adaptations
4. Capacity building and training systems
5. Improved stakeholder engagement and communication
6. Ethics, privacy and accountability considerations

23. The consistency of the recommendations across time suggests systemic bottlenecks (described below). **Fragmentation and proliferation of the IM and Analysis function are the natural results of the OCHA IM and Analysis structure and resourcing mechanisms.** Fragmentation is driven by three systemic factors:

24. Resourcing frameworks and perverse incentives. The combination of fixed envelopes and special project financing simultaneously dampens the incentives of branches within OCHA to seek strategic funding (as it will not increase their envelope) while increasing the incentives for individuals to seek special project funding (and later compete with other units to get “their” special project moved to programme support costs, PSC). The dynamic fosters an environment of internal competition, limiting incentives for strategic collaboration and fragmenting the IM and Analysis structure inside OCHA.
25. IM and Analysis functions as an enabling feature in OCHA. The IM and Analysis function is foundational to a wide range of branches and services internal and external to OCHA. Combined with the fragmenting resourcing pressures, the enabling nature of the IM function leads to a situation of a highly dispersed IM and Analysis function integrated into multiple branches, units, and entities – with no single “leader” of IM and Analysis. Consequently, while the distribution of IM and Analysis functions has allowed retaining a crucial link between IM and Analysis and the pillars supported (such as Coordination or Financing) it has created challenges in developing a unified and coherent IM and Analysis approach. Furthermore, IM and Analysis as a function is interwoven into the other pillars of the OCHA Strategic Plan, making it less visible within the overarching Strategic Plan.
26. Absence of an IM and Analysis Strategy and formalized frameworks. Concurrently, the absence of an IM strategy and formalized analytical or data frameworks leads to a lack of strategic clarity, both within OCHA and among external stakeholders, required to develop a shared understanding of roles and responsibilities within IM and Analysis. This impedes OCHA’s capacity to coordinate and provide vision for a coherent IM and Analysis “ecosystem” both internally within OCHA and externally across the humanitarian system. This has led to a proliferation of expectations among stakeholders regarding the IM function and to “self-defined functions” where individual IM units or entities independently determine the scope of their mandates. As a result, stakeholders may hold differing expectations of the respective roles and responsibilities of the multiple units within IM and Analysis. The dispersed nature of the OCHA IM and Analysis functions also impeded the strategic and timely engagement with complementary actors such as the specialist NGOs.
27. The cascade effect of these factors lead to a fragmented and under-funded IM and Analysis architecture with limited frameworks for establishing a clear and shared understanding regarding the roles of IM and Analysis, reporting lines, core analytical questions to be answered and core platforms required. Fragmentation also shapes the process for how tools and platforms are created, used and managed. The combination of these factors leads to the creation of “perverse incentives” resulting in the fragmentation of the IM and Analysis function and the proliferation of tools, platforms, and products, which in turn leads to a high degree of variability across responses.

Summary Between Systemic Factors and Observed Consequences

Systemic Factors	Leading to....	Resulting in....
Resourcing Mechanisms	Proliferation of individual IM and Analysis units under multiple divisions, branches, and sectors.	Fragmentation of the IM and Analysis function both internal and external to OCHA
IM and Analysis as an enabling function	Decentralized platform and tool development processes within OCHA	Scope-creep and self-developed expectations on OCHA IM and Analysis function by stakeholders
Absence of an overarching IM and Analysis strategy (internal and external)	No shared analytical, data, or coordination frameworks recognized by all stakeholders	Sensitive dependence on specific leadership or agency conditions
Diverse data needs from humanitarian actors	Perverse incentives impeding collective strategic action	Data fatigue and information overload with certain analytical offering over-absorbing limited resources
Evolving technological advances		

		Proliferation of working groups disconnected from each other Delays in updating global guidance and standards Limitations on strategic and timely engagement with complementary actors Significant variability from country to country in terms of IM and Analysis functioning
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28. The consequences of the aforementioned systemic factors result in the structure of IM functions at global, regional and country levels being dependent on the interests of leadership in IM and Analysis, affecting priorities, staffing, and IM and Analysis influence on decision making. Specifically, the quality of IM and Analysis within any specific humanitarian response is dependent on the leadership priorities at the Humanitarian Coordinator (HC)/Resident Coordinator (RC), Head of Office (HOO), and Inter-cluster Coordination Group (ICCG) levels as well as the agencies' support for their clusters. This results in extensive variation among country offices and humanitarian responses regarding IM capacity, coordination, analytical products, and utilization.
29. **There are frequent examples of ongoing individual initiatives to improve IM and Analysis functioning.** Three general patterns are associated with the positive citations that emerged in the review:
1. Champions: Challenges are perceived to be rooted in systemic issues while successes rely on individual initiatives.
 2. Progress is evolutionary, but not linear. There was consensus that processes and products have evolved over time, but acknowledgement that progress was often inconsistent across time and space.
 3. Competing pressures between global and local needs. The review highlights the tension between global data aggregation and standardization needs and country-level needs for contextualized tools for each response.
30. Respondents expressed a desire for OCHA to be more proactive in coordination. However, the absence of an IM and Analysis strategy leads to stakeholders holding contradictory perspectives regarding OCHA's role in providing leadership and coordination within inter-agency spaces and the expectation that OCHA should fill gaps when agencies do not cover them. An example of this tension pertains to OCHA's degree of responsibility to provide IM capacity to specific clusters when the lead agency of that cluster were not able or refused to provide an IMO for the cluster. Stakeholders also expected OCHA to fill gaps related to emergent issues falling outside specific Agency mandates. Finally, expectations extended to OCHA adopting technology changes and rising expectations on IM and Analysis for more sophisticated levels of analysis (predictive and inferential analysis on multi-sectoral datasets). At the same time, respondents are calling for simpler forms of analysis to combat information overload and data fatigue. These factors have led to mismatches between external expectations and IMO capacities and resources; clarity regarding the respective roles and expectations among OCHA, clusters and agencies is needed.

31. **Recommendations:** The following table provides a summary of the eight recommendations emerging from this review. A detailed action plan and priority rating for each recommendation is found in Annex 10.

#	Recommendation	Ratings Summary
1	Recommendation 1: Establish an OCHA cross-branch governance mechanism for Information Management and Analysis (IM&A) under the authority of OCHA senior leadership at the ASG level. This governance mechanism would ensure strategic oversight, coherence, and accountability for IM&A activities across all levels of OCHA, aligning with the OCHA Strategic Plan and the UN Secretary General Data Strategy.	• Theme: Governance • High priority • Internal • Immediate • Lead: ASG Office • Support: IMB, APMB
2	Recommendation 2: Develop an Organizational IM&A Strategy to guide OCHA's IM functions, aligned with the OCHA Strategic Plan and addressing both internal and external requirements. This strategy should ensure coherence, efficiency, and alignment of IM&A activities across all levels of the organization	• Theme: Strategy • High • Internal • Immediate • Lead: ASG Office • Support: IMB, APMB
3	Recommendation 3: Develop a multi-year IM&A Road Map as a practical implementation tool of the IM&A Strategy, outlining priority initiatives, their sequencing, and the required resources across OCHA at global, regional, and country levels. The road map should serve as a practical implementation tool to address systemic challenges and strengthen OCHA's IM function.	• Theme: Action Plan • High • Internal • Immediate • Lead: ASG Office • Support: IMB, APMB
4	Recommendation 4: Protocols for reducing Fragmentation. Continue to further streamline OCHA's data platforms, tools, products and services to reduce fragmentation, enhance efficiency and ensure sustainability	• Theme: Efficiency • High • Internal • Immediate • Lead: IMB
5	Recommendation 5: Develop a Unified OCHA IM&A Resourcing Strategy to mitigate resource fragmentation and ensure sustainable, strategic financing for IM functions. This strategy should align PSC and special project initiatives, promoting coherence and addressing systemic gaps	• Theme: Resourcing • Moderate • Internal • Medium term • Lead: ASG Office • Support: IMB, APMB

6	Recommendation 6: Strengthen inter-agency coordination processes, structures, and agreements for IM&A to ensure coordinated, efficient, and complementary action among stakeholders.	• Coordination • Moderate • External • Medium Term • Lead: IMB
7	Recommendation 7: Develop an IM&A Strategy for the Humanitarian Community's IM&A Ecosystem to ensure coordinated, efficient, and complementary action among stakeholders. The strategy should identify and address gaps, establish shared priorities and promote effective collaboration.	• Strategy • Moderate • External • Long Term • Lead: IMB
8	Recommendation 8: Engage Multi-Disciplinary Analysis Teams at country and regional levels to strengthen humanitarian response by combining operational insights from multiple actors within and external to OCHA including specialist NGOs and UN agencies. These teams will ensure contextually relevant and methodologically sound analyses that align with OCHA's analytical framework.	• Analysis • Moderate • External • Medium Term • Leads: IMB/APMB

1 Introduction

1. The United Nations Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs (OCHA) plays a pivotal role in responding to humanitarian crises through coordination, advocacy, information management (IM), policy, humanitarian financing and resource mobilization.
1. In an increasingly complex operational environment and a fragmented and competitive geopolitical landscape, OCHA recently launched its new Strategic Plan covering the period 2023-2026. The plan addresses six transformational priorities, each with underlying IM and Analysis components.
2. The purpose of this third-party review was to assess the IM and analysis practices, products and systems to ensure that they are fit for purpose to support the implementation of the new Strategic Plan 2023–2026 and are aligned with the United Nations 2020-2022 Data Strategy. The review followed the Terms of Reference provided by OCHA (Annex 1).
3. Findings and recommendations from the review aim to help ensure that the humanitarian community can leverage OCHA's IM and data tools, services and capacities and strengthen OCHA's leadership position among humanitarian actors.

2 Background

2.1 OCHA's information management and analysis processes

4. OCHA's IM process transforms data into information and knowledge and then into action through six steps from planning, data collection, processing, and analysis, through communication and feedback (Figure 1).

Figure 1: The Information Management Cycle

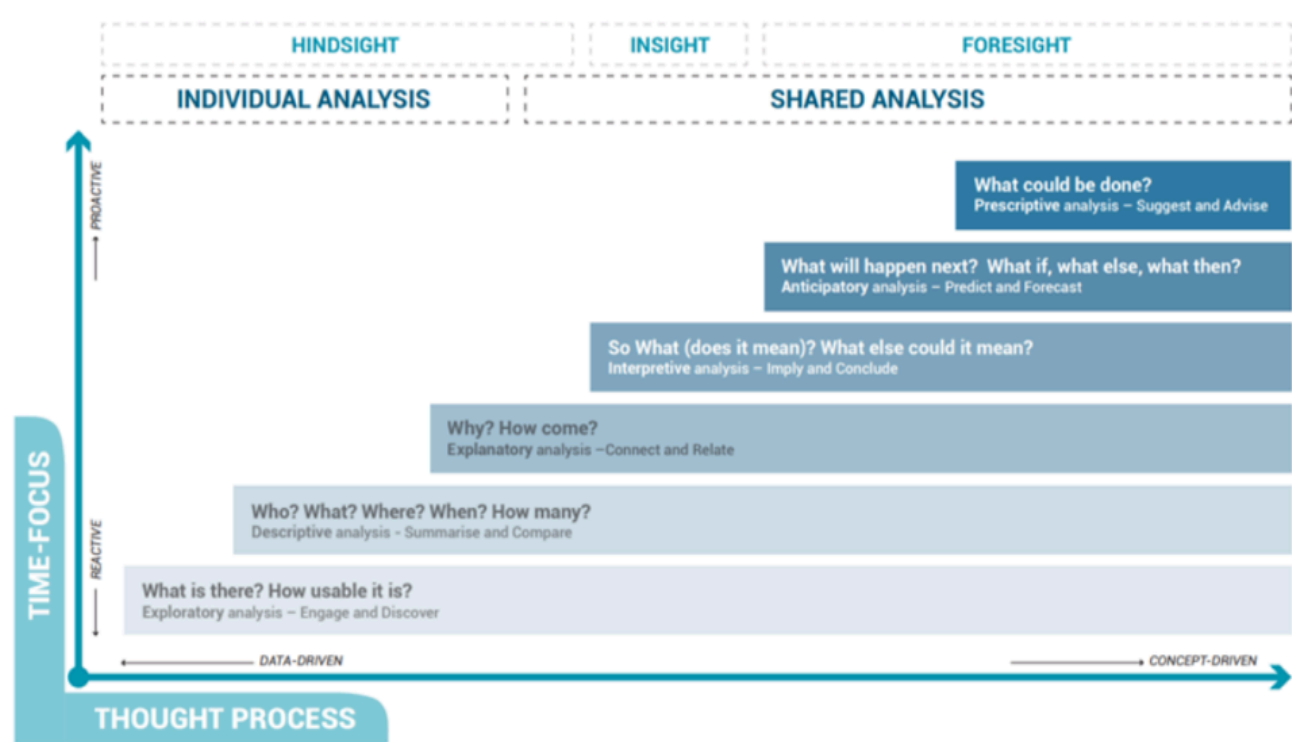


Source: OCHA IM Toolbox. <https://humanitarian.atlassian.net/wiki/spaces/imtoolbox/pages/219676845/IM+Process>

5. Analysis is 'a detailed examination of a complex phenomenon to understand its nature or to determine its essential features'.³ The analysis spectrum used by OCHA describes six levels of analysis ranging from exploratory analysis through prescriptive analysis (Figure 2). For the purposes of this study, the six phases of the IM process are referred to as "IM and Analysis" per the TOR usage.

³ <https://humanitarian.atlassian.net/wiki/spaces/imtoolbox/pages/761233411/Analysis+in+Humanitarian+Setting>

Figure 2: The Analysis Spectrum



Source: OCHA IM Toolbox.

<https://humanitarian.atlassian.net/wiki/spaces/imtoolbox/pages/761233411/Analysis+in+Humanitarian+Setting>

6. The IM and Analysis function is foundational to a wide range of branches, services internal and external to OCHA. OCHA has supported the gradual evolution in the humanitarian IM and Analysis ecosystem⁴ ranging from the development and utilization of the Humanitarian Information Centers (HIC), the institutionalization of Information Management Officers (IMOs) and the subsequent Information Management Units (IMU) in each of its country and regional offices. OCHA also has continued to assume larger roles in supporting predictive analytics, anticipatory action, emergency assessment and analysis cell (A&A Cell) coordination, the creation of Humanitarian Needs Overviews (HNOs), Humanitarian Response Plans (HRPs)⁵ and global-level trends analysis in terms of needs, response and financing.
7. The IM and analysis function within OCHA has faced coherency challenges. There is no IM and Analysis strategy for OCHA and therefore no clear boundaries for what OCHA's IM and Analysis work should, and should not, include. Furthermore, resourcing decisions for IM and Analysis are led by senior leadership where IM and Analysis is underrepresented. IM and Analysis units are integrated into multiple discrete branches and divisions. There has been a proliferation of tools, platforms, and products at both global and individual humanitarian responses levels. There has been an external evolution of the capacities and humanitarian agencies and clusters for their own IM and Analysis function, and an increasing professionalization of the sector leading to the emergence of specialized actors for IM and Analysis within the humanitarian sphere.

⁴ Ecosystem pertains to the array of internal and external stakeholders related to the IM and Analysis function and their respective roles, responsibilities, and operational frameworks and agreements.

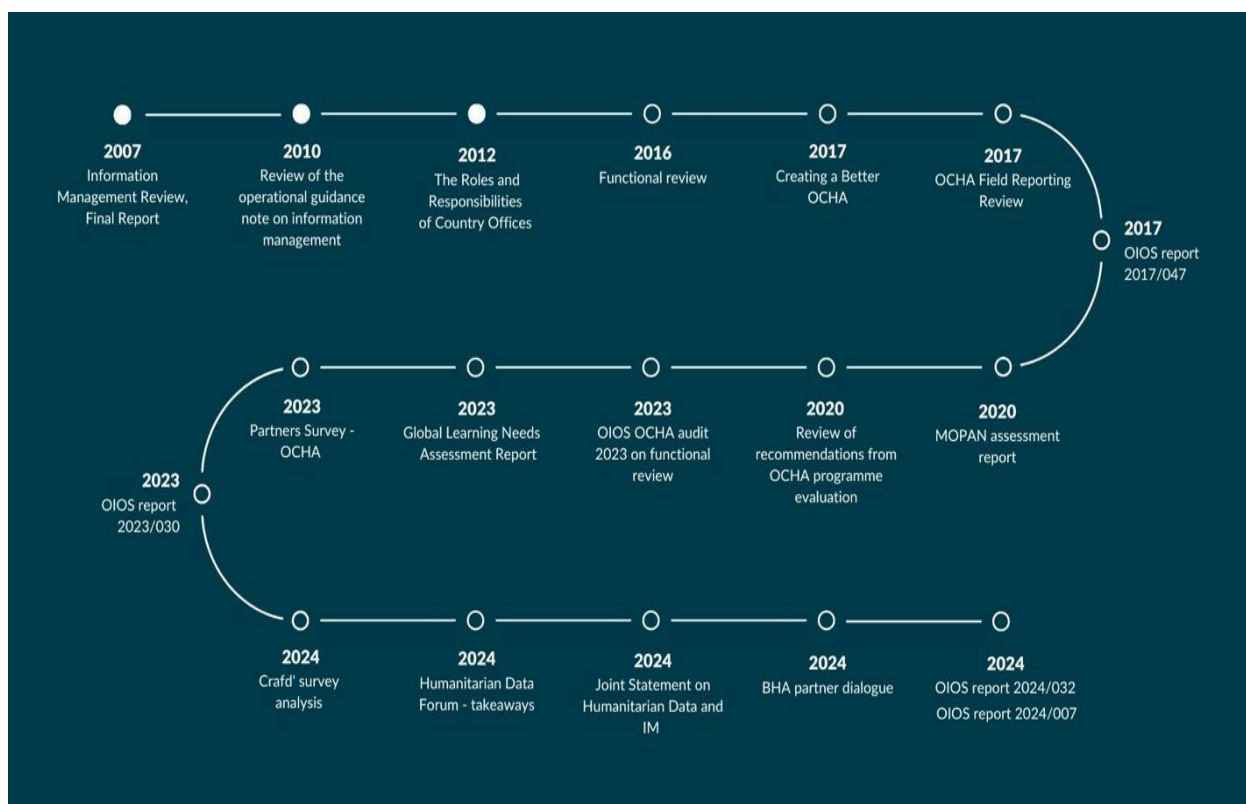
⁵ Humanitarian responses typically produced an HNO and then a separate HRP. However, in some countries a new approach has been piloted combining the two exercises – the Humanitarian Needs and Response Plan (HNRP). For the purposes of this review, these three acronyms are cited concurrently.

8. Moreover, with the creation of the new OCHA Strategic Plan, there has been additional IM and Analysis requirements. The combination of these factors has complicated OCHA's capacity to ensure a coherent suite of high-quality products, leading to a fragmented and under-funded IM architecture with limited frameworks for establishing a clear and shared understanding regarding the roles of IM, reporting lines, core analytical questions to be answered and core platforms required. The most recent OCHA partner review⁶ cited that information accuracy, timeliness and the importance of user-friendly platforms were important considerations for improvement.

2.2 Previously identified challenges

9. There has been a long history of reviews, evaluations and audits which have included IM and Analysis components. At least 15 different reviews, forums, audits and evaluations with relevant IM and Analysis recommendations have occurred over the past decade, with earlier efforts stretching back to 2007 (Figure 3).

Figure 3: Timeline of IM and Analysis Relevant Review and Audits



Source: Review Team based on OCHA documentation

10. The range of previous recommendations relevant to IM and Analysis are similar across the exercises and can be clustered into six thematic categories ranging from leadership and governance through ethical data management with the most frequently weighted elements related to coordination mechanisms and the development of standardized analytical frameworks. A table of common recommendations from previous reviews can be found in Annex 2.
11. There is no evidence from these reviews why their recommendations have not resulted in substantive changes to IM and Analysis. However, there are examples of some of these

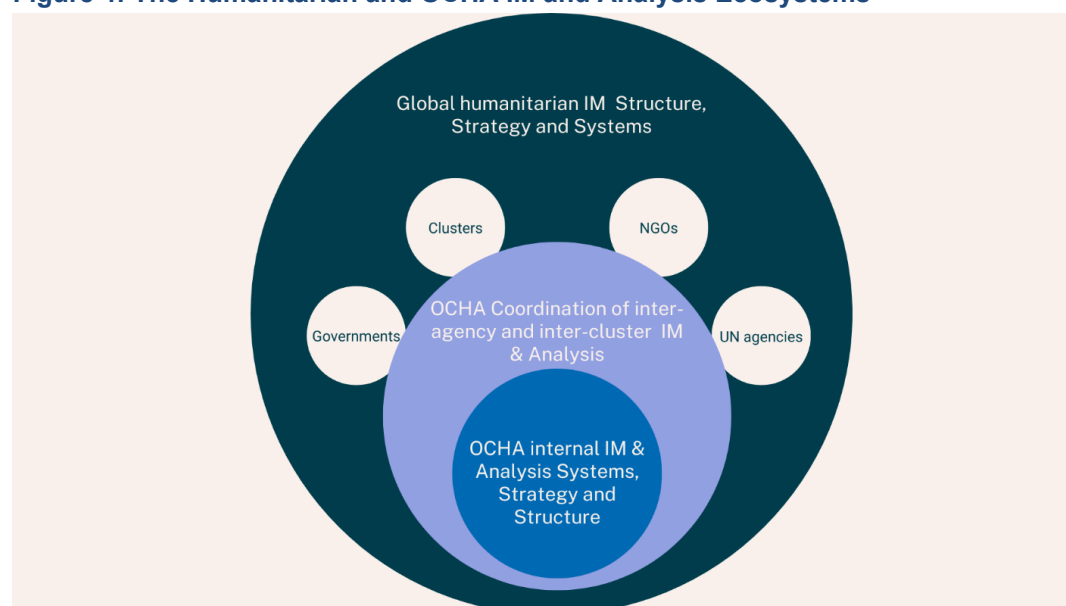
⁶ 2023. UNOCHA. 2023 Partner Survey. OCHA Strategic Planning, Budgeting and Finance Section.

recommendations recently being taken into consideration, such as the establishment of the Technology Governance Board in response to the 2023 OIOS audit recommendation.

3 Subject of the Review

12. The subject of this review is OCHA's IM and analysis system and practices. The review assesses whether OCHA's current IM and analysis products and services meet the needs of the strategic and operational decision-makers OCHA should support (both OCHA decision-makers and decision-makers in the broader humanitarian community). The geographic scope includes global, regional, and country-level actors and decisions.
13. IM and Analysis serves an important enabling function to support OCHA's mandates for coordinating humanitarian response, humanitarian financing, and for advocacy and policy development. The primary departure points for all information feeding into these three pillars begins at the country level with individual responses.
14. **The IM and Analysis Ecosystem.** There are three overlapping dimensions related to IM and Analysis within the humanitarian system:
 - i. The overall humanitarian IM and Analysis data ecosystem comprising the IM and Analysis functions from multiple stakeholders including individual UN agencies, NGOs, and clusters.
 - ii. OCHA's coordination of the humanitarian data ecosystem external to OCHA; and
 - iii. The internal OCHA IM and Analysis systems.
15. All three components are relevant to the review, with the primary focus of the review is on the latter two elements – the internal OCHA IM and Analysis systems and how these influence OCHA's capacity for coordination of the humanitarian data ecosystem external to OCHA. Figure 4 outlines these respective relationships.

Figure 4: The Humanitarian and OCHA IM and Analysis Ecosystems

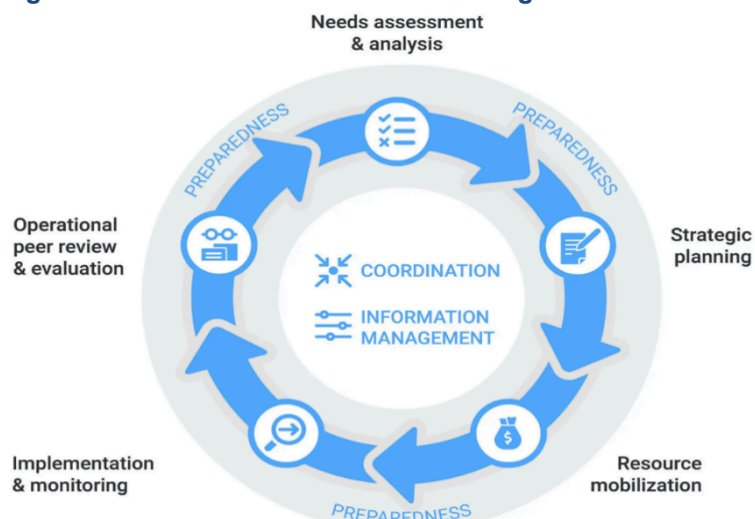


Source: Review Team based on OCHA documentation

16. Assessing the complexity of an emergency and the variety of needs it generates on the people affected by it requires a coordinated system to generate appropriate information for decision-making at strategic, technical and operational levels. To obtain reliable and useful data, there is a need for effective, transparent and systematic information management efforts (understood as the collection, analysis, reporting, storage and sharing of humanitarian information).

17. Figure 5 reproduces OCHA's summary of the Humanitarian Programme Cycle (HPC), outlining the series of actions OCHA facilitates with humanitarian actors to ensure the relevance, quality and predictability of humanitarian action. As depicted by OCHA, Information Management sits at the core of the HPC and is central to the provision of humanitarian responses.

Figure 5: The HPC and Information Management



Source: OCHA - <https://www.unocha.org/we-coordinate>

18. OCHA plays a critical dual role for IM data and analysis for the entire humanitarian community, including other United Nations (UN) agencies and international and national non-governmental organizations (NGOs). OCHA serves a role as both a coordinator of an IM and Analysis sector - supporting Agency, cluster, and NGO IM and Analysis - and as a provider of essential IM and Analysis services.
19. OCHA's dual roles together are to ensure the collection, aggregation, analysis, and data sharing on humanitarian situations, including needs, response, and actors' capacities, ensuring information underpins all OCHA functions and business processes internally and informing collective action externally within the humanitarian responses and sectors.
20. Externally, the Centre for Humanitarian Data (the Centre), established by OCHA in 2017 as a part of the Information Management Branch, represents an emerging initiative aimed to ensure more coherent support to external stakeholders to enhance data-driven decision-making in the humanitarian sector and improve the overall data quality and usability within humanitarian contexts. The Centre focused on improving data access, data responsibility, data literacy and the use of data science in humanitarian response. Its initiatives have contributed to the advancement of predictive analytics and anticipatory action.
21. OCHA's information products and services are tailored to specific audiences. The IM and Analysis component also includes analysis products such as the Global Humanitarian Overview (GHO) or the HNO at the country-levels as well as analysis forums such as the Assessment and Analysis Working Group (AAWG). Products at global, regional, and country levels include maps, graphics, situation reports, humanitarian bulletins, and websites. While positive, this tailoring exacerbates challenges to coherence in the proliferation of products and services. A partial inventory of platforms, products and documents for IM and analysis is provided in Annex 7.⁷

⁷ The factors behind the absence of a universal inventory are described in the findings related to the review dimension of Data Platforms and Tools (see paragraph 60).

22. As part of the coordination work, OCHA country offices (COs) include IMOs responsible for IM work and collaboration with other organizations and humanitarian cluster IMOs. OCHA convenes an Information Management Working Group (IMWG) and an Assessment and an AAWG in each country to drive strategic and technical discussions as well as collaboration on data, analysis and information issues relating to humanitarian response and preparedness.
23. An IMWG also exists at the global level. Countries' IMWGs and AAWGs usually focus on themes such as data standards; general information coordination around assessments and developing common operational datasets, indicators, maps, web platforms; and information sharing protocols. They support the work of the Inter-Cluster Coordination Group (ICCG) and the Humanitarian Coordinator (HC) through the cluster system alongside the overall efforts of the Humanitarian Country Team (HCT) to deliver humanitarian assistance and protection.

4 Review Features

4.1 Review Scope

24. Per the Terms of Reference (ToR, Annex 1), the review was asked to:

- Examine OCHA's Information management and analysis practices using the requirements listed in the OCHA Strategic Plan for reference.
- Assess what subsequent analysis is required to support decision-making in humanitarian response, what information is needed to ensure strong analysis, and what data is required to ensure the needed information is made available.
- Examine OCHA's internal decision-making needs and identify potential options for OCHA to organize itself at global, regional and country levels, making sure tools and mechanisms are available to ensure the predictability and agility required by the organization's mandate.

25. The scope of the review is intended to be primarily thematic (focused on humanitarian response), with a timeline linked to the new Strategic Plan period (2023-present). Its geographic scope includes global, regional and country-level actors. A more detailed stakeholder analysis is found in Annex 3.
26. **Conceptual Framework.** As part of the inception phase, the review team developed a conceptual framework based on the detailed objectives of the review refining the framework through consultation with the review's steering committee.
27. The conceptual framework rationalized and prioritized the review questions into an overarching synthesis, listing the six primary questions that led the review, organized across four dimensions of analysis (Table 1). The conceptual framework also identified the lines of inquiries and cross-cutting themes that were considered in the approach. A more detailed review matrix is included in Annex 4, including information on the data sources and data analysis.

Table 1: Summarized Conceptual Framework

Dimension	Primary Questions
Analysis & Analytical Offerings	• What analytic questions does OCHA need to answer in the field and at Headquarters (HQ)?
Data Platforms and Tools	• What common data platforms should OCHA provide to the humanitarian community? • How does this ideal state align with the current state and what changes should OCHA make to its current portfolio of data platforms?
Leadership and Coordination	• What is OCHA's role in ensuring a coherent suite of humanitarian data/information management services and products? • What are the priority issues in this domain requiring coordination and the field and global level?

Organizational Implications	What, if any, organizational shifts, including capacities and resources, does OCHA need to make to achieve the necessary common data platforms, answer analytic offerings, and successfully coordinate IM services?
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Source: Review team based on ToR and inception consultations

28. The conceptual framework served as the primary methodological guidance for the review, highlighting key areas of focus and aspects to be considered. Data collection tools were developed based on the main review questions, ensuring that data collected fed into the identified lines of inquiries.

4.2 Review Methodology

29. **Overview:** The review was conducted using a comprehensive, mixed methods approach to assess OCHA's IM and analysis practices. A conceptual framework (Figure 4) was developed to prioritize review questions aligned with OCHA's objectives, focusing on leadership, coordination, analytical offerings, data platforms and organizational implications (Annex 2). Interview guides and surveys were structured based on this framework to align data collection with the key lines of inquiry and cross-cutting themes such as leadership, coherence and organizational efficiency. Limitations to the study and mitigation measures are described in the expanded methodology description in Annex 3.
30. **Data collection tools:** The data collection schedule can be found in Annex 5. Four main data collection tools were utilized: desk reviews, semi-structured interviews (individual and group), an online survey and selected site visits (Annex 6). The desk review analysed documents, products and platforms to identify trends, gaps and opportunities in IM practices. Semi-structured interviews provided insights into stakeholders' experiences and perspectives. The online survey gathered complementary quantitative data, while site visits allowed in-depth exploration of regional and country-specific contexts. Remote methods were also employed for additional inclusivity.
31. **Stakeholder mapping:** The review targeted diverse stakeholders, both internal to OCHA and external representatives including persons not associated with IM functions but who relied on IM data for decision-making. Stakeholders were selected across global, regional and country levels, each with distinct IM roles. Stakeholder groups included OCHA staff, humanitarian coordinators, NGOs, donors and national governments. Their roles were categorized into data collection, analysis, decision-making and policy formulation. A total of 292 individuals were selected for interviews, with additional inputs gathered via an online survey.
32. **Site Selection and sampling:** Three country offices (Somalia, Ukraine, Nigeria) and two regional offices (Panama, Amman) were visited in person, while others (Yemen, Haiti, Nairobi, Bangkok) were examined remotely. Countries were selected based on criteria including office size, crisis typology and geographic diversity. The purposive sampling of interviewees prioritized information richness, accessibility, gender representation and diversity of perspectives.
33. **Respondents and Data Collection:** In total, 230 persons were interviewed from multiple levels and stakeholder groups. This included a range of internal OCHA stakeholders and external stakeholders from other organizations including senior leadership. The range of stakeholders included both those who are producers of IM as well as those who are consumers of IM for decision making purposes. In addition to the remote interviews, on-site visits were conducted in Somalia, Ukraine, Nigeria, Panama and Jordan. Additional details regarding the stakeholders interviewed are found in Annex 7.
34. An additional 117 persons responded to the global survey (Annex 7). A final layer of data collection included a global workshop in Istanbul with 22 persons representing different branches and levels of OCHA gathered to review and reflect on the respondent patterns and emergent themes.
35. **Data Analysis:** Data from interviews, the online survey and the desk review were triangulated to ensure validity. Thematic coding identified patterns and themes, with particular weight given to findings corroborated by multiple sources and stakeholder levels. Survey data underwent frequency analysis, while qualitative data were iteratively categorized. Patterns and discrepancies were examined to provide robust conclusions. Further details on the data analysis are in Annex 3.

36.

5 Findings

Overall Finding: The resourcing structure, enabling function of IM and Analysis, and the absence of an OCHA IM and Analysis strategy combine to influence the observed findings in all four review questions.

37. There are three systemic factors that influence the findings within all four questions:

- i. The structure of the resourcing framework.
- ii. The functioning of IM and Analysis as an enabling function distributed throughout OCHA's organization; and
- iii. The absence of an OCHA IM and Analysis Strategy - or formalized IM and analysis frameworks - that provide inputs to: the overarching humanitarian IM and Analysis vision; the external coordination strategy for OCHA within the humanitarian system for IM; and that guides the internal organization of OCHA IM and Analysis

38. In addition to these three factors, the diverse data needs among stakeholders and between global, regional, and country levels, as well as the evolving technological and capacity advances of humanitarian actors influence the patterns of findings in all four review questions.

39. The combination of these factors leads to the creation of “perverse incentives” resulting in the fragmentation of the IM and Analysis function and the proliferation of tools, platforms, and products, which in turn leads to a high degree of variability across responses and stakeholder expectations. Table 2 summarizes the linkages between these factors and observed consequences that are covered in more detail for each review question in the following narrative.

Table 2: Linkages Between Systemic Factors and Observed Consequences

Systemic Factors	Leading to....	Resulting in....
Resourcing Mechanisms	Proliferation of individual IM and Analysis units under multiple divisions, branches, and sectors.	Fragmentation of the IM and Analysis function both internal and external to OCHA
IM and Analysis as an enabling function	Decentralized platform and tool development processes within OCHA	Scope-creep and self-developed expectations on OCHA IM and Analysis function by stakeholders
Absence of an overarching IM and Analysis strategy (internal and external)	No shared analytical, data, or coordination frameworks recognized by all stakeholders	Sensitive dependence on specific leadership or agency conditions
Diverse data needs from humanitarian actors	Perverse incentives impeding collective strategic action	Data fatigue and information overload with certain analytical offering over-absorbing limited resources
Evolving technological advances		Proliferation of working groups
		Delays in updating global guidance and standards
		Limitations on strategic and timely engagement with complementary actors
		Significant variability from country to country in terms of IM and Analysis functioning

Source: Review Team based on evaluation findings

5.1 Analytical Services

Review Questions: What analytic questions does OCHA need to answer in the field and at Headquarters (HQ)?

Summary of findings:

What level of analysis should OCHA provide?

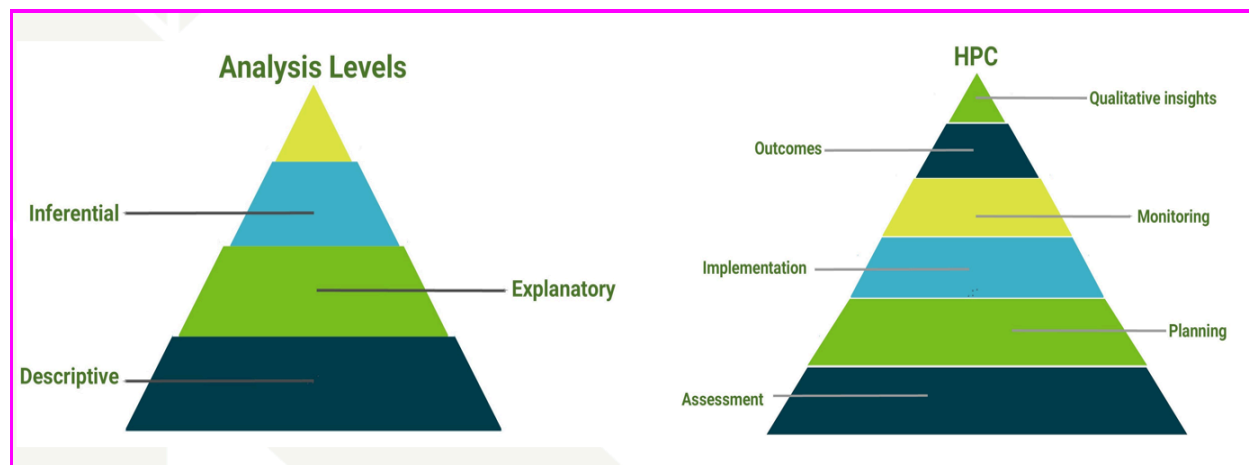
- OCHA's responsibilities are to facilitate inter-sectoral analysis using data from individual clusters.
- Agreement that OCHA should take the lead on six types of data and aggregation for analysis
- Respondents expect OCHA to support the provision of increasingly complex analysis while OCHA staff are also expected to invest significant time and effort to provide basic data quality and descriptive analysis.
- Respondents prioritize timely, strategic, insightful and empowering types of analysis, rather than specific analytical questions.

Key challenges:

- In the absence of a strategy for OCHA external coordination, there is less consensus regarding OCHA's relationship with clusters for data collection methodologies and internal cluster analysis.
- Limited emphasis from stakeholders for outcome level monitoring or to collect insights on experiences of affected populations.
- The emergence of specialist NGOs for IM and Analysis are pivotal for quality IM and Analysis services, but there is limited capacity for their strategic inclusion in in-country operations.
- The absence of a common analytical framework, resource constraints and diverse analysis needs from stakeholders create a set of 5 pairs of competing pressures affecting the quality of analytical services that COs need to individually navigate for each humanitarian response.

40. Throughout data collection, two primary hierarchies of priorities emerged from respondent interviews regarding OCHA IM. The first pertained to “what level of analysis should OCHA provide?”; the second pertained to the HPC cycle – “what are IM and Analysis priorities within the HPC components?” Figure 6 presents a visualization of these patterns of discussion in the interviews.

Figure 6: Hierarchy of Priorities and Respondent Focus



Source: RT development based on interview transcripts

41. Analysis levels. Respondents differentiated between descriptive, explanatory or inferential analysis as follows:

- **Descriptive analysis** focused on collecting raw data and the presentation of “the facts” related to the context, response or monitoring. These are the first two levels of the OCHA Analysis spectrum shown in Figure 2. Respondents tended to focus on elements related to data quality, data collection methods, data reliability or data granularity.

- **Explanatory analysis** pertained to factors influencing the observed patterns in the raw data. These are the third and fourth levels of the OCHA Analysis Spectrum. Examples included determining the relative risk of populations or comparing district coverage and human needs.
- **The inferential analysis** pertained to the “so what” questions. These are the fifth and sixth levels of the OCHA analysis spectrum. Examples included anticipatory and predictive analysis such as convening stakeholders to discuss the implications of the data for informing programming decisions in a response.

Finding 1. Respondents prioritized OCHA’s role in the continuation and improvement of the data quality for basic descriptive analysis while also desiring more higher level analysis support.

42. Respondents recognized that descriptive analysis was the first step in analysis and that the other levels of analysis needed to build on the lower levels. However, respondents primarily focused on issues related to the descriptive analysis levels such as data quality, reliability, and availability. The density of time spent on the descriptive elements suggests that this is where the bulk of OCHA staff time and energy is invested. However, respondents also expressed interest in OCHA supporting the development of higher levels of analysis including explanatory and inferential types of analysis outlined in Figure 6. The implications for how OCHA might achieve this dual expectation is covered further in the Leadership and Coordination review question.

Finding 2. Respondents prioritized OCHA’s support to needs assessment planning and implementation rather than outcome level monitoring or gathering insights from affected populations.

43. **HPC Phases.** A similar pattern emerged within the HPC cycle. The substantive majority of respondent time in interviews focused on the “front end” of the HPC: the needs assessment, planning, and the implementation (in the form of the 3W) phases of the HPC in contrast to the “back end” of the HPC related to outcome level monitoring and eliciting insights on the experiences of the affected populations.
44. Preparedness was also a significant theme related to the “front end” of potential responses. Respondents focus on specific considerations included what was necessary in the needs assessment and planning phases alongside observations regarding how much time is absorbed by staff and stakeholders the these “front end” of the HPC and the need to do better needs assessment during sudden onset responses. Respondents also tended to emphasize OCHA’s role in supporting the transparency and trust in the data used for calculating the People in Need (PiN) figures or the necessity for OCHA to analyse and detect anomalies in the needs assessment data.
45. Respondents did not explicitly question or reflect on the factors driving this emphasis on the needs assessment and planning components of the HPC. The most common rationalization for this heavy emphasis were indirect references regarding that these components were “*what donors wanted to see*”. The implication appeared to be that donors were prioritizing the components of the HPC that affected decisions for resourcing allocations, but that there was less pressure or attention from donors on components related to the results or outcomes of the HPC, and therefore a commensurate lower level of attention allocated to these other components in the IM and Analysis system.

Finding 3. OCHA should take leadership on six types of data and aggregation for analysis.

46. While there were significant respondent variations in terms of expectations of OCHA’s role in platforms, products, tools and services for the humanitarian community, there were six themes where respondents had more significant consensus regarding the criticality of OCHA management and oversight.
47. There was consensus among respondents that OCHA should take the lead in making specific types of data available for coordination and response:

- i. Managing Country Operational Databases (CODs)

- ii. Inter-Agency assessment data
- iii. Cross-sectoral data integration and harmonization
- iv. Situational analyses and event-specific data
- v. Humanitarian indicators and performance data (HNO/HRP/Periodic Monitoring Report)
- vi. Establishing data interoperability and standards

Finding 4. In the absence of a strategy for OCHA external coordination, there is less consensus regarding OCHA's relationship with cluster-specific analysis.

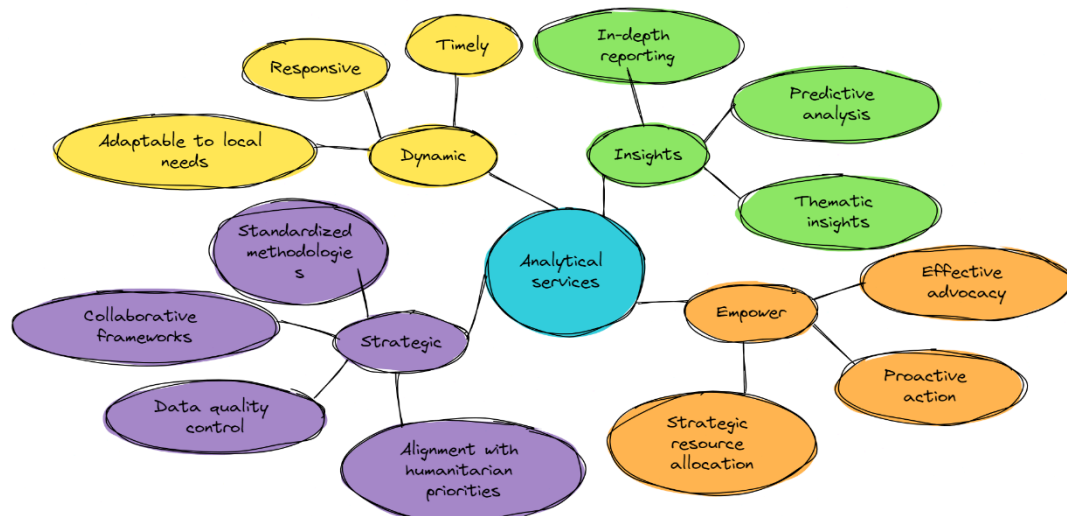
48. The absence of an IM and Analysis coordination strategy that is collectively shared⁸ led to variations in the relationships between OCHA and the clusters in different humanitarian responses. Respondents largely agreed upon OCHA's role within the inter-sectoral space to support inter-sectoral analysis. However, there was not a common consensus regarding the role that OCHA should play within the clusters themselves to support the "pre-interagency analysis". These diverse interpretations can lead to tensions or ambiguities over OCHA's expected roles in clusters. A common contradiction in cluster interviews related to the expectation that OCHA would provide common standards and common methodologies for the clusters on needs assessment, while at the same time criticizing OCHA for "meddling within the clusters".
49. Another example of the ambiguity between OCHA and the cluster responsibilities pertained to the question of ethical data management of shared data – or who is ultimately accountable for the data collected and shared to inform analysis. Data collection processes in country offices are primarily managed by the Agencies, clusters and NGOs. OCHA's role is seen as ensuring and coordinating the inter-agency coherence of this data and ethical data management considerations. However, there is an accountability gap in terms of who is ultimately responsible for the data protection and ethical treatment of respondents. Is it the agency who collected the data, or OCHA who is organizing the data for sharing? Not surprisingly, OCHA stakeholders considered the responsibility to rest with the agencies or NGOs that collected the data, while external stakeholders considered data protection to be the responsibility of OCHA.
50. There is a disconnect between the time and cost invested in data analysis and its perceived utility for decision makers for operations, resulting in data fatigue. The proliferation of internal OCHA data platforms and processes was perceived as creating information overload. Respondents felt data requests from OCHA were primarily for internal OCHA upwards aggregation with less consideration of how the range of information collected would be used by country-level decision-makers.
51. Furthermore, in the absence of a collective analytical framework, OCHA staff in country offices were susceptible to requests from leadership for additional analysis services. The led OCHA IM staff needing to respond to "ad hoc" analysis requests rather than operating within a set of strategic priorities. This was perceived to create "purposeless" data collection. One example pertained to the challenges in the coordination of needs assessment processes where respondents felt that there was a duplication of efforts and subsequent data fatigue. While there are large amounts of data being collected that may be used for descriptive analysis of needs, relatively little of this data was considered to be leveraged for higher-level analysis (the "so what" questions).

Finding 5. Respondent expectations of the ideal state of analytical questions from OCHA focus primarily on the qualities of analysis rather than specific analytical questions.

52. Figure 7 describes a mapping of the key word linkages in respondent interviews regarding analytical services. There are four overarching themes within the key words which in summary would describe analysis as: dynamic, insightful, with established standards for data quality and analysis, and empowering. While all are important considerations, it is indicative that responses did not focus on describing the specific analytical questions needed to be addressed.

⁸ There may exist internal documentation or agreements regarding OCHA's role in IM and Analysis coordinating with clusters, but respondents were not aware of these.

Figure 7: Keyword Themes – Analytical Services



Source: Review Team compiled from interview notes and transcripts

53. Put together in a narrative, the keywords reflect an idealized state regarding the quality of analysis, even if not the type of analytical questions to address. These can form one part of a basis of a new vision for data, IM and analysis in a new strategy for IM and Analysis for OCHA:

“OCHA’s analytical services should be timely, high-quality, and responsive to the dynamic needs of the humanitarian community. Analytical products would go beyond basic reporting to provide in-depth, predictive, and thematic insights that empower humanitarian actors to act proactively, advocate effectively, and allocate resources strategically. Data platforms and tools should be sufficiently user-friendly and adaptable, to allow country teams to customize analyses of local needs, and HQ staff would focus on cross-sectoral and global insights. Rigorous data quality control, standardized methodologies, and collaborative frameworks would underpin the analytical processes, ensuring that all products are reliable, relevant, and aligned with the humanitarian community’s strategic priorities.”

Finding 6. In the absence of a common analytical framework, resource constraints, and diverse data needs from stakeholders creates a set of five pairs of competing pressures that country offices must navigate individually affecting the quality of analytical services.

54. The three systemic factors are:

- i. The absence of a common analysis framework,
- ii. resource constraints, and
- iii. leading to diverse analysis demands from stakeholders.

55. These create a set of competing pressures that OCHA staff need to navigate including:

- i. aggregation versus contextualization
- ii. simplification versus granularity
- iii. description versus critical thinking
- iv. inter-agency obligations versus filling-gaps
- v. reactive versus proactive analysis.

56. The combination of these systemic factors and competing pressures has led to a lack of consensus on analytical priorities and diverse expectations from external stakeholders.

Systemic Factor 1 - There is no common analytical framework used by stakeholders regarding analysis and analytical questions.

57. OCHA's function is to coordinate humanitarian responses, humanitarian financing, and advocacy and policy development. All three functions have both global and country level considerations, with the point of departure even for the global offices will be the data that is generated from country offices.
58. However, there is no commonly referenced analytical framework to inform IM and Analysis considerations for response coordination, humanitarian financing or advocacy. As a consequence, respondents provided varying definitions regarding analysis and highlighted different analytical interests linked to different mandates (Table 3).

Table 3: Summary of Analytical Questions by Stakeholder Type

Stakeholder	Analysis themes	Highest Weighting	OCHA Pillar
OCHA HQ	Strategic planning, anticipatory action, performance measurement, long-term trend analysis.	Long-term trend analysis, strategic planning	Advocacy and Policy Development
Donors	Funding gaps, resource efficiency, and accountability	Largest funding gaps	Humanitarian Financing
Inter-Agency Stakeholders	Analysis of inter-agency coordination, global trends, and data sharing.	Improving inter-agency coordination	Response coordination
HCTs	Operational challenges/progress, access, real-time situation and implementation monitoring, population vulnerabilities	Real-time trends and needs	Response Coordination
Cluster Leads/Sectors	Sector-specific needs, cross-sectoral dynamics, cross-sectoral resource allocation. Identifying priority humanitarian needs.	Priority humanitarian needs, inter-sectoral gaps and overlaps	Response Coordination
Country offices	Local dynamics, access constraints, and localization of data including factors influencing needs.	Local factors influencing needs	Advocacy and Policy Development
Operational NGOs	Vulnerability and protection assessments, identifying most at-risk populations, human rights, and conflict sensitivity	Most at-risk populations	Advocacy and Policy Development

Source: RT development based on interview transcripts

59. Respondents almost always started discussions focusing on the tools, platforms and services to do analysis rather than reflecting on the specific analytical questions to be addressed – reflecting the lack of a common analytical framework. Cited analytical practices were varied and often disconnected – resulting in outputs that lacked strategic alignment or operational relevance. The variations among stakeholders do orient around four priorities:
- Enhancing resource allocation
 - Contextualizing the response to specific local needs
 - Reducing duplications in implementation, and
 - Reducing delays in responses.
60. Respondents tended to expect OCHA to provide leadership on defining the mixture of analysis questions, providing observations on data quality, and expected outcomes. Respondent expected OCHA to facilitate the role of NGOs or others in generating the data and conducting the analysis (covered in more detail in the Leadership and Coordination dimension).
61. These ambiguities around the absence of common analytical framework tied to a country's operations and OCHA operations have in turn led to i) considerable variation in the core analytical offerings produced within a particular response; and ii) the fragmentation of tools and efforts, and iii)

scope creep as stakeholders request analysis that “would be nice to know”. Respondents expressed appreciation for existing analysis but found it inconsistently available across and within country operations. Additionally, there were concerns by external stakeholders regarding the consistency, continuity and frequency of existing products.

Systemic Factor 2 - Certain analytical offerings absorb limited resources at the expense of delivering other forms of analysis.

62. At the Regional and Country levels, resource constraints – time, people, funding – has a cascade effect on analytical offerings. Respondents noted a tension between the time and energy required for producing the basics and the aspirations among stakeholders for more sophisticated analysis.
63. A commonly cited example pertained to the HNO/HRP/HNRP process. These processes were seen as extremely time intensive, limiting the time and capacity available for more sophisticated analysis such as “horizon scanning” (looking into the future regarding future needs), predictive analytics or creating spaces for HCT stakeholders to discuss the “so what” questions and limited the capacity to address sudden onset responses.
64. Some progress has been made in terms of reducing the HNO/HRP/HNRP time requirements, resulting in an approximately 18 percent reduction in the number of days required. However, the widespread consensus from interviewed respondents is that the overall process is still too time intensive. The time required was particularly troubling for some stakeholders, especially country-level stakeholders, who expressed scepticism regarding the overall utility of the HNO/HRP/HNRP for strategic planning and decision making for Agencies implementing responses. In contrast, donors were generally positive about the utility of the products although there were respondents who noted donor funding is not always well aligned in terms of timing or priorities with what is embedded in the HNO/HRP/HNRP.
65. In addition, there has been an emergence of specialist NGOs for analysis but limited time on the part of OCHA staff to fully take advantage of these additional capacities. Specialist NGOs, such as iMMAP, REACH, and ACAPS, have emerged in recent years to provide additional data collection, analysis and support services. These NGOs were considered by respondents to be pivotal stakeholders for providing quality services within humanitarian responses.
66. In theory, these specialist NGOs could provide important supplementary analysis to address the constraints of OCHA staff as they can provide resources and expertise to cover gaps in IM and Analysis functions within humanitarian responses. Country offices have shown positive results in engaging with NGOs for IM and Analysis, but there is no general mapping of their coverage among humanitarian responses.
67. Respondents noted that time constraints on OCHA staff limited the IMO capacities for strategic attention to these NGOs and their inclusion in country operations and analysis. The NGOs were frequently not included in the IMWG or other coordination bodies related to IM and Analysis. They were also frequently not able to directly access the collective humanitarian response platforms for data entry or analysis. As a consequence, these NGOs were seen as both crucial for, and marginalized from, IM functions in countries (covered further in Leadership and Coordination).

Systemic Factor 3: In the absence of an analytical map, diverse data demands from different stakeholders lead to challenges in determining the correct analytical “pitch”.

68. Respondents would vary between saying that products were too superficial, too technical, or too limited. In the global survey, respondents rated most products as “somewhat useful” but noted that dashboards and other outputs focused more on data compilation than actionable analysis. The most common suggestion was the need to move beyond data aggregation to include predictive and thematic analysis.
69. The lack of an analytical map or, more practically, a universal product catalogue that defines the purpose and intended use of each product and shows how they are related to each other in terms of their analytical direction, has made the system more vulnerable to a range of uncoordinated

stakeholder expectations for analysis. Respondents simultaneously cited challenges with the proliferation of dashboards and superficial analysis, which lead to data fatigue and data overload, as well as concerns about analysis which is overly technical.

70. The absence of a collective data strategy complicated the determination of appropriate analytical offerings because of the need for COs to navigate five sets of competing pressures. In addition to the three drivers leading to fragmented and not coherent analytical offerings, the absence of a collective data strategy requires OCHA country offices and global headquarters to determine how to navigate five sets of competing pressures within the humanitarian system related to IM and Analysis functions. These are described in Table 4.

Table 4: Navigating Contradictory Pressures and Analytical Offerings

Contradiction	Challenge
Aggregation versus Contextualization	Balancing the need for strategic analysis and global data aggregation while at the same time attending to the country-level stakeholder demands for more sophisticated context-specific analysis involving real-time responses and adaptations. If country offices produce data that is too contextualized, there are challenges in then taking multiple relatively unique data and attempting to aggregate it upwards for global analysis.
Simplification versus Granularity	Balancing stakeholder requests to “consolidate and simplify” analytical offerings while also attending to stakeholder requests to “provide an increased granularity of data” – usually to respond to donor requests.
Descriptive Analysis versus Critical Thinking	Balancing stakeholder requests for providing extensive descriptive analysis products while also attending to the demand from stakeholders for OCHA to support more “critical thinking” analysis. This is related to the emerging requests for OCHA to do more “sense making” and to “tell the story of the data in a better manner”.
Inter-Agency versus Gap-Filling	Balancing stakeholder expectations for OCHA to “connect the dots” and support inter-cluster and inter-sectoral analysis while also avoiding stakeholder expectations to fill gaps not currently covered in the by any existing cluster, agency, or system.
Reactive versus Proactive Analysis	Balancing between OCHA supporting answering the immediate requests of the humanitarian community and their ability to anticipate future requests for analysis.

Source: RT development based on interview transcripts

71. An additional challenge related to the IM teams in country offices needing to navigate “political” debates related to analytical offerings in the absence of a collective data strategy. A commonly cited example related to the calculations of the PiN numbers in a response. NGOs and some Agencies tended to push for methodologies which led to the presentation of a large PiN number to reflect vulnerability and populations at risk, while donors and governments tended to push for methodologies which led to the presentation of a smaller PiN number to reflect more feasible funding possibilities.

5.2 Platforms, Products, and Tools

Review Questions: What common data platforms should OCHA provide to the humanitarian community? How does this ideal state align with the current state and what changes should OCHA make to its current portfolio of data platforms?

Summary of findings:

What platforms should OCHA provide the humanitarian community?

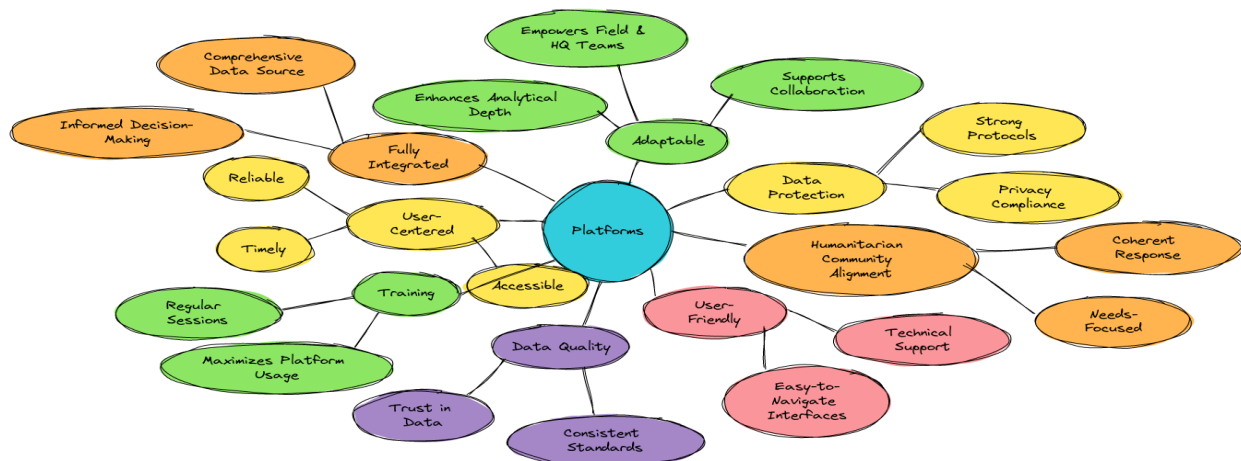
- Respondents tended to focus on the *features* of tools, platforms, services and products rather than the *types* of data in these platforms.
- Respondent prioritized user-friendliness, adaptability, and data quality.
- Respondents appreciate available platforms and tools with seven being the most frequently cited positively.
- The emerging technology governance board is an initiative intended to streamline the current portfolio.

Key challenges:

- The combination of the dispersed nature of IM tool development, the resourcing architecture, and competing data needs have led to the proliferation and fragmentation of platforms tools and products.
- The proliferation has led to information overload and data fatigue
- Interoperability could help reduce proliferation and fragmentation of tools and platforms.
- Efforts to rationalize platforms, tools, products and services are hampered because of the absence of a data strategy and that there is no single universal inventory that captures the entirety of all OCHA-managed services and products.

Finding 7. Respondents could not articulate a clear conceptual linkage between the analysis questions to be answered and the information embedded in platforms, tools or products.

72. There is an implicit assumption from all respondents regarding the importance of data, in the abstract, to provide a better response. However, as noted previously, in the absence of a common analytical framework, respondents did not share a common definition of analysis and consequently, there was a disconnect between what types of analytic questions were expected to be answered, and what types of data was needed to address these questions. Because of this, when asked about data platforms, respondents tended to focus on the *features* of tools, platforms, services and products rather than the *types* of data in these platforms. This can be seen in the key word themes from interviews where the primary themes were user-experience, adaptability, and data quality considerations (Figure 8).

Figure 8: Keyword Themes – Data Platforms and Tools

Source: Review Team compiled from interview notes and transcripts

73. Put together in a narrative, the keywords reflect an idealized state regarding the features of platforms and products. These can form one part of a basis of a new vision for data, IM and analysis in a new strategy for IM and Analysis for OCHA:

“OCHA’s data platforms would be user-centred, adaptable, and fully integrated, serving as a comprehensive source for timely, reliable, and accessible humanitarian data. These platforms would facilitate collaboration across clusters, enhance analytical depth, and empower field and HQ teams to make informed, proactive decisions. Consistent data quality, user-friendly interfaces, and strong data protection protocols would reinforce trust in the data, while regular training and technical support would ensure all users can maximize platform capabilities. This holistic approach would place OCHA’s platforms at the core of a coherent and coordinated humanitarian response, fully aligned with the needs and expectations of the humanitarian community.”

74. There is a proliferation, and fragmentation, of platforms, products, tools and services with ripple effects on coherence and efficiency. The dispersed nature of the IM functions across OCHA, and the emphasis on highly contextualized humanitarian responses, has led to the proliferation of platforms, tools, services and products. OCHA country offices develop their own tools and platforms to address

the specific contextual needs, leading to significant variation in IM products, capacities, and tools among countries. Respondents noted that this, combined with the proliferation of tools and products among the dispersed IM functions at the HQ level, has led to instances of significant data replication, challenges navigating among the dispersed platforms, and multiple instances of manual data entry being required to transfer data from one platform or product to another.

Finding 8. There is evidence of duplications and overlap among existing known platforms within OCHA.

75. The Technology Governance Board has managed to establish a partial inventory of available platforms, tools, or services (Annex 8.1). The inventory includes 96 items managed by a range of HQ units and country offices (Table 5).

Table 5: Partial Inventory of Existing IM Tools, Platforms, Products, and Services⁹¹⁰

Category	Total	OAD	Coord	IMB	HF	SC	Exec	HQ	RO	CO
Tool	45	19	7	11	5	3		27	3	15
Platform	30	5	12	3	7	2	1	25	3	2
Product	18	12	4		1		1	9	3	6
Service	3	2		1				1	2	0
Total	96	38	23	15	13	5	2	62	11	23

Source: Technology Governance Board Initial Inventory, analysed by Review Team

76. Examples are varied in levels and type, ranging from large-scale global platforms such as HDX, to country-specific tools for entering leave days. Of these, 82 percent were classified as external facing and 26 percent were deemed as something that could be integrated into another platform or product. All platforms, tools, products, and services developed have associated use-cases developed at the time of the design. The OIOS audit noted that there has not been a systematic review of the existing use cases to update them against the changing humanitarian needs.

77. During interviews, respondents tended to cite fewer than ten specific platforms or tools (Table 6). These were the same as the most commonly cited tools and platforms from the global survey. The most common frequency of use is monthly (47 percent of survey respondents).

Table 6: Most commonly cited platforms and tools

IM Element	Primary Function described by respondents
HDX	Repository for quantitative datasets
ReliefWeb	Repository for content – information on documents, standards, guidance
FTS	Financial tracking of global resources
Humanitarian Action	Humanitarian Needs Overview and Response planning (HNO, HRP, HNRP) and the JIAF – seen as important example of joint methodologies
3/4/5W	Humanitarian response implementation to avoid duplications and identify gaps in attention to populations
Grant Management System (GMS)	Tracking resource allocation and implementation from the Central Emergency Response Fund (CERF)/Country-Based Pooled Funds (CBFP)
GHO	Strategic global overview of needs, planning, and resourcing.

Source: Respondent interviews, analysed by Review Team

⁹ This inventory is not exhaustive especially for identifying country and regional elements.

¹⁰ Definitions of tools, platforms, services, and product are found in Annex 8.1.

Finding 9. Positive examples exist of supporting analytical services through tools, processes or platforms supporting analysis.

78. Examples tend to reflect pattern of dispersed, pro-active, individual initiatives without a connection to a strategic framework of analytical questions. Frequently cited successes included:

- Operational analytics such as 3Ws, or operational dashboards
- Global Humanitarian Overview (GHO)– donor satisfaction with GHO
- HNO/HRP/HNRP – donor satisfaction with the tools for allocating resources.
- Selective collaborations for specialized analysis within OCHA (Centre for Humanitarian Data, CHD) and in partnerships (REACH)
- Selective innovation such as the Bridge Tools seen as supportive for planning
- Citations of initiatives in process for developing data standards
- Analytical tools for real-time data track and real-time dashboards
- Joint analysis frameworks (multi-sector needs assessments, Multisectoral Needs Assessments, or Joint and Intersectoral Analysis Framework, JIAF) supporting cross-sectoral planning
- Establishing Analysis units and multi-disciplinary teams in country offices to address analytical offerings.

Finding 10. Respondents cited examples of individual initiatives to reduce the proliferation of platforms, products, tools and services.

79. Cited examples ranged from country offices producing their own product catalogues within a particular response to references to the recently formed Technology Governance Board tasked with reviewing and eliminating duplications and inefficiencies. Standardization efforts for inter-agency data sharing were cited referencing the HDX and Relief Web platforms. Respondents also cited the standardization and streamlining of the HPC including efforts to reduce the amount of time required and highlighted the particular stability and success of the GMS for managing funds from the CERF and CBPF. However, these efforts tended to be focused on specific platform improvement or individual initiatives. The most coherent global effort to improve coherence of the array of platforms and tools has been the establishment of the Technology Governance Board in response to the 2023 OIOS audit recommendation.

80. Efforts to rationalize platforms, tools, products and services are hampered because there is no single universal inventory that captures the entirety of all OCHA-managed services and products. This condition is complicated by three additional factors. First, there is also no single universal definition of what is considered a tool, platform, product or service.¹¹ Second, not all country offices had a full inventory of their own product catalogues, and third, some respondents from country and regional offices reported reluctance to share all of their specially developed products and services because these may “get them in trouble” with HQ units for not using the standard products. Because of this, there were cases where country offices reported developing their own solutions as they were not aware of existing products.

Finding 11. In the absence of a collective recognized data strategy for OCHA IM and Analysis, the decentralized tool development process and resourcing architecture creates a set of four competing pressures that country offices must navigate individually, leading to the proliferation of tools, and platforms.

81. The systemic factors are:

- i. the decentralized tool prioritization and development process; and
- ii. the resourcing architecture.

82. The competing pressures are balancing

¹¹ For the purposes of this review, during the inception phase the RT developed definitions of these categories which are repeated in Annex 8.1

- i. Standardization versus flexibility,
- ii. Rigor versus “lightness”,
- iii. Cost-benefit of excessive granularity, and
- iv. Inter-agency obligations versus filling gaps.

83. The combination of the dispersed nature of IM tool development, the resourcing architecture, and these competing pressures have led to the proliferation and fragmentation of tools and products. These factors have also contributed to significant uncertainty among external stakeholder regarding the continuity and consistency of tools and products. Multiple examples were cited of tools developed and rolled out, but then languishing or being replaced by other tools. The consequences of this are described further under the Leadership and Coordination dimension.

Systemic Factor 1: Decentralized platform and tool development processes within OCHA.

84. The enabling function of IM across multiple branches and divisions has led to a dispersed IM structure within OCHA. One consequence of this dispersed structure is that every individual, branch or unit ultimately has become responsible for the development and maintenance of their own tools or platforms.

85. This presents two challenges.

- i. First, each unit must be both the business owner and service provider for “their” platform. This requires needing to have technical expertise in data systems as well as the subject matter expertise in the business of the division, branch or service. This can present complications for efficient project management if the technical expertise is not available “inhouse”.

Second, there is currently no centralized guidance or protocols for platform or tool development nor any consistent documentation regarding what are to be considered the “core tools” or standards for platforms. This can lead to multiple consequences such as: i) units, branches, or individuals using unsanctioned software, ii) unable to access central resources for support or development; and iii) relying on special project funding for the development of “their” tool.

86. The combination of these two challenges has led to the establishment of multiple platforms at country, regional and global levels requiring extensive navigation and data replication. This in turn has led to the situation cited earlier of multiple needs for data entry replication throughout the system, often using manual entry even at the global levels (see paragraph 55).

87. The fragmentation and proliferation, and subsequent manual entry requirements, has led to widespread stakeholder perceptions regarding timeliness and efficiency challenges. Phrases such as “feeding the beast” and “re-inventing the wheel” were commonly found in respondent interviews. Timeliness was seen as further exacerbated by new rollouts of global products or processes. While these might result in improved products, the time required for re-learning and adapting existing systems to the new products was seen as a universal factor in delays.

88. An unintended effect of these decentralized processes related to innovation fatigue. While innovation is encouraged, the proliferation of tools has meant that there can be a wide range of simultaneous innovations occurring on each tool or product. This can lead to the timeliness challenges as new innovations need to be rolled out and adapted to country contexts. In addition, misaligned solutions from HQ stakeholders can face rejection from COs if these solutions are seen as likely to contribute to further delays or require more energy and investment to implement.

89. Because of the resource and time constraints, COs are more frequently engaged in improvisation to meet a demand rather than an innovation. One common example cited is that COs will put together a spreadsheet of their own because there is no common list of tools, or they are not sure who to ask about an existing tool, and they deem it quicker to put together their own spreadsheet. This “bad habit” then becomes an embedded process in the country – leading to yet another version of a tool.

Systemic Factor 2: Resourcing architecture driving perverse incentives.

90. The resourcing architecture creates an array of perverse incentives that reduce incentives for strategic collaboration and increase incentives for short-term siloed projects. The allocation of funding envelopes within the Secretariat creates perverse incentives contributing to a dispersed and fragmented IM and Analysis structure. Funding envelopes are decided at the senior leadership level, outside of IM influence.
91. The envelopes are intended to provide long-term strategic support to OCHA's IM function through programme support costs (PSC). This is a fixed envelop structure. If a branch or unit secures additional strategic funding, this does not increase the size of their envelope. Instead, the amount allocated from the Secretariat is reduced to offset this extra funding. This creates a disincentive (a "perverse incentive") for branches or units to organize to seek strategic funding. The other primary funding option is special project financing. Mechanisms for special project financing provide short term, limited funding options for specific projects. While motivated individuals or units can pursue special project funding, these resources from specific donors are time bound and limited. The expectation is that these special projects should eventually become sustainable with alternative funding.
92. This combination simultaneously dampens the incentives of branches to seek strategic funding (as it will not increase their envelope) while increasing the incentives for individuals to seek special project funding (and later compete with other units to get "their" special project moved to PSC). The dynamic fosters an environment of fragmented competition with limited incentives for strategic collaboration further fragmenting the IM and Analysis system.
93. Respondents noted that donors do play a critical role in supporting the platform and tool architecture through three avenues: i) providing the financial resources to develop and maintain the IM platforms, tools and services; ii) providing the financial resources for funding the training initiatives and capacity development required in rollouts of new products and platforms; and iii) engaging in advocacy for IM within the humanitarian system through earmarking funding for IM – which can highlight or reinforce the importance of IM functions. However, at the same time, donors with sector-specific or regional funding mandates may inadvertently fragment OCHA's efforts to provide a unified IM framework as resources become tied to particular priorities.
94. The absence of a collective data strategy for OCHA IM and Analysis creates complications for country offices who need to individually navigate a balance among four sets of competing pressures. In addition to the two fragmentation drivers, OCHA country offices and global headquarters are susceptible to the need to navigate competing pressures within the humanitarian system related to IM and Analysis functions:
- i. Balancing standardization with contextualization; i
 - ii. Balancing methodological rigor with demands for lightness, flexibility, and practicality.
 - iii. Balancing the cost-benefit of granular data; and
 - iv. Managing expectations regarding OCHA's role in technological innovations.
95. These competing pressures are exacerbated by the absence of a collective data strategy to inform decisions on these issues. These tensions are described in Table 7 below.

Table 7: Navigating Competing Pressures and Tools, Products, Platforms, and Services

Pressures	Challenge
Standardization versus Adaptability	Country offices and HQ units face challenges in balancing the need for standardized tools and platforms while at the same time attending to the demand for adaptable and flexible tools that can be applied to specific country contexts.
Methodological Rigor versus "Lightness"	Respondents strongly support the importance of OCHA's role in ensuring standardized methodologies with high technical rigor to ensure reliable data. At the same time, there was a significant push from external respondents on the need for OCHA to ensure that processes are light, flexible and practical.

Cost-benefit of granularity	Country offices and HQ units face challenges in balancing requests for the necessity to have substantively disaggregated data to the lowest possible administrative levels for decision making. However, because of the inherent unreliability of highly localized data within an emergency context, obtaining rigorous granular data can be very time consuming and expensive. Country offices struggled with balancing the relative utility of highly granular data (as opposed to more general estimates) for decision making compared to the time, effort and cost required to obtain reliable data.
Innovative Technologies and Gap-Filling	Technologies for information management are rapidly evolving with a widespread recognition among respondents that the entire humanitarian community is facing challenges with absorbing or adapting to the new technologies. There is not a shared consensus among external respondents regarding the purpose or benefit of technology information, but there is a consensus from external respondents that OCHA should “take the lead” on integrating these technology innovations.

Source: RT development based on interview transcripts

Finding 12. Interoperability could reduce the consequences of the proliferation and fragmentation of tools and platforms.

96. Interoperability and automation were often presented as mitigation measures to the proliferation and fragmentation of tools and platforms. Interoperability and automation were highlighted within stakeholder interviews as a potential area for focus due to their promise for resolving timeliness and completeness barriers within IM. Respondent interoperability suggestions can be broadly classified into four categories:

- Technical Interoperability – Standards and protocols, APIs, Data integration tools
- Semantic interoperability – Common ontologies and taxonomies, meta data
- Organizational interoperability – Policies and governance, partnerships and data agreements, business processes
- Syntactic interoperability – Data formats, Data mapping, Validation mechanisms.

97. Respondents tended to use the term interoperability to refer to a wide range of potential issues within these four categories ranging from registration data through platform automation linked to Agency databases. The range of issues cited illustrate that it was less about a single issue, and more about a proposed solution to a perceived bottleneck – timeliness. Both the stakeholder interviews and the global survey cited challenges with timelines and completeness of data availability. In the global survey, about half of the respondents rated the data as “somewhat timely” (51 percent) and “Somewhat comprehensive” (53 percent), suggesting more could be done to ensure timeliness and completeness.

98. Both external and internal respondents considered it important for OCHA to be leading on interoperability issues. However, the implicit logic for OCHA leading interoperability considerations was that it would reduce the effects of the fragmentation and proliferation of tools and platforms because, if there was sufficient interoperability and automation, then the data could be quickly merged into the different platforms as required without the accompanying delays. This pattern was similarly reflected in the global survey responses where one of the most common suggestions from respondents pertained to the need to develop more interconnected tools to *streamline* user workflows. In other words, the proposed solutions cited by respondents were linked more to improved timeliness rather than improved analysis.

5.3 Leadership and Coordination

Review Questions: What is OCHA's role in ensuring a coherent suite of humanitarian data, IM service and products? What are the priority issues in the domain requiring coordination at the country, regional, and global levels.

Summary of findings:

What is OCHA's role in ensuring a coherent suite of humanitarian data, IM services and product?

- Stakeholders distinguished between leadership and coordination
- Stakeholders expect OCHA to take an active leadership in five dimensions; generally distinguishing between expected leadership related to areas around data analytics, and coordination related to analysis and decision-making.

What are the priority issues requiring leadership and coordination?

- Setting the overarching strategic vision for IM in the humanitarian community
- Highlighting funding gaps and unmet needs
- Facilitating data sharing and data standardization
- Facilitating IM surge capacity and supporting sudden onset emergencies
- Coordinating the inclusion of specialist NGOs and other actors in the collection, analysis and dissemination of quality products.

Key challenges:

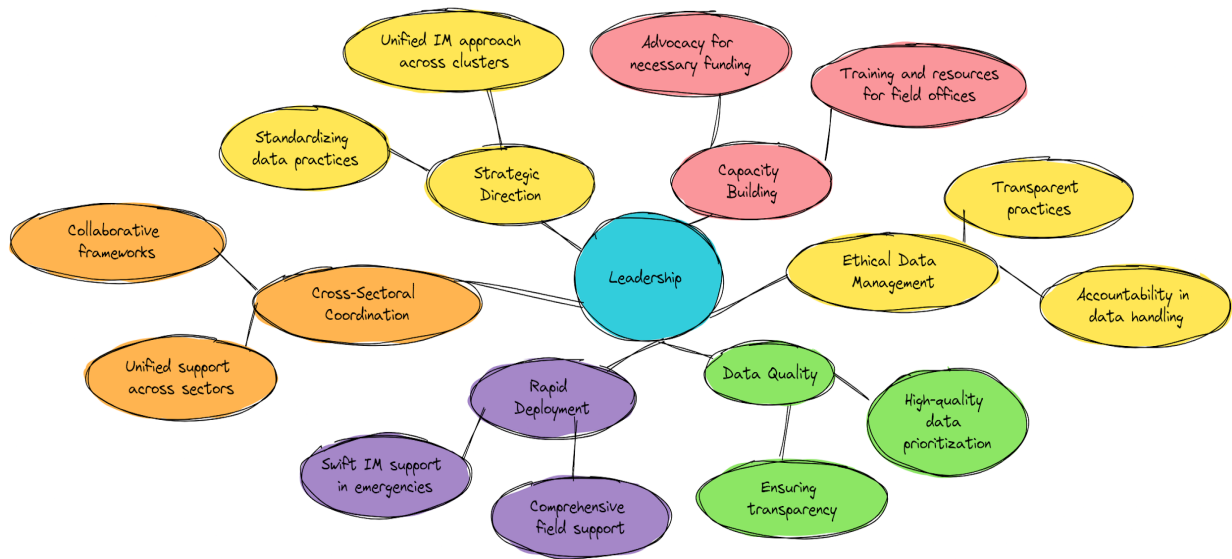
- In the absence of an IM and Analysis strategy for external coordination, individual humanitarian responses are sensitive to specific leadership and agency conceptions, leading to substantive variation in the OCHA IM structure, its integration into the humanitarian response, and overall capacity for effective IM and Analysis.
- Tensions among humanitarian agencies - especially the larger, more autonomous agencies- were identified as creating significant challenges for OCHA in ensuring smooth coordination within a particular response.
- Significant variations in terms of the degree of agency co-leads in their support to IM and Analysis for their clusters.
- The decentralized management approach to IM and Analysis within and outside of OCHA impede the rationalization of OCHA's leadership and coordination role, leading to the proliferation of working groups, delayed updates to global guidance, and limitations to the successful inclusion of complementary actors, such as specialist NGOs.

Finding 13. Respondents expect OCHA to take leadership in five dimensions: strategic direction, supporting coordination, supporting rapid deployment, supporting IM capacity building, and overseeing data quality and management.

99. The keyword themes from transcripts define an ideal state of OCHA's leadership and coordination for IM based on five dimensions:

- i. Defining the strategic direction for IM,
- ii. Supporting inter-cluster and cross-sectoral coordination,
- iii. Supporting rapid deployment in sudden onset emergencies and in circumstances of reduced capacity,
- iv. Supporting IM capacity building for the humanitarian community, and
- v. Overseeing data quality and ethical data management considerations (see Figure 9).

Figure 9: Keyword Themes – Leadership and Coordination



Source: RT development based on interview transcripts

100. A narrative combining these keyword clusters further highlights the management of core platforms and tools for the humanitarian community and OCHA's role as an advocacy for necessary funding. These can form one part of a basis of a new vision for data, IM and analysis in a new IM and Analysis strategy for OCHA:

"OCHA functions as a strong, central leader in IM, responsible for setting strategic direction for IM, standardizing data practices, and ensuring a unified approach to IM across clusters. OCHA's leadership prioritizes high-quality data, cross-sectoral coordination, rapid IM deployment, and comprehensive support for field offices. In addition to providing core platforms and tools, OCHA builds IM capacity, advocates for necessary funding, and ensures ethical and transparent data management. OCHA is a trusted IM authority, seen as fostering coherence, transparency, and accountability in humanitarian data management and analysis."

Finding 14. Respondents distinguish between OCHA's leadership and coordination roles with the former related to data analytics and the latter to analysis and decision making.

101. Respondents distinguish between OCHA's leadership roles and OCHA's coordination roles. The ToR for the review combined the two dimensions of coordination and leadership. However, these are distinct forms of engagement. Because OCHA has no specific leverage over Agencies, clusters, or NGOs within a response, *leadership* was not discussed in terms of enforcing compliance but of promoting a particular stance, standards, or agreements. Leadership was also cited when discussing the ownership or management of specific products. The term *coordination*, in contrast, was usually used by stakeholders when OCHA was expected to broker consensus or agreements among humanitarian agencies or to ensure that a process was carried out by others, such as needs assessments conducted by clusters within humanitarian responses.
102. The primary patterns appear to be an expectation from respondents that OCHA provides leadership in elements related to data analytics and is expected to provide coordination in elements related to analysis and decision-making. For example, there is an expectation that OCHA provides leadership in defining a strategic direction, setting global standards, driving innovation and championing accountability in humanitarian data and IM practices. This includes managing critical platforms (such as HDX or FTS).

103. Coordination entails ensuring that Agencies, clusters, and NGOs align their efforts to shared goals. OCHA coordinates: data collection, harmonizes methodologies, and ensures interoperability among diverse actors. It is noteworthy that not all elements on which OCHA could lead, or coordinate are cited by respondents. Table 8 illustrates respondent perceptions regarding elements for expected leadership and roles of expected coordination from stakeholders.

Table 8: Respondent Citations expected OCHA leadership and OCHA Coordination

Dimension	Expected Leadership Role	Expected Coordination Role
Strategic Leadership	- Set the overall vision for the IM process in humanitarian response - Develop a unified IM strategy for the humanitarian system - Lead innovation around emergent technologies (such as Artificial Intelligence)	Promote best practices
Inter-Agency Spaces	- Lead joint-initiatives - Promote partnerships with NGOs and other actors	- Support IM coordination - Ensure cross-sectoral and inter-cluster harmonization
Data Management	- Own key platforms (HDX, FTS, 5W, Relief Web, GMS) - Develop customizable tools - Set data quality standards	- Champion open data policies - Ensure inter-agency data sharing - Ensure ethical data management
Analysis and Monitoring	- Lead the HNO/HRP/HNRP processes - Provide real-time situation and response monitoring - Ensure cross-sectoral data integration - Lead inter-sectoral analysis	- Support sectoral analysis - Support early warning systems
IM Funding	Secure IM resourcing	Mobilize IM surge capacity

Source: RT development based on interview transcripts

Finding 15. In the absence of an external coordination strategy within a humanitarian IM and analysis strategy, individual responses are susceptible to leadership or agency conditions, creating four sets of competing pressures that require individual navigation.

104. The absence of an IM and Analysis strategy or other documentation clarifying the expectations regarding the degree to which OCHA should provide leadership versus coordination on issues, alongside the degree to which external stakeholders expected OCHA to fill gaps in the system, enables this diversity of views. Table 9 below shows the range of expectations on OCHA leadership role by stakeholder group.

Table 9: Stakeholder Expectations for OCHA Leadership

Stakeholder	Expected OCHA Roles	Highest Weighted Issue
OCHA HQ	Strategic IM vision, Anticipatory and predictive analysis, performance monitoring, Setting clear vision for IM which aligns global, regional, and country priorities Developing a unified and strategic approach	Setting clear vision for IM which aligns global, regional, and country priorities Developing a unified and strategic approach
Donors	Advocacy through data, resource allocation transparency, providing global standards, highlighting funding gaps, identifying unmet needs	Highlighting funding gaps and unmet needs
Inter-Agency Stakeholders	Coordination across agencies, harmonizing data collection practices, ensuring multi-sectoral data integration. Facilitating	Facilitating data sharing and data standardization across agencies.

	data sharing and data standardization across agencies.	
HCTs	Operational coordination – aligning data priorities, HNRP oversight, capacity development, data transparency and sharing. Ensuring operational effectiveness through alignment	Ensuring operational effectiveness through alignment of plans, resources, and implementation.
Cluster Leads/Sectors	Leadership in standardization, harmonize methodologies across sectors, ensure inter-cluster data sharing, support sector-specific analytical support.	Ensuring consistent data standards across clusters Lead data sharing among clusters
Country offices	Localized IM support – tailoring to context needs, lead on access constraints, lead on real-time data collection. Develop a common understanding of what data analysis is needed and aligned with priorities as highlighted in OCHA HQ.	Contextualized IM tools and services
Operational NGOs	Leadership in collecting and disseminating protection related data, integration of conflict-sensitive data into IM frameworks, ensure ethical data governance	Leading collection, analysis, and dissemination of response-related data

Source: Respondent interviews, analysed by Review Team

105. In addition to the diversity of stakeholder expectations on leadership and coordination, the absence of an external coordination strategy within OCHA led to individual responses being highly dependent on the specific three leadership and agency conditions and created a set of competing pressures that systemic factors led to the systemic factors are:

- i. sensitivity to leadership conditions;
- ii. sensitivity to agency conditions, and
- iii. sensitivity to IM as serving both an enabling and standalone function within OCHA architecture.

106. The competing pressures are balancing

- i. Standardization versus flexibility,
- ii. Rigor versus “lightness”,
- iii. Cost-benefit of excessive granularity, and
- iv. Inter-agency obligations versus filling-gaps.

Factor 1: Sensitive Dependence on Leadership Conditions.

107. Among country offices, there is substantive variation in the OCHA IM structure, its integration into the humanitarian system, and overall capacity for effective IM and Analysis. For example, according to internal OCHA documentation, the number of IM roles in a country office across the current responses varied from 1 to 14 with more than 50 distinct job titles among these offices.

108. There was no standardized mapping or analysis of IM capacities within a particular response, including an assessment of the data availability within the humanitarian system or a plan for covering any IM gaps. While there were examples cited by respondents of some countries doing this mapping systematically, it was more often ad hoc and informal.

109. There were also significant variations regarding the expectations on the IMOs in country programmes ranging from “filling in excel sheets” to doing complex analysis and sitting in on the highest levels of decision-making. Additionally, there were variations in the linkages between the IMWG and AAWG, with the rest of the cluster system. Sometimes the IMWGs were integrated into the cluster system, in other countries they were working in parallel processes or disconnected.

IMWG membership also varied significantly with some countries involving only the Cluster IMOs while others included Agency IMOs or NGO representatives as well.

110. The most common phrase explaining the degree of country variations from all interviews was “*it depends on the leadership*”. There were three leadership positions that particularly influenced the quality of the IM system in the country: the RC/HC, the OCHA Head of Office (HOO), and the ICCG chair.

111. Transitions between leadership in these three roles were seen to have a significant effect on the degree of IM integration and resourcing in a country response. Due to the lack of established and widespread standards and systems for IM, even short-term institutional gaps in these leadership roles could have long-term consequences for IM in a country.

112. As one respondent noted:

“When there are coordination gaps (for IM), we (the humanitarian community) will create workarounds, which then become bad habits (that impeded smooth coordination for IM)”.

113. In addition, resource constraints, as a result of leadership prioritization, were also seen as impeding OCHA’s capacity to drive innovation at the country office, regional or global levels.

Factor 2: Sensitive dependence on Agency (and cluster) conditions.

114. The second systemic factor cited by respondents involved the challenges related to the larger structural conditions of the humanitarian community in terms of the relationship of OCHA to clusters and agencies. First, tensions among the agencies - especially the larger, more autonomous agencies- were identified as creating significant challenges for OCHA in ensuring smooth coordination within a particular response. Respondents noted that, in some cases, OCHA’s convening and coordination role was acknowledged by agencies, but not always respected. This led to circumstances where respondents perceived the coordination as reactive rather than strategic.

115. Second, there were significant variations in terms of the degree of agency co-leads in their support to IM and Analysis for their clusters. OCHA’s annual coordination mapping shows that only about half of national level clusters have a dedicated IMO (which are funded by the lead agency for the cluster or included as surge support specialist NGOs such as iMMAP) and less than 10 percent of subnational clusters have a dedicated IMO (also to be funded by the lead agency for the cluster). Table 10 shows the last three years of coordination mapping for IMOs in the Clusters globally.

Table 10: Number and Percentage of Clusters with dedicated IMO Support

Type of IM Support	2021	2022	2023
National Clusters	N=305	N=294	N=275
Dedicated	44%	45%	52%
Partial	12%	14%	12%
Double-hatting	24%	24%	20%
Vacant/No position	20%	17%	16%
Subnational Clusters	N = 1134	N=1011	N = 1153
Dedicated	6%	6%	8%
Partial	2%	4%	1%
Double-hatting	10%	14%	12%
Vacant/No position	83%	77%	79%

Source: OCHA Coordination Mapping Exercise, 2021-2023

116. The degree of attention agencies provided to the clusters had two important implications for OCHA. First, there was an implicit assumption from respondents that OCHA would be expected to fill any IM and Analysis gaps left by agencies and to provide the necessary IM support to the

clusters. This led to additional strains on OCHA IM teams in countries. Furthermore, when the IM capacity within a cluster was weak, this affected the quality of the cluster-specific analysis and the sectoral products which in turn affected the quality of the inter-cluster analysis and joint exercises that OCHA was expected to lead.

117. A common example cited by respondents in country offices that illustrates these challenges pertained to responding to sudden onset emergencies. Respondents consistently noted that timely needs assessment data was a persistent challenge within the humanitarian system. Respondents did note that “*OCHA’s personality changes when there is a sudden response*”; perceiving a greater degree of proactiveness, albeit with fewer standardized processes. However, a significant barrier to timely needs assessment was the degree to which each cluster was prepared to include its cluster-specific information on joint needs assessments ahead of time. When the clusters were unprepared, then the entire process was delayed before joint needs assessment could be done.

Factor 3: Sensitive dependence on IM as an enabling function.

118. The third factor influencing IM and Analysis leadership and coordination conditions pertained to the systemic challenges of a decentralized management approach to IM and Analysis within and outside of OCHA. As noted earlier, because the IM and Analysis function is foundational to a wide range of branches and services within OCHA, including coordination, access and humanitarian financing, this has led to a highly decentralized IM and Analysis structure within OCHA with IM and Analysis units integrated into multiple divisions, branches, and sectors and no single “leader” of the IM and Analysis sector within OCHA.
119. The IM and Analysis function is also foundational within any specific humanitarian response with each cluster, Agency, NGO and HCT relying on information and analysis for decision-making, planning and implementation. This cross-cutting nature of the IM and Analysis function leads to a highly dispersed IM and Analysis structure within the larger humanitarian response structure as agencies and clusters have their own embedded IM and Analysis functions and have developed their own tools and platforms for informing their programming.
120. The consequences of this dispersed IM function both internal to OCHA and within the larger humanitarian responses creates systemic challenges for developing a unified and coherent IM and Analysis approach – both within OCHA and externally for the entire humanitarian system.
121. The systemic factors have created a cascade effect leading to the proliferation of working groups, delayed updates to global guidance, and limitations to the successful inclusion of complementary actors, such as specialist NGOs.
122. Proliferation of working groups for IM and Analysis. The proliferation of working groups created two challenges. First, respondents reported that the multiplicity of working groups created challenges for effective coordination as sometimes the groups might work at cross-purposes. Second, the groups also tended to become too large, hindering effective decision making. The quantity and size of the groups then led to sporadic engagement of stakeholders within any particular group, resulting in languishing initiatives and multiple interpretations of the purpose of each group. One example cited pertained to the linkages between the GIS sub-working group at the global level and the IMWG. This was exacerbated by transitions in leadership and re-definitions of the roles of the groups.
123. Delays updating global guidance and standards. There are a wide range of guidance for specific processes and tools – such as the JIAF, the HPC, or financial tracking. However, there are limitations in terms of the global guidance for overarching IM functions. While there is global guidance developed by OCHA for IM within the humanitarian system, some of the guidance has not been updated since 2008. This affected stakeholder awareness of, and attention to, the available guidance, resulting in diverse sets of self-developed expectations from stakeholders regarding OCHA’s leadership and coordination roles.

124. A further complication noted by stakeholders related to the fact that the guidance was developed by OCHA globally but ultimately carried out by OCHA country offices, clusters and their member Agencies. These entities felt that there was sometimes insufficient consultation with external actors in the development of this guidance.
125. Limitations on strategic and timely engagement with complementary actors, such as the specialist NGOs. As discussed above, there has been an increase in the number and size of NGOs with specialist functions for data collection, analysis, or monitoring within IM. Respondents agreed that these specialist NGO actors are now present and have a demonstrated capacity for supporting IM functions.
126. There were multiple examples cited from country offices regarding strategic engagement with these NGOs for positive outcomes. The examples ranged from relying on these NGOs to provide IM capacity support to drawing on the NGO expertise to develop more sophisticated analysis of response outcomes. However, the lack of sufficient resources to engage these agencies combined with the absence of a current system-wide mapping or structure for integrating and coordinating the work of these NGO actors within the IM function has resulted in ad hoc and episodic collaborations and a great deal of variation among country responses in terms of their inclusion. For example, although these NGO actors were significant IM stakeholders, they were usually not included in the IMWGs within country responses.
127. The result was a simultaneous perception from stakeholders (not only NGO actors) of these NGOs as being crucial for IM support but also marginalized from IM coordination processes and, as a result, both an opportunity and a threat to a coherent humanitarian response.

Finding 16: Positive examples of OCHA leadership and Coordination for IM and Analysis are dependent on individual actions in specific responses.

128. Respondents cited individual positive examples of OCHA leadership and coordination, focusing on convening spaces, guidance and protocols, and positive improvisation by country offices. These examples were less systemic in nature and more reflections of positive outcomes driven by individuals taking initiatives within the system and showing willingness to address a specific issue.
129. For example, structures promoting convening spaces exist including the IMWG, the GIFT, the Technology Governance Board and the CHD. However, how these are applied vary from country to country. For example, in some countries, respondents cited the leadership of the IMWG in promoting IM leadership and coordination in a humanitarian response, but in other countries, respondents considered the IMWG to be marginalized with little influence on the humanitarian response. Respondents noted that these bodies, especially the IMWG and the GIFT, have evolved towards being primarily for information sharing or activated for specific problem solving, but respondents emphasized their potential for providing more structured leadership in IM.
130. In terms of the development of tools and standards, there were positive examples of OCHA leadership on the elaboration of guidance and protocols for specific platforms, tools or processes, such as for those included in the HPC and the JIAF updates.¹² However, the quality of the guidance and protocols varied from tool to tool and platform to platform and respondents were not aware of any overarching guidance or standard informing the entire IM process. Regarding country office improvisations, multiple positive examples were shared regarding how a particular country office was able to successfully coordinate data sharing, advocacy, multi-cluster analysis, tool development and supporting IM capacity. However, these varied from country to country. Improvisation examples usually involved the adaptation or development of tools or products to fit specific needs in the humanitarian response, or organizing working groups within the humanitarian response to address specific challenges arising.

¹² There were challenges in rollouts due to innovation fatigue which is covered in the Platforms, Process and Tools dimension.

5.4 Organizational Implications

Review Questions: What, if any, organizational shifts, including capacities and resources, does OCHA need to achieve the necessary common data platforms, answer analytic offerings and successfully coordinate IM services?

Summary of findings:

What organizational shifts does OCHA need to achieve the necessary data platforms, answer analytic offerings and coordinate IM services?

- The IM and analysis function within OCHA has become increasingly dispersed across the organization with IM and analysis units integrated into multiple discrete branches and divisions.
- Externally, there has also been an increase in IM and analysis capacities of Agencies, and the rise of specialist NGOs engaged in data collection or analysis.
- There is an appetite for increased strategic rationalization of the IM and Analysis function among respondents with a clarification of global, regional and country IM roles under a coherent HQ IM leadership or governance structure
- There is broad interest for OCHA support to increasingly specialized functions (analysis, surge capacity, data quality assurance, etc) and promoting an organizational cultural which emphasizes both innovation and standards

Key challenges:

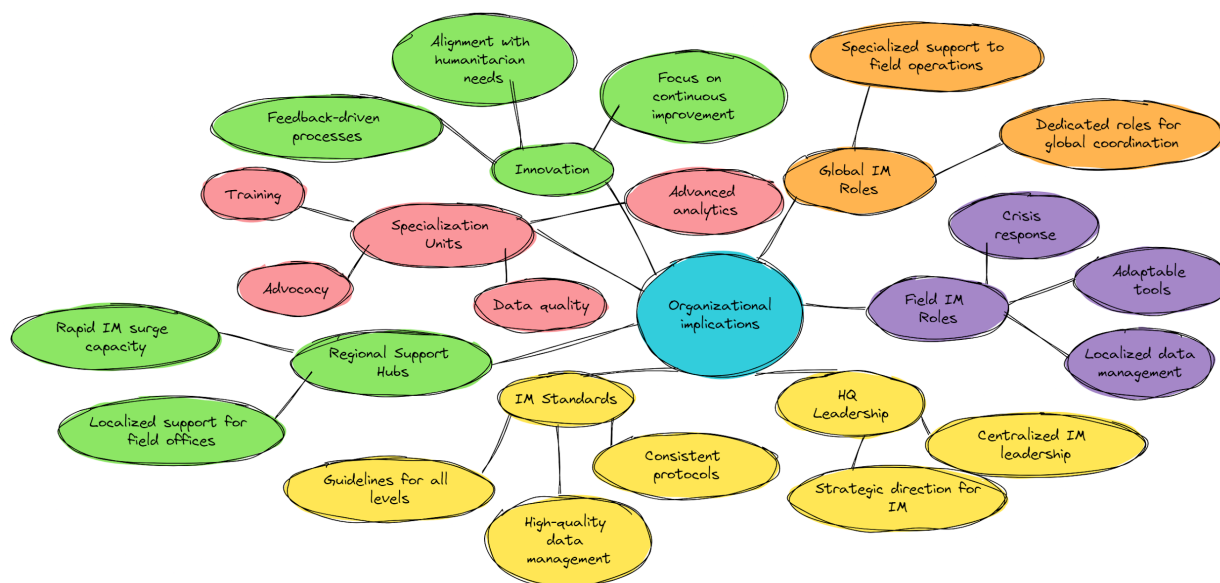
- The decentralized IM and Analysis structure and resourcing allocation processes impede the rationalization of strategic planning processes for IM and Analysis and create perverse incentives that impede collective action

Finding 17. Respondents identified three key areas of focus to enable OCHA to meet the expectations of the humanitarian community.

131. Respondents focused on three overarching themes for OCHA. A keyword exercise regarding the ideal state of organizational considerations based on respondent perceptions identified three overarching themes distributed across seven clusters (See Figure 10):

- OCHA leadership should create a distinction and clarification of global, regional and country IM roles - under a coherent HQ IM leadership or governance structure
- OCHA should support increasingly specialized functions within IM and Analysis (analysis, surge capacity, data quality assurance, etc)
- OCHA should promote an organizational cultural which emphasizes both innovation and standards

Figure 10: Keyword Themes – Organizational Implications



Source: RT development based on interview transcripts

132. A narrative based on the keywords places an emphasis on OCHA expertise, but also notes a desire for both standardization and adaptability. These can form one part of a basis of a new vision for data, IM and analysis in a new IM and Analysis strategy for OCHA:

“The ideal OCHA organizational structure for supporting IM would involve a well-defined hierarchy with a coherent leadership structure at HQ to coordinate dispersed IM functions, the establishment of regional support hubs, and dedicated IM roles at global, regional, and country levels. This structure emphasizes specialized units for carrying out specific IM tasks and effective coordination between them with units dedicated to data quality, advanced analytics, training, and advocacy. Clear IM standards and protocols would guide operations across all levels, ensuring consistent, high-quality data management and analysis. Country offices would benefit from specialized support from NGO and other local actors, employ adaptable tools, and be able to rely on rapid IM surge capacity for crises, while a focus on innovation and continuous feedback would keep OCHA’s IM practices aligned with the evolving needs of the humanitarian community”.

133. Stakeholder classes prioritized different elements of OCHA’s organizational priorities (Table 11). The combination of these considerations suggest that in order to support the previously described areas of focus, OCHA should have: i) a cohesive IM strategy that aligns global, regional, and country priorities; ii) systems that present granular financial information and data-sharing; and iii) IM focal points and sufficient resourcing and expertise to lead customizing global tools for specific humanitarian response needs.

Table 11: Stakeholder Perceptions of OCHA Organizational Priorities

Stakeholder	Priorities	Highest Weighting
OCHA HQ	Development of overarching strategic vision for IM, developing metrics to evaluate the effectiveness of IM tools, platforms, and coordination efforts, leading innovation on IM technologies	Cohesive IM strategy that aligns global, regional and country IM priorities
Donors	Granular financial data reporting, data driven advocacy, dedicated IM funding streams	Enhancing FTS to include detailed, real-time data on funding flows and gaps.

Inter-Agency Stakeholders	Improved data sharing protocols; harmonized data standards across agencies; capacity for cross-sectoral analysis	Data sharing
HCTs	Alignment of global standards with country realities; increase number of IM officers to collect and analyse data effectively, develop tailored tools	Ensuring alignment of global IM priorities and individual humanitarian response operations
Cluster Leads/Sectors	Improved platform usability; dedicated IM roles per cluster; standardization and interoperability	Dedicated IM focal points for tailored sectoral support and analysis
Country offices	Surge capacity for IM in emergencies, technical support to customize global tools for local contexts, improved data collection systems	Providing resources and expertise to customize global IM tools for local contexts
Operational NGOs	Enhanced protection data analysis; integration of protection data; conflict sensitive IM practices	Ensuring protection data is represented in multi-sectoral platforms and decision making

Source: RT development based on interview transcripts

Finding 18: The evolution of processes and technologies has created increasing and more sophisticated demands on OCHA IM and Analysis staff.

134. There has been an evolution of processes and products. Examples cited included standardization efforts for data sharing, developing and streamlining joint methodologies, and increasing capacities and skills in information management staff. At the same time, respondents noted that this progress was often inconsistent across time and space. Respondents could cite a wide gamut of positive examples of ongoing initiatives within OCHA to improve institutional process, albeit via individual champions. This included the emergence of entities for improved coherence – such as the emerging Technology Governance Board, and the CHD; examples of improved capacity development – such as citations regarding formalized IM training, examples of externalizing IM capacity via standby partners, NGO specialization; and best practices in shared management – such as the shared management of IM functions (as in the case of the Country Datasets and Population Statistics datasets by the United Nations Population Fund). An important consideration is that this gamut of improved practices were not connected within a larger strategic framework or roadmap, but were dependent on individual branches, sectors, or individuals emphasizing these initiatives.

135. The diversity of priorities, evolution in technology, and changes in overall data literacy have led to increased expectations on OCHA's IMOs. There has been an evolving expectation from external stakeholders on OCHA and IMOs. This includes expectations of IMOs to have increased capacities to provide a range of services such as higher-level analysis, leadership in data standards, and responding to ad hoc requests. Many of these external stakeholder expectations pertained to the “gap-filling” role – as new technologies emerged or as new issues arose within the humanitarian response community, there was an increasing desire from respondents for OCHA to cover these gaps. As a consequence, across the interviews, respondents cited 22 different skills sets covering 8 dimensions that were deemed as crucial for IMOs:

- Technical and data management
- Analytical and problem solving
- Sector specific knowledge and contextual awareness
- Coordination and communication
- Standards in data protection and ethical management
- Training and capacity building
- Project and time management
- Adaptability to technology advances

136. There is a general guidance on the expected skillsets of the IMOs including a range of job titles.¹³ However, this has not been updated recently and does not include all of these expected skillsets described by stakeholders. Nor is this guidance followed consistently - as evidenced by the more than 50 different job titles in the OCHA IM spreadsheets from country offices (referenced in the Leadership and Coordination Section).
137. Information overload and data fatigue have also increased expectations for OCHA IMOs. The proliferation of data and information cited earlier has led to respondents requesting for OCHA to “help make sense” of the data and the related surging interest across the humanitarian systems for “telling better stories from the data”. This is likely also associated with the IAHE recommendations related to making better use of qualitative data to “deepen the insights and understandings” of the responses.
138. Simultaneously, respondents noted that, while there are increasing expectations on IMOs, there are perverse incentives limiting the expansion of IMO capacities. These evolving expectations on the IMOs are not always reflected in the job descriptions for IMOs, in the associated capacity building initiatives, nor in the allocation of resources to staffing. Respondents reported limited career progression opportunities at CO and RO levels for IMOs, leading to long-term staffing challenges.

Finding 19: The decentralized structure of IM and Analysis within OCHA and the resourcing allocation processes impede the rationalization of strategic planning for IM and Analysis and creating perverse incentives impeding collective action.

139. **Factor 1: The decentralized IM and Analysis structure within OCHA.** The decentralized structure also leads to an under-representation of IM and Analysis as a sector within the OCHA Strategic Plan and associated KPIs. In contrast to the other pillars of OCHA, there is no separate IM and Analysis strategy for OCHA or an IM and Analysis road map to operationalize a strategic vision for OCHA IM and Analysis. Consequently, IM-related workplans are developed in isolation from each other – only being linked to the Strategic Plan. Finally, the dispersed nature of IM means that there is no overall mechanism for ensuring coherence in IM and Analysis functioning across the organization. In addition, the enabling function leads to IM being under-represented as a sector at senior leadership level compared to other pillars.¹⁴ There is an appetite within OCHA for a mechanism that strengthens strategic oversight and senior leadership representation of IM and Analysis as seen in the interviews where respondents frequently made suggestions for creating new staffing levels (such as a COO or a D2) or creating an intermediate level between IM and Analysis and senior leadership to represent collective IM and analysis interests within OCHA.
140. **Factor 2: Resourcing allocation processes lead to a disconnect between strategic plans, workplans and budgets.** Resourcing decisions for IM are led by senior leadership, where IM is under-represented. In addition, workplans are developed in a separate process from the resource allocation process. As a consequence, resourcing is often insufficient to achieve IM-related workplans. This situation creates a cascade of perverse incentives including seeking short-term special project funding to cover gaps in the workplans. This leads to the creation of isolated and fragmented tools, platforms and products. The short-term nature of the funding then leads to sustainability challenges to sustain these tools which leads to territorial in-fighting to maintain resourcing for tools. The resourcing processes also inhibit OCHA's capacity to keep up with innovation or to pilot emerging technologies, leading to isolated initiatives or outsourcing.
141. The resulting structure creates perverse incentives impeding the development of a unified IM and Analysis strategy or governance mechanism. As noted earlier, the previous evaluations or reviews have consistently recommended the establishment of some mechanism for strategic leadership of IM and Analysis within OCHA. These recommendations have not been acted on because of the challenges embedded in the current structure. The development of a global guidance or IM and Analysis strategy is impeded because the resulting IM and Analysis structure, or

¹³ <https://humanitarian.atlassian.net/wiki/spaces/imtoolbox/pages/221315247/OCHA+IM+Skillsets+and+Roles>

¹⁴ While the IMB Chief is a member of the OCHA SLG, the IMB Chief is representing IMB, not the IM and Analysis function within OCHA.

ecosystem, creates perverse incentives for individual IM and Analysis units. The current structure may lead to a fragmented structure, but the individual IM and Analysis sectors, units or departments do benefit from this fragmentation because they are able to function autonomously and provide concentrated focus on their specific IM and Analysis needs. This includes the development of any necessary tools or platforms to meet those needs. A unified IM and Analysis strategy would reduce this level of autonomy. Therefore, the collective will that is required for a decentralized system to develop a unified strategy is impeded by the potential adverse effect this strategic framework would have on the individual units that are needed to be involved in the development of the framework.

6 Conclusions and Recommendations

6.1 Conclusions

142. **Conclusion 1: Challenges for IM and Analysis are persistent across time within OCHA suggesting systemic issues.** There has been a long history of reviews, evaluations and audits citing similar challenges, suggesting systemic drivers. Recommendations from previous exercises can be clustered into six thematic categories:

1. Leadership and governance for IM and Analysis
2. Data quality and standardization
3. Data platforms and technology adaptations
4. Capacity building and training systems for IM and Analysis
5. Improved stakeholder engagement and communication for IM and Analysis
6. Ethics, privacy, and accountability considerations for IM and Analysis

143. A common observation among respondents has been to emphasize that there is a “lack of leadership and vision in OCHA related to IM and Analysis. However, there are underlying factors which create this situation. The implication of these recurrent patterns in recommendations is that the challenges for OCHA IM and Analysis are related to systemic factors within the organization. These have been noted throughout and include: the integration of IM and Analysis units into multiple divisions, branches, and sectors each with their own governance structure and a resourcing structure that creates perverse incentives for fragmentation. In combination with the diverse data, information and analysis needs of different external stakeholder groups, these factors lead to a fragmented and underfunded IM and Analysis structure within OCHA with perverse incentives impeding a coherent IM strategic vision.

144. **Conclusion 2: Fragmentation and proliferation are the natural results of the current OCHA IM and Analysis structure.** The three principal systemic factors which exist, in combination, create a cascade effect impeding the coherence of the OCHA IM and Analysis structure and creates pressures towards a fragmented structure and the unmonitored proliferation of tools and products:

145. Resourcing frameworks and perverse incentives. The way funding envelopes are allocated within the Secretariat creates perverse incentives leading to a dispersed and fragmented IM and Analysis structure. The combination of fixed envelopes and special projects depresses the incentives of branches to seek strategic funding (as it will not increase their envelope) and increases the incentives for individuals to seek special project funding (and later compete with other units to get “their” special project moved to PSC). This combination creates an environment of fragmented competition with limited incentives for strategic collaboration.

146. IM function as a cross-cutting function. The IM function is foundational to a wide range of branches and services internal and external to OCHA. Combined with the fragmenting resourcing pressures cited above, the enabling nature of the IM function leads to a situation of a highly decentralized structure with IM and Analysis units integrated across multiple branches, units, and entities – with no single “leader” of IM. Consequently, while the enabling function of IM and Analysis has allowed IM and Analysis to retain a crucial link between IM and Analysis and the functions supported (such as Coordination or Financing) has created systemic challenges in developing a

unified and coherent IM and Analysis approach. This then leads to institutional bottlenecks to develop an overarching IM and Analysis strategy.

147. Absence of an IM and Analysis Strategy. The decentralized IM and Analysis structure within OCHA and the subsequent limitations of building an overarching IM and Analysis strategy for OCHA leads to a situation where there are contradictory stakeholders expectations of the IM and Analysis role for OCHA and to “self-defined functions” – individual IM and Analysis units or entities within OCHA determining for themselves what the boundaries of their mandates may be. This creates a situation wherein stakeholders may have differing expectations of the respective roles and responsibilities of the multiple units within the IM and Analysis ecosystem and, at the same time, a lack of strategic clarity to develop a shared understanding of roles and responsibilities across the system.
148. The cascade effect of these drivers leads to a fragmented and under-funded IM and Analysis architecture with limited options for establishing a clear and shared understanding regarding the roles of IM and Analysis, reporting lines, core analytical questions to be answered and core platforms required. There have been attempts to address fragmentation and proliferation such as the creation of the Technology Governance Board but more needs to be done.
149. **Conclusion 3: The lack of an IM and Analysis strategy or framework leads to a diversity of stakeholder expectations for IM and Analysis both within and external to OCHA.** A common pattern emerging throughout the analysis of the various review dimensions is the emergence of a wide range of stakeholder expectations regarding OCHA's role in IM and analysis due to the absence of a common framework. This includes competing and contradictory data needs, including the previously cited example of the global need for standardized data aggregation versus country responses requiring highly contextualized, adaptive and highly granular data needs.
150. Stakeholders within the humanitarian response system are primarily focused on the IM and analysis function with respect to the HPC phases of needs assessment, context analysis and resourcing components. There is recognition that more could be done related to more sophisticated levels of analysis or related to outcome levels of humanitarian responses, but the absence of a common analytical framework impedes developing a coherent IM and Analysis function within a particular response. The emergence of specialist NGOs for IM and analysis present an opportunity for ensuring a coherent suite of IM and analysis products. However, there is no common framework for partnering with these specialist NGOs, leading to challenges in inclusion in existing processes and working groups.
151. **Conclusion 4: There are frequent examples of ongoing individual initiatives to improve IM and Analysis functioning.** Respondents frequently cited successes and referenced ongoing processes intended to improve IM functioning at global, regional or CO levels. This could range from the development of analytic tools for real-time data tracking, rolling out joint analysis frameworks, or specific innovations. One predominant example was the recently created Technology Governance Board which is mandated to review existing platforms and tools and seek to reduce duplications and create more efficient protocols for platform development (the current spreadsheet inventory developed by the board can be found in Annex 8.1). Three general patterns in the positive citations emerged which are relevant to all four dimensions under review.
152. Pattern 1 – Champions: Challenges are perceived to be rooted in systemic issues while successes rely on individual initiatives. One common pattern to examples provided to improve IM functioning is that these were often dependent on individual initiatives or champions to move successes forward through the development, resourcing, scale-up or promotion. Even larger institutional tools such as the HPC tools or the CHD were perceived as relying on the efforts of specific individuals. However, some of these same examples then languished when these individuals moved on, highlighting the risks of reliance on individual champions.
153. Pattern 2 – Progress is evolutionary, but not linear. There was a consensus among respondents that there has been an evolution of processes and products over the years. Examples cited included

standardization efforts for data sharing, developing and streamlining joint methodologies, and increasing capacities and skills in information management staff. At the same time, respondents noted that this progress was often inconsistent across time and space. Connected to Pattern 1, progress was often driven by individual champions without the systematic institutional support to ensure continuity. For example, the relative capacity of the IM function at country-level fluctuated significantly over time. In some periods, the IM function operated well, with many staff and support from the senior leadership. In subsequent years, the same IM function would suddenly decline (for a variety of factors described in the following narrative). This inconsistency raised concerns among external stakeholders regarding the consistency, continuity and frequency of existing products.

154. **Pattern 3 – Competing pressures between global and local needs.** An important theme influencing both the successes and challenges across the dimensions of the review pertained to the tension between the need at the global level for data aggregation and standardization and the need at country levels for highly contextualized and adapted tools to fit the particularities of each response. Respondents were just as likely to cite successes towards each pressure. For example, the development of HPC tools or the use of the FTS for global aggregation were seen as positive examples supporting aggregation and standardization needs. At the same time, other respondents cited positive successes related to country-level tool development.
155. **Conclusion 5: The OCHA IM and Analysis functioning in any particular humanitarian response is highly dependent on individual leadership, and agency conditions.** The quality of IM and Analysis within a highly decentralized structure, with no clear strategy or roadmap, and diverse stakeholder expectations, ends up relying heavily on the individual leadership, and agency priorities. The quality of IM and Analysis within any specific humanitarian response is dependent on the leadership's priorities at the HC/RC, HOO, and ICCG levels as well as the agencies' support for their clusters. Without clear mandates, humanitarian actors create "workarounds" to meet their IM and Analysis needs, leading to potential long-term "bad habits." This results in extensive variation among country offices and humanitarian responses regarding IM and Analysis capacity, coordination, analytical products, and utilization.
156. **Conclusion 6: There is a need to distinguish OCHA's inter-agency obligations from expectations that OCHA should fill gaps left by agencies and clusters.** Throughout the review dimensions, respondents noted tensions between expectations on OCHA to provide leadership and coordination within the inter-agency spaces and the expectation that OCHA should fill gaps when agencies do not cover them. A common example pertained to the degree of responsibility of OCHA to provide IM capacity to specific clusters when the lead agency of the cluster refuses to fund an IMO for the cluster. Additionally, stakeholders expected OCHA to fill gaps related to emergent issues which do not fall within a specific Agency mandate such as cash, climate change, or anticipatory action.
157. Finally, expectations also extended to OCHA filling gaps pertaining to technological changes and rising expectations on IM for more sophisticated, yet simpler analysis. There were divergences between internal and external expectations on OCHA's obligations to fill current and future gaps. The default expectation from non-OCHA respondents is that OCHA would be expected to take the lead in filling these gaps in Agency non-compliance, emergent themes, or new technologies (alongside the more sophisticated analysis that non-OCHA stakeholders were expecting due to technological advances). In contrast, OCHA stakeholders do not share this view that the gap-filling expectation should be part of the expectations of stakeholders on OCHA. These combined factors have led to situations where the IMO mandates, capacities and resources are not always aligned with the evolving nature of the function, requiring more leadership, innovation and clarity regarding roles and expectations. The lack of an IM strategy for OCHA reduces the capacity of the organization to address and resolve these disparate expectations between internal and external stakeholders on OCHA filling gaps in the system.

6.2 Recommendations

158. The following table provides a list of the primary recommendations, and associated most relevant key actions, emerging from this review. The eight recommendations are aligned to consider the three levels described in Figure 4 – the humanitarian IM and Analysis Ecosystem (Recommendation 7), the OCHA internal IM and Analysis ecosystem (Recommendations 1, 2, 3, 4, 5), and OCHA's external coordination role (Recommendations 6, 8). A detailed action plan for each recommendation is outlined in Annex 9 as well as two sets of tables linking findings to conclusions to recommendations.

Table 12: Recommendations

#	Recommendation	Key Actions	Thematic Focus	Priority External & Internal	Timeframe and Responsibility
1	Recommendation 1: Establish an OCHA cross-branch governance mechanism for Information Management and Analysis (IM&A) under the authority of OCHA senior leadership at the ASG level. This governance mechanism would ensure strategic oversight, coherence, and accountability for IM&A activities across all levels of OCHA, aligning with the OCHA Strategic Plan and the UN Secretary General Data Strategy .	• Leadership & Management: Governance mechanism would operate under OCHA senior leadership at the ASG level, supported by a dedicated senior focal point and/or cross-branch steering team responsible for driving the governance work, and ensuring adherence to the IM&A strategy. • Cross-Branch Coordination: Serve as a forum and convene meetings to harmonize IM&A priorities and resolve systemic challenges such as resource fragmentation and siloed tool and platform development. • Integration & Linkages: Formalize relation of the Technology Governance Board into the IM&A governance mechanism, and the relation of OCHA regional and country offices to ensure alignment and minimize redundancies. • Strategic Coherence: Oversee the development and roll out of an OCHA global IM&A strategy, roadmap and resourcing strategy with clear benchmarks and guidelines, ensuring coherence and alignment across OCHA's diverse IM&A functions and levels.	Governance	High Internal	Immediate Lead: ASG office Support: IMB, APMB.
2	Recommendation 2: Develop an Organizational IM&A Strategy to guide OCHA's IM functions, aligned with the OCHA Strategic Plan and addressing both internal and external requirements. This strategy should ensure coherence, efficiency, and alignment of IM&A activities across all levels of the organization	• Vision: Define OCHA's overarching vision for IM and Analysis, highlighting its role as an enabler for coordination, advocacy, and decision-making. • Roles and Responsibilities: Internally, define how the IM&A functions within OCHA's branches, sections and levels should work together for a unified IM&A outcomes. • Analytical Framework: Develop an OCHA analytical framework that defines a clear direction for analysis including roles and coordination with external humanitarian actors including specialist NGOs. • Standardization and Contextualization: Specify the standardization components with core tools, methodologies, and data quality frameworks and segments for contextualization to ensure both data aggregation and contextualized responses.	Strategy	High Internal	Immediate Lead: ASG office Support: IMB, APMB

		• Accountability and Monitoring: Include a protocol for regular strategy reviews and updates to adapt to emerging challenges and opportunities. This would conducting regular assessments to identify gaps in IM&A capacity, tools, and resources using selected KPIs.			
3	Recommendation 3: Develop a multi-year IM&A Road Map as a practical implementation tool of the IM&A Strategy, outlining priority initiatives, their sequencing, and the required resources across OCHA at global, regional, and country levels. The road map should serve as a practical implementation tool to address systemic challenges and strengthen OCHA's IM function.	• Milestones: Specify milestones and timeframes for implementation of OCHA IM&A Strategy. • Partnerships: At a global level develop formal agreements and processes to integrate specialized NGO analytical capacities (e.g., iMMAP, REACH, ACAPS, etc.) into humanitarian responses. • Standardize IMO responsibilities: Review and clarify the responsibilities and core competencies of Information Management Officers (IMOs) at all levels, updating existing IM profiles and operational guidance to reflect evolving needs. • Capacity Development: Create a capacity-building framework for IMOs, including standardized training modules and professional development opportunities. • Monitoring: Develop a mechanism to track progress on Road Map's milestones and priorities.	High Internal	Action Plan	Immediate Lead: ASG office Support: IMB, APMB
4	Recommendation 4: Reduce Fragmentation. Continue to further streamline OCHA's data platforms, tools, products and services to reduce fragmentation, enhance efficiency and ensure sustainability	• Universal Inventory: Establish a comprehensive, universal inventory of all platforms, tools, products and services used at global, regional, and country levels. • Taxonomy: Develop standardized taxonomy and definitions. • Leverage the Technology Governance Board (TGB): building on the ongoing work of the TGB to expand processes to further streamline OCHA's data platforms, tools, products, and services beyond the current information technology focus. • Development Protocols: Develop protocols to ensure coherency within the decentralized tool development process. • Standardization of Core Tools and Platforms: Ensure identified <i>Core Tools and Platforms</i> are funded and maintained through predictable and sustainable mechanisms, such as Programme Support Costs (PSC). • Continued HNRP refinement: Continue to refine the Humanitarian Needs and Response Plan processes to improve operational relevance and reduce administrative burdens.	High Internal	Efficiency	Immediate Lead: IMB

		• Monitoring: Define protocols for measuring tool and platform analytics including success metrics.			
5	Recommendation 5: Develop a Unified OCHA IM&A Resourcing Strategy to mitigate resource fragmentation and ensure sustainable, strategic financing for IM functions. This strategy should align PSC and special project initiatives, promoting coherence and addressing systemic gaps	• Resourcing Framework: Develop a unified IM resourcing framework that integrates funding streams, prioritizes strategic initiatives, and aligns with OCHA's IM&A Strategy. • Strategic Alignment: Establish clear guidelines on how PSC funding and special project initiatives can be linked to support IM priorities to ensure predictability and sustainability, reducing reliance on ad hoc or fragmented financing models. • Planning: Create mechanisms to forecast future IM&A resource needs for the entire organization. • Monitoring: Develop KPIs to track progress such as funding gaps, predictability, or PSC allocations against strategic priorities.	Medium Internal	Resourcing	Medium Lead: ASG office Support: IMB, APMB
6	Recommendation 6: Strengthen inter-agency coordination processes, structures, and agreements for IM&A to ensure coordinated, efficient, and complementary action among stakeholders.	• IMWG: Transform global Information Management Working Group (IMWG) and its sub-groups into strategic coordination bodies, focusing on joint planning, priority setting, and decision-making. • Updated Terms of Reference: Revise ToRs for country level Humanitarian Country Teams (HCT) and Inter-Cluster Coordination Groups (ICCG) to explicitly include roles, responsibilities, and deliverables related to IM and Analysis functions and linkages to IMWG. • Inclusion: Develop standard but customizable ToRs for country level IMWGs and Assessment and Analysis Working Groups (A&AWGs) that includes, when they are activated, their inclusive membership, including specialists NGOs, and linkages to each other and the ICCG and HCT. • Streamlining: Establish a mechanisms, perhaps under the IMWG, to provide strategic oversight to ensure adequate strategic linkages among working groups and avoid duplications.	Medium External	Coordination	Medium Term Lead: IMB
7	Recommendation 7: Develop an IM&A Strategy for the Humanitarian Community's IM&A Ecosystem to ensure coordinated, efficient, and complementary action among stakeholders. The strategy should identify and address gaps, establish shared priorities and promote effective collaboration.	• Vision: Define a shared vision for the humanitarian IM and Analysis ecosystem, aligning with global frameworks such as the UN Secretary General Data Strategy. • Agreements: Facilitate agreements among stakeholders to delineate roles, responsibilities, and areas of complementarity, minimizing overlap and improving efficiency • Complementarities: Address systemic issues such as resource gaps, surge capacity, and integration of specialized NGO analytical capacities into the broader ecosystem.	Medium External	Strategy	Long Term Lead: IMB

		• Monitoring: Include mechanisms for monitoring progress and adapting the strategy based on feedback and evolving needs			
8	Recommendation 8: Engage Multi-Disciplinary Analysis Teams at country and regional levels to strengthen humanitarian response by combining operational insights from multiple actors within and external to OCHA including specialist NGOs and UN agencies. These teams will ensure contextually relevant and methodologically sound analyses that align with OCHA's analytical framework.	• Composition: Formalize analysis teams and agreements at country and regional levels to include both HAOs and IMO for internal analysis as well as specialized NGOs with strong analytical capacities, and UN agency IM capacity representatives for external analysis. • Standardized workflows: Drawing on a standardized analytical framework, ensure teams have adequate tools to align analysis with framework objectives. • Coordination: Ensure alignment of analysis teams with existing coordination structures (IMWG/AAWG/ICCG/HCT) to streamline outputs for all phases of the HPC.	Medium External	Analysis	Medium Term Lead: APMB

7 Annexes

Annex 1. Terms of Reference

1. Background information

The Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs (OCHA), to a large degree, led the humanitarian information management transformation with the development and utility of the Humanitarian Information Centers (HIC), the institutionalization of Information Management Officers (IMO) and the subsequent Information Management Units (IMU) in each of its country and regional offices.

In the area of analysis, OCHA has also displayed leadership in predictive analytics, anticipatory action, emergency assessment and analysis cell coordination (A&A Cell), the creation of Humanitarian Needs Overviews (HNO), and global level trends in terms of needs, response, and financing.

Despite these achievements and the fact that the use of data, information, and analysis underpins all other areas of OCHA's work (coordination, decision-making, advocacy, financing), information management and analysis is fragmented in the organization. Moreover, with the creation of the new [OCHA Strategic Plan](#), additional requirements have emerged which calls upon the organization to further enhance its efforts around IM and analysis.

Moreover, the [United Nations 2020-2022 Data Strategy](#) sets the stage for UN Secretariat-wide improvements and is monitored through the [UN 2.0 mechanism](#), with benchmarks for all UN Secretariat entities.

2. Scope of the review

The review will look holistically at OCHA's IM and analysis practices using the requirements listed in the OCHA Strategic Plan for reference. It will review whether OCHA's current IM and analysis products and services meet the needs of the strategic and operational decision-makers OCHA should support (looking at both OCHA decision-makers as well as decision-makers in the broader humanitarian community). The review will look at what subsequent analysis is needed for such decision support, what information is needed to ensure a strong analysis, and what data is required to ensure we have the needed information – and whether OCHA is best placed to provide this type of support or where other partners should be coordinated by OCHA.

In parallel, the review will also look at OCHA's own internal decision-making needs and potential options for OCHA to organize itself at each level both to provide the predictability of delivering the above and to ensure sufficient agility to adjust quickly to new analysis and decisional needs.

The geographic scope will include global, regional, and country-level actors and decisions. While the thematic scope is focused on humanitarian work, it will also, by default, need to include links to development, peace/security, and environmental actors and the support needed from external levels to conduct state of the art analysis that will contribute to durable solutions and addressing the priority areas of OCHA's strategic plan.

At the global level, it will include, but not limited to, the following:

- OCHA external actors: major IASC and SCHR partner organizations, global Clusters, UN Secretariat UNDCO, Donors, UN and NGO partners etc. NGO partners include operational actors and specialized ones delivering IM, data and analysis services to the humanitarian community (e.g., IMPACT Initiatives, IMMAP, ACAPs, etc.).
- OCHA internal actors: DUSG, and Divisions and Branches (Operations and Advocacy Division (OAD), Coordination Division (CD), Information Management Branch (IMB) etc.).

At the regional level, the scope will include the following:

- OCHA external actors: Regional HC/RC where applicable, regional offices for IASC member organizations, regional offices for UN Secretariat entities, applicable regional organizations, Donors, etc.
- OCHA internal actors: Regional Offices, IM and analysis staff, partner organizations, other regional actors, and the analytical work that ideally should take place at this level.

At the country level, the scope will include the following:

- OCHA external actors: HC, HCT, ICCG / Cluster Coordinators and IMOs, UNCT, NGO Forums (including the ones coordinating local and national actors), Governments, local authorities, UN Secretariat entities, Donors, and Analysis and Information Management Working Groups, UN, and NGO partners. NGO partners include operational actors and specialized ones delivering IM, data, and analysis services to the humanitarian community (e.g. IMPACT Initiatives, iMMAP, ACAPs, etc.).
- OCHA internal actors: OCHA Management, staff involved in IM and analysis work, and users of the results of IM and analysis work. The scope will also include the sub-national level and the role of OCHA sub-offices in generating and interpreting data/information and conducting analysis.

The review will look more holistically at analysis enablers, including OCHA's information management activities, platforms, and data-driven business processes. This will be done to improve the discoverability, coherence, and inter-operability of data, information, and analysis on OCHA's platforms, and for these to live up to the highest level of security, safety, and business continuity.

The review will consider longer-term goals as well as possible short- to medium-term pathways that could move OCHA in the right direction and provide a blueprint for further progress in the areas of IM and analysis.

3. Purpose / Objectives / Rationale

Purpose

OCHA strengthens its leadership position among humanitarian actors in information management, analysis, and evidence-based decision-making. To achieve this, a comprehensive review of organizing principles, practices and corporate systems is needed to ensure that they are fit for purpose to implement the new Strategic Plan 2023-2026, align to the UN data strategy, and ensure the humanitarian community can leverage the IM and data, tools services and capacities it requires.

Objectives

- 1) **OCHA Data Platforms:** Determine what common data platforms OCHA should provide to the humanitarian community. How does this ideal state align with the current state and what changes should OCHA make to its current portfolio of data platforms? What organizational implications, capacities and resources does OCHA require to achieve this? Moreover, internally, what does OCHA need to do to improve the cohesion, support and sustainability of corporate systems and infrastructure to manage data/information for timely analysis and decision-making.
- 2) **The coordination of data and information management as a humanitarian sector.** Determine OCHA's role in ensuring a coherent suite of humanitarian data/IM services and products (from OCHA and other actors). What are the priority issues in this domain requiring coordination at the country, regional, and global level? What services and functions should OCHA deliver itself and what functions should it coordinate from others? What organizational

implications, capacities and resources does OCHA require to successfully coordinate this domain? How could OCHA leverage technology to reduce transaction costs and barriers to data collection?

- 3) **OCHA's analysis functions.** Establish what analytic questions OCHA (internally and externally) needs to answer in the country and regional level and at HQ. What organizational implications, capacities and resources does OCHA require to answer these questions? Suggest improved practices for the responsible handling of data and information including the use of analytical frameworks for prioritized collection and use. Suggest how to improve the analytical offerings to support OCHA's core functions and the humanitarian community at large.
- 4) Improve corporate level organizing principles to promote a data-driven culture and that we have the right people involved in analytical processes for informed decision-making. (People)

Rationale

This is an opportune time to review these areas of work in OCHA to ensure the organization can effectively address the goals of the 2023-26 Strategic plan, set baselines to monitor progress, and lay the foundation for future strategies.

4. *Intended use(s) and user(s)*

The review will identify what OCHA needs to accomplish in terms of IM and analysis to implement the OCHA Strategic Plan 2023-2026. This will include senior-and-middle management and staff working at the strategic, operational, and tactical levels of the organization.

It will identify what strengths, weaknesses, opportunities, and threats OCHA has in implementing the Strategic Plan and to re-establish its leadership position within the humanitarian sector.

The review will lay the foundation for improvements in IM and analysis within the organization and in its collaboration with humanitarian, development, peace/security, and environmental actors, including those at the local, national, regional, and global levels.

In terms of specific users:

- OCHA leadership, senior-and-middle management, and staff: To inform plans and strategies.
- OCHA Donor Support Group: To coordinate and enable support for OCHA work on IM and data
- Humanitarian Community: To transparently share an analysis of OCHA's vision for its role in data, IM, and analysis.

5. *Review questions*

For OCHA to be able to implement its transformational priorities in the Strategic Plan 2023-2026, the review should investigate and suggest what is needed vis-à-vis the following transformational priorities:

1. Strategic Analysis: What in terms of IM and analysis needs to be in place for OCHA to enable a responsive humanitarian system and foresight to an uncertain, complex, and increasingly unpredictable humanitarian landscape and future?
2. Catalytic Financing: What in terms of IM and analysis needs to be in place for OCHA to ensure increased and timely use of humanitarian financing for humanitarian action including catalytic use of pooled funds?
3. Access: What in terms of IM and analysis needs to be in place for OCHA to provide systematic and predictable leadership on access?
4. IDPs: What in terms of IM and analysis needs to be in place for OCHA to provide effective system-wide processes and practices for durable solutions for IDPs in protracted crises?

5. Inclusion: What in terms of IM and analysis needs to be in place for OCHA to provide coordination approaches that support participatory, inclusive, and principled response? How do local and national actors contribute to the data ecosystem (contribute to defining the information needs, participate in the analysis, access relevant services and products etc.)
6. Response: What in terms of IM and analysis needs to be in place for OCHA to provide new and scalable approaches that respect, engage, and empower local actors in a more structured and consistent manner and facilitates a lighter, more effective, evidence-based, and sustainable response? This area should include aspects of needs analysis and existing engagement with the HPC (Humanitarian Program Cycle), including JIAF (Joint and Intersectoral Analysis Framework) 2.0 and the element of foresight. It should also include aspects related to response monitoring to ensure that information on the people reached and the response delivered informs strategic decisions, course correction and advocacy.

In addition to the above questions, OCHA would like the review to investigate ways forward in the below areas, leading up to a suggested organizational strategy on IM, data, and analysis:

7. Data and information leadership: How can OCHA lead and enhance the humanitarian data ecosystem?
8. External facing coherence: How can OCHA streamline its use of platforms and datasets to provide a coherent experience for humanitarian users?
9. Consistency in the use of tools: How can platforms and tools effectively and efficiently be used across country and regional offices?
10. System-wide interoperability: How can OCHA leverage cross-pillar initiatives and address data interoperability challenges, within the humanitarian system and across the nexus?
11. Aggregation services: How can OCHA rationalize, prioritize, and improve data aggregation services provided by OCHA and others to ensure that the humanitarian community has the foundational data it needs to stay coordinated and facilitate strategic foresight?
12. Resources: What, from an IM and analysis point of view, are the resources (financial, technical, and human) needed to implement the findings of this review?
13. New Technologies and Methods: How can OCHA ensure that novel methods, data sources and technologies for humanitarian IM, data and analysis are quickly and appropriately put in service of the humanitarian community.
14. Organizational Shifts: How best to utilize country, regional, and global level capacities and how should OCHA configure its setup to maximize its current capacities?
15. Analysis levels: The result of the review work should include a recommendation of what analysis is ideally conducted at which level.

6. *The principles and approach that will guide the review*

The review will adhere to the ethical procedures established by the United Nations. The review will be guided by the [UNEG Norms and Standards](#) and the [UNEG ethical guidance for evaluation](#) to ensure the quality of review process. The review team is expected to consider ethical considerations throughout the entire review process. Due diligence will be given to effectively integrating good ethical practices and paying due attention to robust ethical considerations in the conduct of the review, as stipulated in the United Nations Evaluation Group (UNEG) Ethical Guidelines for Evaluation of 2020. Furthermore, it is vital for the review to fully comply with the precautionary measures put in place by the collective agencies and host governments, to protect staff, teams and consultants, partners and people. It is of utmost importance that the 'do no harm' principle consistently guides review efforts across the board, including as it applies to those involved in the on-going response as well as affected populations.

The [UNEG Guidance on Integrating Human Rights and Gender Equality in Evaluation](#) shall serve as point of reference to integrate human rights and gender equality concepts, standards, values, and principles throughout the review.

7. Methodology

The review will organize its approach to the above review questions through multiple approaches including desk reviews, country and regional office visits, surveys, and key informant interviews. The approach will be described in the inception report.

The results will be reviewed, and the final report will be agreed to by OCHA and approved by the Steering Committee before any further dissemination. A succinct public-facing report will be produced based on the final report to share with the wider humanitarian community.

All information that the review team will access will be treated as confidential information and can only be shared after explicit agreement from the Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs.

8. Roles and responsibilities

The review team is responsible for the administrative and substantive elements of the review. In terms of administrative components, this includes logistics, visas, travel, accommodation, insurance, etc. The review team should have an adequate project management structure to support the review (human resources/focal point, administrative support, access to travel agency, booking interviews, organizing workshops etc.).

In terms of substantive components, this would include the full development of a strategy to conduct the review based on this ToR, development of instruments for data collection and processing, identification of target groups, collection of data / interviews, analysis of data/information and reporting.

The review will be governed by a Steering Committee composed of a small group of experts familiar with OCHA's information management (IM) and analysis function and mandate. The role of the steering committee is to:

- a. Approve this ToR (Terms of Reference)
- b. Approve the inception report.
- c. Approve the final report.

The review will also be supported by a reference group of stakeholders and technical experts on data and analysis subjects who the reviews can turn to for guidance or insights. The members of reference group will help reviewers understand the 'lay of the land' in terms of the humanitarian data and analysis ecosystem and act as a bouncing board from a technical point of view.

The OCHA members of the reference group will support the review team throughout its work in terms of data collection and access to key documentation, organization of meetings / interviews, and participate in missions as needed. These will also participate in the planned workshops.

9. Prospective Contractor's General Requirements

The bidding company needs to have experience in conducting evaluations or reviews in humanitarian settings (at least 2 evaluations) and experience in evaluating Information Management and/or Analysis in humanitarian or development settings (at least 1 evaluation).

The bidding company needs to demonstrate that ethical procedures will guide the review and its findings and recommendations, including through a comprehensive approach to gender.

The proposal must also demonstrate the company's administrative capacities to conduct the review in terms of human resources, logistics (organizing workshops, conducting interviews), visas, travel, accommodation, insurance and security.

10. Team Composition and Qualification Requirement

The team leader needs to be experienced in evaluations and reviews of a similar nature. The team leader must also have at least 10 years of experience with humanitarian affairs in the management of humanitarian information and analysis within the United Nations common system or comparable international organization.

The team membership needs to have extensive collective experience of inter-agency information management activities and coordination in a country and regional setting. At least one member of the core team (the team leader and the senior consultants) should have at least one year of experience with humanitarian-development-peace interlinkages in information management and analysis. Language skills within the team should include fluency in both oral and written English, French, and Spanish.

Personnel requirements:

- Team leader and senior consultants hold an advanced university degree (master's degree or equivalent) in political science, social science, international studies, information management and analysis, or related areas.
- Team leader with at least 10 years of experience in humanitarian / development / public sector and having led evaluations or reviews in humanitarian affairs.
- Two senior consultants with at least 7 years of experience each in humanitarian / development / public sector information management, analysis, and ICT within the United Nations common system or comparable international organization.
- Two research staff with at least 2 years of work experience each in humanitarian / development / public sector information management and analysis.
- The team should consider gender and geographic diversity with at least one female among the core team (team leader and two senior consultants).

There may be interviews of prospective team leaders and at least one senior consultant to assess the following competencies:

- Planning and Organizing
- Professionalism
- Vision

The team is expected to work as follows:

<i>Personnel</i>	<i>Estimated Number of Workdays</i>
<i>Team Leader</i>	85 – 105
<i>Senior Consultants</i>	85 – 105
<i>Research Staff</i>	60 - 80

11. *Proposed Technical Approach:*

First, the proposal narrative should demonstrate the bidders understanding of the review questions and OCHA's Strategic Plan ambitions. More specifically it should demonstrate an understanding of OCHA's IM and analysis products and services, as well as the organization management of these issues. It should also reveal the company's knowledge of the humanitarian ecosystem in terms of data, IM, and analysis, as well as the current opportunities and challenges in those domains.

Second, the proposal should prove the company's ability to design a solid and realistic data collection and analysis plan. To that end, it must include a conceptual framework which reflects the suggested approach to the collection and collation of data (sampling, software, statistical, visualization etc.). In addition, the proposal should include a short risk-analysis to demonstrate the company's capacity to identify the risks that could limit the data collection and the proposed actions to mitigate it.

Third, the proposal should demonstrate the bidder planning capacity and understanding of the review key steps and milestones through a Gantt chart that indicates the proposed timeline/evaluation phase. The Gantt chart should include the deliverables described in the ToR (see the reporting section below). The proposal should also indicate what quality assurance mechanism will be set to ensure the review is on track.

Travel:

- To three UN HQ locations (NY, Geneva, and Istanbul), and remote interaction with The Hague.
- To two Regional Offices, and two country offices Virtual Engagement:
- Virtual interviews and focus groups will be conducted to supplement the in-person interviews and workshops

Workshops:

- Organize and conduct one virtual workshop at the end of the planning stage and in preparation for the data collection stage (see timeline below)
- Organize and conduct a 2-day in-person workshop at the data analysis stage (see timeline below). Please note that the workshop will be held in one OCHA office (Venue free – location TBC depending on cost effectiveness)
- Both these workshops will include key OCHA staff and others as needed

12. *Timeline*

The overall timeframe of the review is 7 months. This could be broken down to:

- Planning: 1 month
- Data collection / collation and production of the inception report: 2.5 months
- Data analysis and consultations on emerging findings: 2 months
- Final report writing and final review: 1.5 months.

13. *Reporting*

The Review Team will produce an **inception report** which will outline:

- The Team's understanding of the issues to be reviewed (objectives), their understanding of the context in which the review takes place and any additional line of inquiry (in terms of issues to tackle or stakeholder to consult for instance) compared to the ToR, following initial consultations. This shall not be a repetition of the ToR.
- A detailed stakeholder analysis and clear indication of entities to be consulted, engaged with, and involved in the review process, as relevant. Per stakeholder, a plan of action should be proposed, outlining the planned level and scope of engagement in the review.

- The details of the gender analysis approach
- A comprehensive methodological approach for the review, including:
 - Review approach and design
 - A review matrix relating to the chosen approach and with sub-questions for each of the review questions. This matrix should indicate, for each question, the assumptions to be assessed, the indicators proposed and corresponding sources of information. It should also outline sources of data and methods required to answer those questions (including documents, information, and data asked of all stakeholders).
 - An assessment of data availability and accessibility in relation to the review questions at hand, and the identification of challenges/gaps and a plan for mitigating them, resulting in a set of final key review questions.
 - Data collection plan and analysis tools used to conduct the review (survey instruments, interview guides, country and regional data collection plan and schedule of interviews, and other tools to be used for the review).
 - Any limitations of the chosen methods of data collection and analysis and how they will be addressed. This might include, for example, methodological and management measures to reduce any potential bias in data collection undertaken by the consultants that may arise due to their regional, religious, or ethnic identity.
 - A final list of data sources to be used.
- A detailed workplan/timeline for the remaining review phases including planning for country and regional office visits, and for all deliverables
- A description of team organization and quality assurance arrangements

The Review Team will produce a **final report** which should not exceed 25,000 words (excluding executive summary and 4es). It should be written in a clear and concise manner that allows readers and all intended users, especially decision makers, to understand the main review findings, conclusions and corresponding recommendations, and their inter-relationship. The report should be comprised of a(n):

- Executive summary of 2,500 words.
- Summary table linking findings, conclusions, and recommendations, including where suggested responsibility for follow-up should lie.
- Methodology summary. This should be a brief chapter in the main report, with a more detailed description provided in an Annex.
- Main body of the report, including an overall assessment, findings in response to the review questions, conclusions, and recommendations. The report should clearly identify the decision-makers' needs in terms of data and analysis: what current services, platform and products exist to respond to them; and what do we need to change to do so to deliver on the OCHA Strategic Plan. It should do so at global, regional, and country level.

The final report should present recommendations that are specific, clearly stated and not broad or vague; as well as realistic, reflecting an understanding of the humanitarian system and potential constraints to follow-up. They should suggest where responsibility for follow-up should lie and include a timeframe for follow-up.

Annexes should include: 1) ToR, 2) detailed methodology, 3) list of persons interviewed, 4) details of qualitative and quantitative analysis undertaken, 5) team itinerary, 6) all review tools employed including an evidence matrix, 7) list of acronyms, 8) complete bibliography of references 9) a summary table that links the key findings, conclusions, and recommendations of the review.

The final report and its versions will be reviewed by the Steering Committee. No limited number of drafts or rounds of review is set due to the need to optimize the quality of the review report.

- **Power Point Presentation:** The review team is also expected to produce a succinct Power Point Presentation that can be used for senior leadership purposes.
- **A public report:** The review team will use the executive summary of the Final Report as

the base for a public-facing report to share with the wider humanitarian community. The public-facing report will highlight broad themes of the findings and not be more than 2,500 words.

Table 13: Most Common Themes in Recommendations from Previous Reviews

Dimension	Examples of Most Common Recommendation
Leadership and Governance	- Establish a Strong IM Governance Framework: Create clear structures and designated focal points within OCHA for overseeing IM processes, ensuring consistency and accountability. - Strengthen Inter-Cluster Coordination: Enhance coordination mechanisms like the IM Working Group, or focusing on coordination for outcome-driven approaches, or strengthening coordination to create consensus on overarching IM and Analysis mandates. - Formalize Roles and Responsibilities: Clearly delineate IM responsibilities across OCHA offices and clusters to avoid redundancy and ensure cohesive data management. - Increase Senior Management Oversight: Ensure that senior management actively oversees IM processes to maintain alignment with strategic goals.
Data Quality and Standardization	- Develop and Enforce Data Standards: Create and maintain global IM standards to improve data reliability, comparability, and interoperability across humanitarian partners. - Implement Data Quality Assurance Mechanisms: Regularly assess data accuracy and integrity, especially for real-time data used in humanitarian decision-making. - Expand Ethical and Technical Standards: Address ethical data concerns, ensuring unbiased, protected, and high-quality data collection and dissemination.
Data Platforms and Technology Adaptations	- Enhance Centralized Data Platforms: Strengthen platforms like HDX and ReliefWeb to support seamless data sharing and improve accessibility for humanitarian actors. - Adopt Digital and Automation Tools: Leverage digital tools, automation, and Application programming interfaces (APIs) to streamline data processing, increase efficiency, and reduce manual data handling. - Pilot Interoperable CMS Platforms: Transition to a content management system that allows multi-channel information distribution, facilitating faster updates and broader reach.
Capacity Building and Training Systems	- Provide Data Literacy and Analysis Training: Conduct regular training programs on data literacy, analytics, and IM standards for field staff and partners. - Promote Regional Capacity Building: Focus on building IM capacities within local and regional offices, ensuring sustainable and context-specific data practices. - Strengthen Learning Infrastructure: Develop a structured learning curriculum that addresses both foundational skills and advanced IM topics.
Stakeholder Engagement and Communication	- Enhance User-Focused IM Products: Adapt IM products to user needs by incorporating visualizations, concise summaries, and tailored formats, ensuring accessibility for diverse audiences. - Foster Partnerships with Local and Global Stakeholders: Engage with local entities, NGOs, and data providers to align IM efforts, reduce redundancy, and increase data sharing. - Gather Feedback for Continuous Improvement: Implement mechanisms to collect feedback from IM users and stakeholders, using it to refine products and practices.
Ethics, Privacy, and Accountability	- Ensure Data Privacy and Confidentiality: Develop and enforce protocols for protecting sensitive data, particularly when it involves vulnerable populations. - Promote Ethical Data Use: Establish guidelines to ensure that data use adheres to humanitarian principles, avoiding political influence and respecting affected populations. - Increase Transparency in Data Sharing: Develop accountability measures for transparent data handling, fostering trust with stakeholders and communities.

Annex 3. **Detailed Methodology**

Scope of the review

159. The Review team developed a conceptual framework based on the detailed objectives of the review, as stated in the ToR (Annex 1), following with the consultations with the Steering Committee who advised on the priority areas the review.
160. The review team then developed a conceptual framework to rationalize and prioritize the review questions. The framework emphasizes the questions that will facilitate the identification of priority areas for OCHA's information management vision and leadership in the humanitarian data and analysis ecosystem, and areas where OCHA can focus its work by rationalizing and divesting. The framework served as the primary methodological guidance for the review, highlighting key areas of focus and aspects to be considered. The interview guides and survey question stemmed from the main review questions, making sure that data collected feed into the identified lines of inquiries.
161. The Conceptual Framework below reorganizes the questions developed in the ToR, providing a coherent alignment with the four dimensions listed in the questions within the review objectives. The conceptual framework lists the six primary questions that will lead the review, as well as the lines of inquiries and cross-cutting themes that were considered in the approach. A more detailed review matrix is included in Annex 4, including information on the data sources and data analysis.

Table 14: Conceptual framework

		Lines of Inquiry and Cross-Cutting Themes	
		These two columns serve as probes for elaborating responses during Key Informant Interviews	
Dimension	Primary Questions Principal Structure for guiding KIs (Drawn from the Objective Questions)	Lines of Inquiry (Drawn from the Review Questions and the Objective sub-questions)	Cross-cutting themes (Balancing Roles) (Review Goals)
Leadership and Coordination	Q1. Determine OCHA's role in ensuring a coherent suite of humanitarian data/IM services and products (from OCHA and other actors).	Data and information leadership External facing coherence Consistency in the use of tools System-wide interoperability Aggregation of services Analysis levels New Technologies and Methods	Strengthening OCHA's leadership and vision Coordination versus ownership Coherence for efficiency Coordination for effective or coherent suites of services
	Q2. What are the priority issues in this domain requiring coordination at the country, regional, and global level?	What services and functions should OCHA deliver itself and what functions should it coordinate from others? How could OCHA leverage technology to reduce transaction costs and barriers to data collection and insights?	
Analysis Analytical Offerings	Q3. Establish what analytic questions OCHA (internally and externally) needs to answer in the regional and country-level and at Headquarters (HQ).	Strategic Analysis Catalytic Financing Access Internally Displaced Persons (IDPs) Inclusion Response Analysis levels	Strategic versus Operational analysis needs Leadership and Vision: What services and functions should OCHA deliver itself and what functions should it coordinate from others? What analytical role should OCHA play? And what are the analytical offerings to support OCHA core functions and the humanitarian community at large. Increasing timeliness Increasing usefulness for decision making
Data Platforms and Tools	Q4. Determine what common data platforms OCHA should provide to the humanitarian community.	Strategic Analysis Catalytic Financing Access IDPs Inclusion Response	Strategic versus Operational data needs Leadership and Vision: What services and functions should OCHA deliver itself and what functions should it coordinate from others?

	Q5. How does this ideal state align with the current state? What changes should OCHA make to its current portfolio of data platforms?	Timeliness Completeness External facing coherence Consistency in the use of tools System-wide interoperability Aggregation of services New Technologies and Methods	Coherent user experience What data generation roles should OCHA play? Increasing timeliness Increasing usefulness for decision making
Organizational Implications	Q6. What, if any, organizational shifts - including capacities, and resources - does OCHA need to achieve the necessary common data platforms, answer analytic offerings and successfully coordinate of IM services?	Data and information leadership Organizational implications Resources Analysis Levels Aggregation of Services System wide interoperability External facing coherence Fragmentation Appropriate people involved in decision making Internally what does OCHA need to do to improve the cohesion, support, and sustainability of corporate systems and infrastructure to manage data/information for timely analysis and decision-making? Suggest improved practices for the responsible handling of data and information including the use of analytical frameworks for prioritized collection and use. Culture – how to Improve corporate level organizing principles to promote a data-driven culture and that we have the right people involved in analytical processes for informed decision-making. (People)	Reducing fragmentation Coordination for effective and coherent data analysis/generation Strengthening OCHA's leadership and vision Organizational implications as fit for purpose

Stakeholder mapping

162. A range of stakeholders both internal and external to OCHA at the global, regional, and country levels make use of its IM and analysis services. Each group of stakeholders has a different set of IM needs, offering and relationship with the IM system.

163. The following table presents a list of stakeholders for the review disaggregated by relationship to OCHA (**I**: internal or **E**: external) and level (**G**: Global, **R**: Regional, **C**: Country). The following roles are also identified to better distinguish the roles played by each stakeholder:

- Collects data: conduct primary data collection or aggregate secondary data.
- Analysis: perform analysis that concludes with findings.
- Decision-making: making determinations and decisions based on data and analysis.
- Data policy: creates data policy.

Table 15: Stakeholder Classes and Role in Evaluation

Level	Type	Stakeholder Class	Role in IM Systems				Role for the review
			Collects data	Analysis	Decision-making	Data policy	
G	E/I	Review Steering Committee (SC) members ¹⁵	x	x	x	x	- Approve the review ToR - Approve the inception report - Approve the final report - Participation in workshops
G	E/I	Review Reference Group ¹⁶		x	x		- Provision of technical guidance/insights - Support for data collection, access to documentation, organization of meetings / interviews - Participation in workshops
G	E	Inter-Agency Steering Committee (IASC) members		x	x	x	Key informants
G	E	International Council of Voluntary Agencies (ICVA) organizations					Key informants
G	E	Humanitarian Cluster Leads & IMOs		x	x	x	Key informants
G	E	UN Development Coordination Office (DCO)	x	x	x	x	Key informants
G	E	Humanitarian donors		x	x	x	Key informants
G	E	Secretary General Executive Office		x	x	x	
G	E	Information Management Working Group			x	x	Key informants
G	E	Relevant IM actors (e.g., iMMAP ¹⁷ , IMPACT ¹⁸ , ACAPS ¹⁹ , etc.)		x	x	x	Key informants
G	E	International NGOs	x	x	x		
G	I	Deputy Emergency Relief Coordinator (D-ERC)		x	x		Key informants

¹⁵ See composition in Annex 3

¹⁶ At the time of draft report submission, the Reference Group hasn't been formed yet

¹⁷ <https://immap.org/>

¹⁸ <https://www.impact-initiatives.org/>

¹⁹ <https://www.acaps.org/en/>

G	I	Directors: Operations & Advocacy, Coordination Divisions		x	x		Key informants
G	I	Information Management Branch	x	x	x	x	Key informants
G	I	Centre of Humanitarian Data	x	x	x	x	Key informants
G	I	Assessments, Planning and Monitoring Branch	x	x	x	x	Key informants
G	I	Pooled Funds Management Branch, CERF	x	x	x	x	Key informants
G	I	Thematic Advisors		x	x	x	
G	I	Other internal IM Focal Points	x	x	x		Key Informants
R	E	Regional Humanitarian Coordinator (HC) / Resident Coordinator (RC)		x	x		Key informants
R	E	Regional IASC Members		x	x		Key informants
R	E	Regional UN DCO		x	x		Key informants
R	E	Regional Donors		x	x		Key informants
R	I	OCHA Regional offices Stakeholders (primarily IM but also senior management)	x	x	x		Key informants
C	E	Resident Coordinator (RC) / Humanitarian Coordinator (HC)		x	x		Key informants
C	E	Humanitarian Country Team		x	x		Key informants
C	E	Inter-Cluster Coordination Group		x	x		Key informants
C	E	IM Working Group (WG)	x	x		x	Key informants
C	E	Thematic WGs (e.g., access, assessments, cash, etc.)	x	x		x	Key informants
C	E	Cluster Leads/Members	x	x	x	x	Key informants
C	E	Humanitarian NGO Forum	x	x	x	x	Key informants
C	E	National NGOs	x	x	x		Key informants
C	E	National/Local Governments	x	x	x	x	Key informants
C	E	Organisations conducting IM (e.g., iMMAP, IMPACT, ACAPS, etc.)	x	x	x	x	Key informants
C	E	Donors		x	x	x	Key informants
C	E	Operational NGOs	x	x	x	x	Key informants
C	I	Head/Deputy of OCHA		x	x		Key informants
C	I	Coordination Unit ²⁰	x	x	x		Key informants
C	I	Humanitarian Financing Unit ²¹	x	x	x		Key informants
C	I	Humanitarian Access Unit ²²	x	x			Key informants

²⁰ To be confirmed based on the country selected for data collection

²¹ To be confirmed based on the country selected for data collection

²² To be confirmed based on the country selected for data collection

C	I	IM Unit ²³	x	x		x	Key informants
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The table served as the basis for the compilation of the list of people to be interviewed.

Risks and assumptions

There are a few assumptions and accompanying risks that were important to manage for the success of the review and its subsequent uptake:

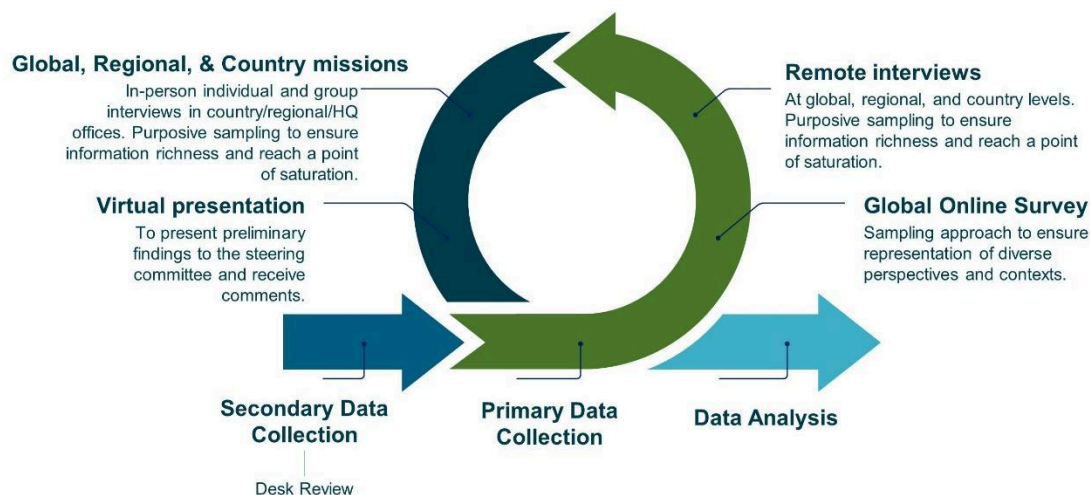
164. **Assumption 1:** The **purpose, priorities and desired outcome** of the review are commonly understood and agreed upon by the key stakeholders responsible for overseeing the review and actioning the proposed recommendations.
165. **Moderate Risk:** The introductory and planning meetings with OCHA helped define the review questions and lines of inquiry, and the Steering Committee meetings were useful to discuss different perspectives on the purpose and priorities of the review.
166. **Assumption 2:** The stakeholders to be consulted at the different levels, both internally and externally, 1) are **interested** in and see the importance of coordinated information and data management in humanitarian crises; 2) are able to be **candid** and **concrete** in their consultations; 3) **see possibility** of new ways of working and 4) are **not threatened** by the prospect of change that benefits and improves OCHA's role in information management and ultimately humanitarian crisis operations.
167. **Moderate Risk:** There is a general awareness of the review from the public posting of the request for proposals, and the internal announcement of the review within OCHA's information management, and assessment, planning and monitoring branches. From these, there should be an understanding that this review is undertaken with a growth and learning mindset. The selection of stakeholders includes data creators and data consumers. Consultations were geared toward their specific roles with adequate time allowed for probing. Key informants were contacted in advance and informed about the purpose and implications of their contribution to the review.
168. **Assumption 3:** The review team will have **access to internal documents, products and platforms** necessary to make determinations and recommendations about the configuration, interconnectedness and aspirations of OCHA overall toward information management, data and analytics, and specifically for the information management and assessment, planning and monitoring branches.
169. **Low/Moderate Risk:** For the planning phase and the inception report the review team compiled an inventory of necessary documents, products and platforms. The data collection phase will conduct a desk review to answer the review questions for which internal documents are key. Some documents have already been received for use in the planning and development of the inception report – including links to relevant platforms and products. Additional documents are being collected and analysed as part of the data collection process.
170. **Assumption 4:** Membership of the SC is representative of the key stakeholders in OCHA that members have an overview of and stake in information management in the organization and can help drive change. The views of each representative are equal and the purpose, outcome, etc. are agreed to by consensus and committed to in **good faith**.
171. **Low/Moderate Risk:** The issues of representativeness of membership in the SC was raised with OCHA. The review team was assured that the selected members were key liaisons for the organization and will see the review through to its consideration and implementation. If consensus is not built with all group members, there is a risk of the review asking the wrong questions and providing recommendations to address challenges that are not the most pressing and appropriate. The relevance of the review could be questioned with the findings and recommendations discounted.

Methodology summary

²³ To be confirmed based on the country selected for data collection

172. The review adopted a non-experimental, mixed methods approach that combines qualitative and quantitative participatory methods. This approach utilized four data collection tools: desk review, semi-structured individual interviews, group interviews, and an online survey. Semi-structured interviews and group interviews were conducted both remotely and in-person at multiple levels: global (headquarters), regional, and country levels. The figure below provides an overview of the methodology, purpose and sampling strategies for each tool used.

Figure 11: Evaluation Methodology and Linkages



Source: Elaborated by the Review Team

173. With input from the OCHA Technical governance group the stakeholder mapping (Table 2) provides detailed information on type of stakeholders to be included in data collection. While the global survey will target informants from all categories, the selection of key informants (KIs) was refined to reach a realistic sample aligned with the available resources for the review.

174. Global level data collection will involve internal and external stakeholders (Annex 10) including in-person and remote interviews with OCHA staff from New York, The Hague, Geneva and Istanbul offices. Following a detailed mapping of regional and country levels (see section 158), the team will select two country offices and the associated regional offices for visits. Four additional country offices were covered as virtual cases. This approach ensures consistent data collection and analysis across various levels, locations and contexts.

175. As detailed in the table below, the RT planned to engage around **292** individuals through in-person and remote individual and group interviews. This was a large number, but the RT was able to interview 230 persons by the end of the data collection process. The engagement strategy aimed to capture a wide range of views and experiences, facilitating a robust and comprehensive review of OCHA's IM and analysis practices. The online survey, available to the broader humanitarian community as identified through OCHA's distribution list, was intended to serve as complementary input to further broaden the information base. By involving a diverse group of stakeholders, the review sought to ensure that the findings and recommendations are well-informed and reflective of the diverse realities at the operational level.

Table 16: Interview Events & Types of Stakeholders

Level	Method	Format	Type of Stakeholder Class	Sample size
Country	Individual Interviews	In-person	RC/HC, HCT, IM Working Group, Thematic WGs, Cluster Leads/Members, Nat/Local NGOs, Orgs conducting IM (iMMAP, IMPACT, ACAPS), Donors, Head/Dep Head OCHA, Coordination Unit, Humanitarian Financing Unit, Humanitarian Access Unit, IM Unit.	40 (20 per country)
	Group Interviews	In-person	National staff and international staff, consultants, and contractors	32 (16 per country in 2)

				Group interview events per country)
	Individual Interviews	Remote	Country Representatives from non-site visit countries, staff representatives.	60 (15 per country)
	Group Interviews	Remote	Country staff – international and national – from non-site visit countries	32 (from four remote Group interview events with 8 people invited to each)
Regional	Individual Interviews	Both	Regional HC/RC, Regional IASC Members, Regional UN DCO, Regional Donors	20 (10 per regional office)
	Group Interviews	Both	Regional Staff, consultants, and contractors	32 (16 per regional office in 2 Group interview events per office)
HQ	Individual Interviews (NY/The Hague/ Geneva/Istanbul)	TBC	IASC Members and team leaders, UN DCO, Donors, D-ERC, REACH, iMMAP, ACAPS, NRC Others: MapAction, DFS, INSO, and CRAF'd OCHA Directors - Operations & Advocacy, Coordination Thematic Advisors, CERF Chief, Pooled Fund Management Chief, Other IM focal points IM Branch Chief • Centre of Humanitarian Data Lead • FIS Chief • DSS Chief Assessment, Planning and Monitoring Branch (APMB) Chief • Monitoring & Tools Section Chief & HPC Tools Lead • Needs Response Analysis Section Chief • System Wide Approaches and Practices Section Chief • FTS Lead IMWG Chair / GIFT Lead	60 (between NY, Hague, Geneva, Istanbul)
	Group Interviews	TBC	Group interviews with individuals from different branches (any one interview involving only individuals from the same branch), Cluster Leads & IMOs, IM Working Group	16 (2 Group Interview events)
Total number of stakeholders interviewed (KIs and Group interviews)				292
A II	Online Survey	Remote	Humanitarian community	To be distributed by OCHA ²⁴
Total number of stakeholders participating				TBC (self-selection)

Data collection methods and tools

176. The sub-sections below provide further detail on the proposed four main data collection methods. The review matrix in Annex 3 profiles the linkage between each tool, the information to be collected, and the connection to each of the review questions.

Method 1: Desk review of documents, products, and platforms

177. The RT began a thorough examination of available documentation, platforms, and products during the inception phase to gather comprehensive insights into OCHA's IM and analysis landscape. Based on meticulous analysis, the review team will develop a detailed mapping of OCHA's current practices, challenges and opportunities in IM and analysis. This desk review supported identification of key trends, gaps, challenges and opportunities, while preparing and

²⁴ Design will ensure avoiding potential overlap with the annual OCHA partner survey

nurturing subsequent data collection and analysis activities. Additionally, this process helped identify the best practices within the organization. The Bibliography of the review is in [Annex 10](#). The team utilized an analysis grid to extract relevant information related to various dimensions of each platform/product/document to identify patterns and themes across all of them.

178. The desk review also identified existing data from other sources relevant to OCHA's IM and analysis. Leveraging pre-existing data aids in triangulating and comparing information, enhancing the robustness and credibility of the review findings. This approach ensured a comprehensive and multi-faceted understanding of OCHA's IM and analysis practice, facilitating the identification of areas for improvement and the development of well-informed recommendations.

Method 2 and 3: Individual and group interviews

179. Interviews will play a crucial role in contributing to the qualitative data collected for the review process. Findings from interviews will complement other data collection methods, offering nuanced insights into the complexities of OCHA's information management landscape and informing the development of targeted recommendations for improvement.
180. Both internal and external stakeholders were involved to provide the review team with valuable firsthand knowledge about the strengths, weaknesses, opportunities, and challenges related to OCHA's IM and analysis efforts. The diverse range of stakeholders (detailed in the stakeholder analysis in Annex 2 above) will promote the inclusion of different perspectives and help avoid biases through triangulation. Interview guides have been developed and included in Annex 5, ensuring the interviews are focused and relevant.
181. The discussions were structured around specific topics outlined in the conceptual framework, allowing for in-depth exploration of challenges and collaborative identification of solutions. The semi-structured nature of the interviews will allow for flexibility and in-depth exploration of key topics, ensuring a thorough understanding of perspectives. For internal stakeholders, an oral history approach around particularly illustrative cases of platforms, tools, and products will help identify patterns in emergence, evolution, coordination, and strategic decision making which ensure a coherent suite of tools, products, and platforms ([Annex 8](#)).
182. Group interviews were employed with technical level stakeholders at country offices, regional offices and headquarters. Group interviews were conducted in person during country visits, with one or two sessions per visit, and remotely (through Teams, Meet, Webex or other convenient tools) to include personnel from country offices selected as virtual case studies. Given the potential sensitivity of certain issues and the need for confidentiality, group interviews will need to be comprised of persons from similar units and levels and focus on collecting ideas, constructive criticism, and recommendations for system improvements rather than delving into specific incident stories or personal frustrations. Accompanying parallel survey tools such as Menti may be included in the sessions to provide more anonymous input.
183. The sampling approach for interviews was purposive, aiming for information richness and reaching a point of saturation to ensure robust and thorough insights. The selection of interviewees was guided by the steering committee and informed by six main criteria:
- **Information richness** – are the respondents from a particular stakeholder class selected to be interviewed sufficiently familiar with OCHA IM systems and humanitarian data and analysis needs to provide rich insights?
 - **Accessibility** – can the people from the stakeholder class be interviewed by the review team?
 - **Gender** – does the mix of respondents from a stakeholder class adequately represent gender distribution?
 - **Diversity** – does the mix of respondents from a particular stakeholder class represent the variety of perspectives or types?
 - **Depth of contribution** – who are the actors and organizations most prominent in contributing to the ecosystem?
 - **Representation of roles in the system** – do these actors represent the key roles within the IM and Analysis ecosystem?

Method 4: Online survey

184. To complement the qualitative data gathered through group and individual interviews, an online survey were utilized to gather additional insights. This survey will employ a combination of

Likert scale²⁵ fixed-response formats and open-ended questions and were available to relevant humanitarian actors (donors, OCHA staff, IASC members, etc). While conclusions drawn from online surveys must be treated cautiously due to potential response rate bias, the survey data will provide valuable complementary insights. Analysis of response rates and non-response patterns were included in the review report to provide further context and validity to the findings.

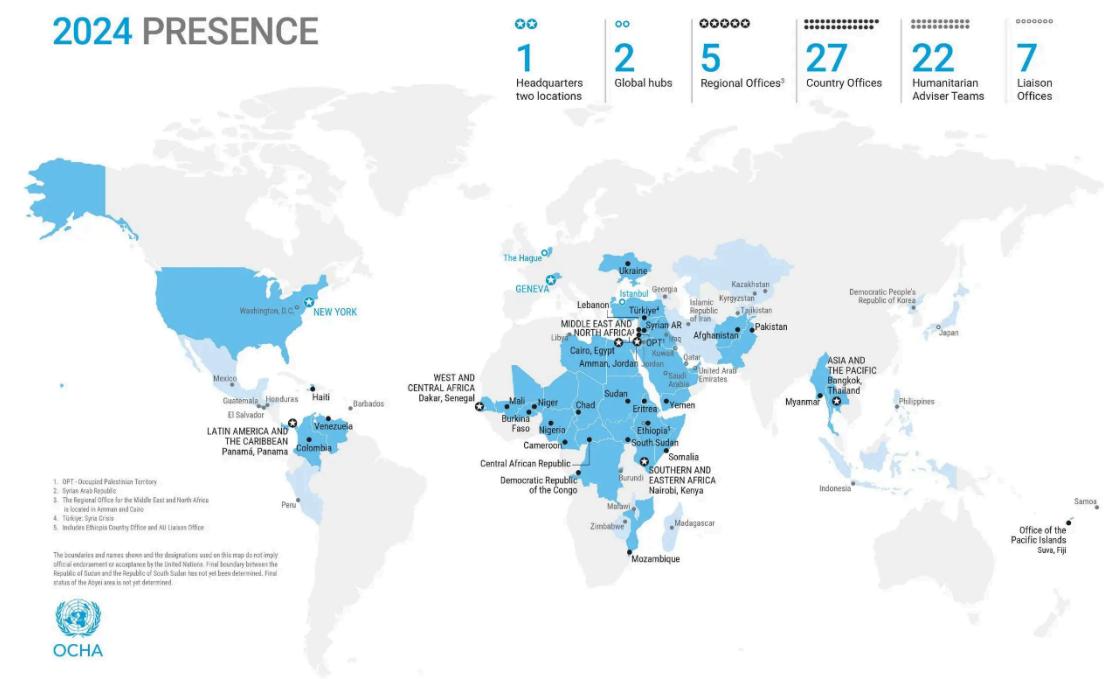
185. The RT will prepare the survey questions, upload them to a designated platform (such as Kobo ToolBox) to generate a survey link. The link was shared with OCHA alongside an introduction letter. OCHA will then distribute the letter and survey link throughout their system using their existing distribution list and send follow-up messages to boost participation. After the survey period concludes, KonTerra will collect and analyse the responses, using the data to support the findings and triangulation efforts. The raw data will remain with KonTerra, and any patterns or components shared from the survey were anonymised.
186. Additionally, the team takes note of the recent survey conducted by the Complex Risk Analytics Fund (CRAF'd), which is complementary to the proposed survey. After reviewing the questions, the team has determined that some areas of inquiry can contribute to the overall lines of inquiry for this current review, particularly regarding ecosystem strengths and weaknesses and ecosystem mapping. The response rate to the CRAF'd survey was low with fewer than 200 responses from a universally distributed survey. The data itself is therefore interesting as a complementary stream, but insufficient for replacing the current review. On the other hand, there is not likely to be survey fatigue among respondents who may have filled out the CRAF'd survey and who also received this current review's online survey.

Method 5: Selected visit sites

187. In addition to the remote interviews and online survey, the review team selected countries that are particularly illustrative of predefined criteria (see below) to conduct a deep dive – these will include six countries and three regional offices wherein the bulk of country and regional level interviews will take place. Among these countries of interest, the RT sought to visit **three country offices and two regional offices** to conduct in-person interviews. Additional country and regional offices were included through remote data collection.
188. Criteria for the selection of country and regional visits were based on the following considerations:
- Size of office
 - Geography
 - Typology of crisis
 - Feasibility
 - o Possibility to obtain visas
 - o Safety
 - o Access to country can be feasibly managed for short period of time
 - o Capacity of office to support the review process
189. An initial mapping was conducted by the RT based on OCHA's 2024 presence (see figure below) to classify countries assuming similar countries would have similar data information needs.

²⁵ Likert scale responses ask respondents how strongly they may agree or disagree with a particular statement.

Figure 12: Overview of OCHA presence (2024)



Source: OCHA - <https://www.unocha.org/headquarters>

190. After an initial mapping of potential classification factors (including size of office, numbers of implementing partners, presence of data specialists and support services, among others), it emerged that many of these factors were closely associated with each other and could be inferred from two dimensions: Typology of crisis and size of office.
191. Typology of crisis was categorized by primary, secondary and tertiary type of crisis on four dimensions: Complex, Natural Disaster, Slow Onset, and Migration.²⁶ Most of the countries (85%) have a primary classification of complex (and Mozambique has a natural disaster and complex response embedded within the same country). Furthermore, 50% of all countries have complex crises with a slow onset secondary crisis.
192. The table below provides a color-coded categorization of countries according to secondary crisis. The second, third and fourth columns differentiate between large, medium, and small offices.
- **Green** colours denote Natural Disaster as the secondary crisis
 - **Orange** colours denote Slow Onset as the secondary crisis
 - **Purple** colours denote Complex Emergency secondary crisis (only one)

Table 17: Categorization of country offices

Primary Typology	Large Offices (60+)	Medium Offices (20-60)	Small Offices (<20)
Complex	Ukraine Syria Yemen Ethiopia Somalia South Sudan Sudan Central African Republic DRC (Democratic Republic of the Congo) Afghanistan Myanmar	Lebanon Colombia Burkina Faso Cameroon Chad Mali	Haiti Venezuela Eritrea Niger Nigeria

²⁶ These general typologies cannot adequately represent the complexities of crises but are intended to serve as a first filter only.

Slow Onset	None	None	None
Natural Disaster	None	None	Mozambique
Migration	None	El Salvador	Guatemala Honduras

Source: Elaborated by the Review Team

193. Based on the categorization above, countries were approached to assess their willingness to host in-person visits. Based on these consultations, the following list of countries was selected for the review.

Table 18: Countries and Regional Offices Selected

Country	Method	Regional Office	Method
Somalia	Visit	Panama	Visit
Ukraine	Visit	Amman	Visit
Nigeria	Visit	Nairobi	Remote
Yemen	Remote	Bangkok	Remote
Haiti	Remote		

Data collection plan

194. Country and regional visits: The in-person data collection activities involved three country offices visits (Somalia, Ukraine, Nigeria), and two regional office visits (Panama, Amman). To complement this approach and get a better sense of the humanitarian landscape, three country offices (Yemen, Haiti) and two regional offices (Nairobi, Bangkok) were selected as “virtual cases” to ensure consistency of the information collected while focusing on specific contexts and operational environments (such as small and medium offices and in francophone countries). For these virtual cases, remote individual and group interviews were conducted. To take advantage of the time available, the team will divide roles and functions and ensure the data collection process takes an adaptive and flexible approach. After the first visit, the team will adjust the interview tools and approach based on the learnings and apply these in the subsequent visits.

195. The in-person country and regional visits will occur in August and September and will strive to avoid overlapping with the peak of Humanitarian Needs and Response Plan (HNRP) preparation. The visits were used to collect data systematically, based on the interview guides and selected lines of inquiry to explore. Each country visit is expected to last three days, while the regional visits are expected to last two days.

196. To ensure efficiency, arrangements were made to build a three-day agenda for the virtual visits and efforts were deployed to reach out to the most relevant interviewees, secure interviews and ensure a robust schedule can be developed.

197. HQ Interviews: Although the ToR has specified in-person visits, there has not yet been sufficient justification for the additional costs and logistical challenges for organizing in-person visits. The list of global stakeholders includes persons based around the world and who will need to be interviewed remotely. In the current post-COVID era within a context of global warming, the onus is now to justify the potential costs and challenges for a visit against the added value that could be obtained from a physical visit. Visits are challenging logistically as well because they require organizing a concerted set of interviews from many stakeholders in a short period of time with limited flexibility to change the plans. Usually, the criteria justifying an in-person visit comes from one of two factors: i) there is a physical product that can be observed or reviewed for accountability and compliance; ii) there are classes of stakeholders who cannot be accessed remotely (such as FGDs with beneficiaries); and iii) the stakeholders who would be interviewed are sufficiently flexible in their schedules that they can be organized for interview in a short period of time.

198. For the HQ interviews, none of these criteria hold. There is limited utility in any physical observation of computers, and all stakeholders can be accessed remotely. Furthermore, for many of the stakeholders on the global interview list (Annex 10), their schedules are such that they could not be easily organized into a small-time window for interviews. As such, the RT proposes that the

HQ interviews be shifted to a remote format to allow for more streamlined organizing of the stakeholder interviews.

199. Presentations and analysis: A series of sharing exercises were organized throughout the review period with different classes of stakeholders to share preliminary findings and receive feedback from stakeholders. These are described in the following section 3.5. These exercises will provide opportunities to collectively analyse trends and discuss opportunities and challenges. The in-person technical level workshop were designed to promote discussions, group exercises and practical activities aimed at enhancing understanding and generating actionable insights. If approved by the SC, an additional in-person exercise can be added after the approval of the report with a very small group of OCHA leadership to focus on the practical implications for the implementation of the findings and recommendations.

Data analysis

200. A review matrix in Annex 3 describes in detail the dimensions, key questions, lines of inquiry, data collection methods and analysis methods. The review matrix is intended to serve as the foundation of the review process and dictates how the data were analysed from the four separate data collection threads employed in the data collection phase. Cumulatively, the evidence available against each question or performance indicator should enable a response to the relevant review questions.

201. Data analysis plans are adapted for each of the four data collection techniques as follows:

- Online Survey: The quantitative data from the online survey will largely rely on frequency analysis of the responses – disaggregated by gender and stakeholder as relevant. As mentioned in section 154 above, this data may be subject to response rate bias. However, the patterns in the frequency distributions can be used as complementary information to triangulate with the other sources of information.
- Desk Review: The platforms, products and document review were based on highlighting key themes identified and connected to the review matrix criteria. The CRAF'd survey will also have some relevance for IM issues. These findings were assessed against the review matrix questions and used for triangulation of data.
- Individual interviews: The qualitative data from the semi-structured interviews were first collected into a review response matrix connected to the specific review questions in the guides. The interview notes were compiled into a shared folder using a standard matrix for each interview. The review team will then review these notes and employ a standard qualitative approach of an iterative analysis of emergent themes.²⁷ Key thought units were identified in interviews. These will then be clustered into categories and emergent themes from each category were identified for further analysis and re-categorization to identify key patterns.
- Group interviews: The qualitative data from the group interviews were managed in a similar fashion to the individual interviews. However, the data were summarized to a larger extent since there were more internal discussions prior to developing notes. Respondents will themselves identify the key patterns in their discussions based on the specific questions used in the guides. These key patterns were collected by the review team and conclusions were drawn during the team analysis meetings.

202. Evidence for conclusions were built via **triangulation**. Data from interviews were coded and organized into themes via appropriate qualitative data software to identify emergent themes. Themes or patterns were examined to determine if they are coming from multiple stakeholder levels and multiple stakeholder categories. Observations or comments that are only coming from a sole source or a single category of stakeholder were given less conceptual weight during the building of the analysis. Findings highlighted in the report were those emerging from multiple actors and across multiple levels with distinct types of stakeholders.

203. Per the ToR, **a series of remote or in-person workshops** were organized with key stakeholders to take stock of the review, share progress, and receive feedback. These workshops will serve as platforms to discuss emerging trends and patterns, share views, co-create solutions, and reach a common understanding. They will foster a shared sense of ownership and accountability, ultimately contributing to the relevance, credibility and impact of the review outcomes. Details of the workshops planned as per the ToR are described below:

²⁷ Patton, Michael Quinn. 2010. Qualitative Research and Review. Sage Publication. San Francisco, California.

- At the end of the inception phase (mid-August), a virtual workshop was organized to finalize the review plan with the steering committee.
- At the end of data collection, a virtual presentation was scheduled to present preliminary findings to the steering committee and receive comments.
- At the data analysis stage, a 2-day in-person workshop was organized (likely in Istanbul) with technical-level stakeholders both within OCHA and within partners to allow for sharing progress and receiving feedback.
- At the end of the reporting phase, an online presentation was organized to present the final report to OCHA and the steering committee for approval. As noted above, this could be combined with an in-person workshop with a small group of OCHA leadership to discuss the practical implications for implementing the findings and recommendations. This is dependent on OCHA SC approval.

204. Workshops were designed to facilitate interactive discussions, group exercises and practical activities aimed at enhancing understanding and generating actionable insights.

Ensuring validity and reliability

205. The analytic process brings together evidence from the different information streams against the review matrix as the main analytical tool. To strengthen the validity of the findings, a series of layered triangulation techniques are applied to the data collection and data analysis processes. These include triangulation across four dimensions:

- **Data Types:** The review will gather information via the four qualitative, quantitative, and secondary data tools described above. Review questions to be explored are addressed in both qualitative and quantitative tools to serve as checks against each other.
- **Data Sources:** The information sources come from a wide range of stakeholders internal and external to OCHA. The case countries are reflective of different regions with different challenges.
- **Data Collectors:** The review team contains members from different nationalities and roles and experiences. The plan is to rotate who lead interviews and visits countries among the team members to ensure that no single evaluator has too much influence over the facilitation processes and that data collected in French and Spanish can be handled.
- **Consistent Tools:** A set of systematic tools for the four techniques were developed to ensure that the techniques are being applied in a consistent manner that can be cross-checked by outside agents.
- **Participatory Analysis:** For the conclusions and recommendations, the team will make use of its diversity to ensure that multiple perspectives are considered when reviewing the evidence against the review matrix. This were supplemented by an additional consultative approach with findings presented to and validated by the stakeholders during workshops and debriefings.

206. Complementarity were used to explain and understand findings obtained by one method by applying a second. Where findings diverge from the application of the different methods, these will need to be further investigated to either reconcile or explain the differences in findings.

Limitations and mitigation measures

207. Potential limitations were identified belonging to the different data collection methods and the formulation of recommendations. For each, the RT anticipated mitigation measures to ensure robustness and validity of data collected as detailed below.

Table 19: Limitations and mitigation measures

Review process	Potential limitations	Mitigation measures
Desk review of platforms, products and documents	▪ Difficulties getting access to documents, platforms, and products.	▪ The RT will expand the universe of platforms/products/documents analysed for the review to reach saturation in the qualitative research and increase information richness.
In-person country/regional visits	▪ Potential delays in organizing the visits, limited time to plan, overlapping with key	▪ Close communication will be maintained with OCHA to plan the visits in advance and allow sufficient time to build the schedules and make travel arrangements. Conflicting events will be kept in mind to avoid overlapping. In case of

Review process	Potential limitations	Mitigation measures
	events of the humanitarian agenda (HNO, UNGA).	inability to plan the visits with sufficient time, virtual cases will be considered.
Key Informant Interviews	▪ Difficulty to reach out to the large number of stakeholders identified for in-person interviews and to find timeslots accommodating their availabilities within the limited time allocated to data collection. ▪ Staff turnover creating loss of institutional memory.	▪ The RT will start planning visits early in the process to ensure interviewees receive notifications in advance and plan their time accordingly. In case of impossibility to meet specific stakeholders in-person, remote interviews will be organized. ▪ Interviewees with good knowledge of the IM and analysis landscape will be prioritized. If needed, the possibility to reach out to former colleagues will be explored.
Remote interviews	▪ Difficulties booking interviews with stakeholders in the allocated time for data collection due to informants' lack of time and response.	▪ OCHA will support the RT in reaching out to identified respondents and follow-up if needed. Sufficient time will be allocated to remote data collection considering potential delays in scheduling interviews.
Group interviews	▪ Stakeholder bias or conflicts of interest ▪ Existence of power dynamics within the groups preventing the informants to speak freely and share their views openly.	▪ Conflicting priorities, interests and agendas might increase the risk of bias. To mitigate this, a wide variety of stakeholders will be interviewed, and data collected will be triangulated among team members and with other sources. ▪ Power dynamics and balance will be considered for the formation of group interviews. Gender and position of interviewers will be determined accordingly to create safe spaces encouraging freedom of speech and transparency.
Online survey	▪ Limited number of responses to the online survey, hindering its use as a reliable source of information to draw findings	▪ OCHA's support will be requested to disseminate the survey to relevant stakeholders and send reminders to increase the participation rate. ▪ The survey will be used as a source of information complemented by other sources such as individual and group interviews to ensure triangulation.
Observation	▪ Limited or no access to facilities or tools to be observed and analysed.	▪ Minimum time will be allocated to observation during the country and regional office visits to ensure one of the team members gets access to the identified tools/facilities. ▪ Observation will be complemented by other data collection methods (individual interviews, group interviews) to reach a satisfactory level of reliability.
Elaboration of recommendations	▪ Factors affecting IM and analysis work lying outside the direct control of OCHA or unknown to the RT (e.g., funding allocation), can limit the RT ability to provide actionable recommendations for some of the weaknesses/bottlenecks identified.	▪ The RT will endeavour to get as much information as possible to avoid blind spots. ▪ Recommendations from areas of work under OCHA's control will be prioritized.
	▪ Wide variety of OCHA operational contexts/levels combined with a limited timeframe for the review constrains the RT's ability to provide specific	▪ The RT will try to identify patterns related to context specificities through interviews and visits to country/regional offices. ▪ Recommendations will be sufficiently broad to apply to a wide range of contexts while taking into consideration the patterns observed.

Review process	Potential limitations	Mitigation measures
	recommendations relevant for each country or regional office.	

Annex 4. Review Matrix

208. This review matrix describes in detail the categories of data to be analysed, key questions, lines of inquiry, data collection methods and analysis methods. The review matrix is intended to serve as the foundation of the review process and dictates how the data will be analysed from the four separate threads employed in the data collection phase. Cumulatively, the evidence available against each question or performance indicator should enable a response to the relevant review questions. All four data collection techniques will have their corresponding analyses.

Table 20: Review matrix

		Lines of Inquiry and Cross-Cutting Themes			
		These two columns serve as probes for elaborating responses during Key Informant Interviews			
Dimension	Primary Questions Principal Structure for guiding KIs	Lines of Inquiry (Review Questions) (Objective sub-questions)	Cross-cutting themes (Balancing Roles) (Review Goals)	Data sources	Data analysis
Leadership and Coordination	Q1 Determine OCHA's role in ensuring a coherent suite of humanitarian data/IM services and products (from OCHA and other actors).	Data and information leadership External facing coherence Consistency in the use of tools System-wide interoperability Aggregation services Analysis levels New Technologies and Methods (Old OQ7) What services and functions should OCHA deliver itself and what functions should it coordinate from others?	Strengthening OCHA's leadership and vision Coordination versus ownership Coherence for efficiency Coordination for effective or coherent suites of services	Review of available policies, documents and reports KIs with stakeholders Group interviews with stakeholders Online survey (humanitarian community)	Qualitative data analysis from desk review, KIs and Group interviews Quantitative Data analysis from online survey Triangulation of available information and data gathered
	Q2 What are the priority issues in this domain requiring coordination at the country, regional, and global level?	(Old OQ9) How could OCHA leverage technology to reduce transaction costs and barriers to data collection and insights?		Review of available policies, documents and reports KIs with stakeholders Group interviews with stakeholders	Qualitative data analysis from desk review, KIs and Group interviews Triangulation of available information and data gathered

Analysis is Analytical Offerings	Q3 Establish what analytic questions OCHA (internally and externally) needs to answer in the regional and country-level and at HQ.	Strategic Analysis Catalytic Financing Access IDPs Inclusion Response Analysis levels	Strategic versus Operational analysis needs Leadership and Vision: What services and functions should OCHA deliver itself and what functions should it coordinate from others? What analytical role should OCHA play? And what are the analytical offerings to support OCHA core functions and the humanitarian community at large. Increasing timeliness Increasing usefulness for decision making	Review of available policies, documents, and reports KIIs with stakeholders Group interviews with stakeholders Online survey (all OCHA staff) Site observation	Qualitative data analysis from desk review, site observation, KIIs and Group interviews Quantitative Data analysis from online survey Triangulation of available information and data gathered
Data Platforms Data Tools	Q4 Determine what common data platforms OCHA should provide to the humanitarian community.	Strategic Analysis Catalytic Financing Access IDPs Inclusion Response Timeliness Completeness External facing coherence Consistency in the use of tools System-wide interoperability Aggregation services New Technologies and Methods	Strategic versus Operational data needs Leadership and Vision: What services and functions should OCHA deliver itself and what functions should it coordinate from others? Coherent user experience What data generation roles should OCHA play? Increasing timeliness Increasing usefulness for decision making	Review of available products, platforms and documents KIIs with stakeholders Group interviews with stakeholders Online survey (all OCHA staff) Site observation	Qualitative data analysis from desk review, site observation, KIIs and Group interviews Quantitative Data analysis from online survey Triangulation of available information and data gathered
	Q5 How does this ideal state align with the current state? What changes should OCHA make to its current portfolio of data platforms?			Review of available products, platforms and documents KIIs with stakeholders Group interviews with stakeholders Online survey (all OCHA staff)	Qualitative data analysis from desk review, site observation, KIIs and Group interviews Quantitative Data analysis from online survey Triangulation of available information and data gathered

				Site observation	
Organizational Implications	Q6 What Organizational shifts, capacities, and resources does OCHA require to achieve the necessary common data platforms, answer analytic offerings and successfully coordinate this suite of IM services?	Data and information leadership Organizational Implications Resources Analysis Levels Aggregation of Services System wide interoperability External facing coherence Data handling (Original Q4) Internally what does OCHA need to do to improve the cohesion, support, and sustainability of corporate systems and infrastructure to manage data/information for timely analysis and decision-making? (Original Q14) Culture – how to Improve corporate level organizing principles to promote a data-driven culture and that we have the right people involved in analytical processes for informed decision-making. (People)	Reducing fragmentation Coordination for effective and coherent data analysis Strengthening OCHA's leadership and vision Organizational Shifts fit for purpose	Review of available documents, policies and reports KIIs with stakeholders Group interviews with stakeholders Site observation	Qualitative data analysis from desk review, site observation, KIIs and Group interviews Triangulation of available information and data gathered

Annex 5. Data Collection Schedule

Table 21: Data Collection Schedule

Phase-I: Planning & Inception Phase (2.5 Months)		
Task	Associated deliverable	Dates
Team orientation & initial planning		9 – 24 May
Desk review & evaluability assessment		27 May – 28 June
Consultations with OCHA/Hague Office remotely		27 May – 28 June
Develop a detailed work plan, including timelines and deliverables.		27 May – 28 June
Identify key stakeholders and establish communication channels.		27 May – 28 June
Prepare a draft inception report		17 June – 19 July
OCHA and Steering Committee Revision and Review Process		11 July – August 29
Organize and conduct a virtual workshop to finalize the review plan		August 29
Finalize the inception report	Inception Report	August 29
Phase-II: Data Collection & Analysis Phase (2.5 Months)		
Design and launch the global survey		October – November
Continued remote data collection – Global, Regional and Country including the selected “Countries of Interest”		September – November
Conduct in-person visit to Somalia		Week of Sept. 16
Conduct in-person visit to Nigeria		Week of Sept. 9
Conduct in-person visit to Ukraine		Week of October 14
Conduct in-person visit to Panama (Regional Office)		Week of Sept. 9
Data analysis (quantitative + qualitative) and synthesis.		November 4-13
Workshop on data analysis findings (in-person).	Evidence and Analysis exercises PPT	November 14, 15
Presentation to Steering Committee on Preliminary Findings	PPT	November 29
Draft the final review report, incorporating feedback from consultations.		Week of December 2
Submission of D0		December 3

Review and Revision Process from OCHA and SC		December 3-13
Submission of D1	Final Report ²⁸	December 16
Presentation by KonTerra to OCHA SLG of final report		Week of December 16
Prepare the PowerPoint and Public Report	PowerPoint , Public Report	20 December

²⁸ While it is assumed by the RT that the final report will be published, very few people will read a lengthy report with annexes. For this reason, the TOR describes the production of an additional public-facing report of reduced length for broader distribution.

Annex 6. Data Collection Tools

209. **Overview.** The purpose of the Review is to assess the principles, practices, and corporate systems used for data organization to ensure their suitability for implementing the new Strategic Plan 2023-2026. This assessment aims to enhance the humanitarian community's ability to use OCHA's information management (IM) and data tools, services, and capacities, thereby reinforcing OCHA's leadership among humanitarian actors.
210. **Methodology.** The review employs a mixed methods approach to gather comprehensive and diverse data. This approach combines qualitative and quantitative methods to provide a better understanding of the organization's processes and outcomes. For the qualitative data collection, semi-structured interviews have been chosen as one of the methodologies to implement.
211. **Key Informant Interviews.** Key informant interviews (KIs) will provide in-depth insights and perspectives from individuals who have a deep understanding of OCHA's IM and analysis practices and who use OCHA's products, tools and services. The interviews will target key stakeholders within OCHA, including senior leadership, Information Management Officers (IMOs), analysts, and other relevant staff members. Also, interviews will be conducted with external partners, including representatives from UN agencies, NGOs, donor organizations, and other humanitarian actors. By engaging with a diverse range of key informants, the review team will gain valuable first-hand knowledge about the strengths, weaknesses, opportunities, and challenges related to OCHA's IM and analysis efforts. The interviews will be semi-structured to allow for flexibility and exploration of key topics, ensuring the evaluation captures a comprehensive range of perspectives.
212. Both remote and in-person KIs will be conducted.
213. The KIs include global, regional, and country-level actors and decision makers. country offices selected for visits will be chosen through a 'country mapping' exercise, in which (6) countries will be selected as 'countries of focus' for prioritizing the KIs. In-person visits will be carried out in (2) of the (6) countries and the (4) remaining countries will be developed as 'virtual cases'. The selection of the COs and ROs will consider diverse categories of analysis to guarantee that the collected data is sufficiently representative of the breadth of variation in the OCHA system.
214. **Informed consent principles and the maintenance of confidentiality.** The RT will adhere to 2020 UNEG Ethical Guidelines and 2014 Guidelines on Integrating Human Rights and Gender Equality in Evaluations, as well as to the Pledge of Commitment to Ethical Conduct in Evaluation. In addition, the RT will follow any guidance specific to OCHA. Depending on the precise methods and data collection tools selected for the review, there could be specific ethical concerns that may arise which have not yet been identified by the RT. In some cases, the RT may collect data and conduct interviews that would make participants vulnerable to the effects of local emergencies; in these situations, the team will carefully weigh the value for the evaluation of each stakeholder's participation in juxtaposition with the opportunity cost of time and effort vis-à-vis their other ongoing commitments. Informed consent principles and the maintenance of confidentiality are crucial pillars of any data collection exercise. In this case, interviewees will be informed at the start of the interview regarding the purpose of the evaluation, assurances of voluntary participation, and confidentiality of all responses. During data collection, the RT will treat all personal identity information and sensitive personal data in a strictly confidential manner to avoid any harm or threat to the safety of participants.
215. The RT will follow the principles of non-nuisance, avoiding questions, attitudes or comments that are judgmental or may expose stakeholders to humiliation or reactive pain. Wherever possible, group interviews will be organized in a manner where stakeholders - particularly women - do not feel undue social pressure or exclusion.
216. **Central level Stakeholders - KI Semi-Structured Interview Guides.** These guides are intended to serve as "semi-structured" interview guides. Such guides offer direction for the conversation while allowing for flexibility and modifications as needed. As semi-structured guides, facilitators can delve deeper into topics as they arise and should have the freedom to explore emerging themes relevant to the overall review matrix and objectives. It is important to recognize that not all questions will be applicable to every stakeholder group. Therefore, interviewers should rephrase the questions as necessary to suit their specific audiences.

217. Each section covers a different segment of the conceptual framework which aligns the review and objective questions into four categories: leadership/coordination, data tools, data analysis, and possible organizational shifts.
218. Some questions may be asked only to internal OCHA's stakeholders while others may be asked of all central level stakeholders.
219. The interviewer should foresee about 45-60 minutes on average for each KII interview.
220. The interviewers should introduce themselves and clarify the purpose of the evaluation, as well as the confidentiality of the interview (i.e., when quoting KIs, attribution will be made to categories of stakeholders, not individuals or organizations).
221. Moreover, the interviewee will briefly introduce him/herself, title and function, gender, years of service in the organization. Once this information is presented, the interviewer will start with the suggested interview questions. As stated above, the interviewer will guide the questions, and depending on factors such as role, organization/institutions, division, etc. of the interviewee, the interviewer could prioritize certain questions and avoid others.

Top 10 Questions

Intro

Before we begin, can you describe your role and how you are connected to the overall IM ecosystem?

Platforms, tools and services

1. To what extent does OCHA's current data platforms and data services align with the needs of the humanitarian community?
 1. *Probing around: External facing coherence, Consistency in the use of tools, System-wide interoperability, Synthesis or aggregation, New Technologies and Methods*
 - a. What have been some of the most successful actions by OCHA for IM?
 - b. What have been some of the major challenges facing IM?
 - i. Are there tools, platforms, or services that are no longer fit for purpose?

Analytical offerings

2. Which analytic questions and needs (internally and externally) are currently being answered by OCHA at global levels?
3. What analytics questions or needs are being unaddressed by the humanitarian system?

Common Platforms

4. What common data platforms should OCHA provide to the humanitarian community?
Probing around: continue to provide, should start to provide, should cease to provide

Oral History

5. We'd like to hear more about the emergence of <illustrative cases of newly developed tools, platforms, centres or services> and what has happened since. Can you tell us something of this history?
Probing around: impetus for starting, how the decision was taken, funding, evolution, challenges, sustainability, and next steps

Coordination

6. To what extent is OCHA successfully leading and coordinating humanitarian data and IM services and products?
 - a. What have been some challenges for OCHA in coordination?
 - b. What services and functions should OCHA deliver itself and what functions should it coordinate from others?
Probe around: Necessary structures, capacities and resources, Reduced fragmentation Appropriate people involved, Data handling, appropriate policy and guidance
7. Where are some of the challenges in IM coordination within the system in general beyond OCHA's control?
 - a. What are the issues in information management and data analytics domain requiring coordination at the global level?

Recommendations

8. What organizational shifts, including capacities and resources, does OCHA need to achieve the necessary common data platforms, answer analytic offerings and successfully coordinate IM services.

Platforms, Data Aggregation & Consistency

Objective Question

- 1.1 Determine what common data platforms OCHA should provide to the humanitarian community.
- 1.2 How does the ideal state of its data platforms' use align with the current state and what changes should OCHA make to its current portfolio of data platforms?

Sub-Question

- 1.3 To what extent OCHA's current data platforms align with the needs of the humanitarian community.

Interview Questions	Lines of Inquiry
<u>Platforms</u> Which OCHA data and platforms do you use in your role? What factors inhibit/constrain or facilitate the use of OCHA's data and platforms? To what extent do OCHA's current platforms provide a coherent experience for humanitarian users? How can OCHA streamline its platforms for optimal use? What changes should be made for this to happen? Which platforms are most effective (e.g., for answering your analytical questions, informing decision making, providing situational awareness, facilitating coordination, etc.) and why? Which platforms need adjustments to be more effective? What suggestions do you have for adjustments to help the platforms effectively meet the needs? Which platforms do you consider useful for improving the system coordination and are not currently available or in use? <u>Data interoperability, aggregation & consistency in tools [COLLECTS DATA]</u> How can OCHA ensure that novel data methods and technologies are appropriately integrated into the humanitarian system? What is going well and what can be improved with OCHA's data aggregation and interoperability services and tools? What is going well and what can be improved with the consistency and utility of OCHA's platforms and tools across countries?	External facing coherence Consistency in the use of tools System-wide interoperability Aggregation services New Technologies and Methods How could OCHA leverage technology to reduce transaction costs and barriers to data collection?

Organizational Implications

Objective Question

2.1. What Organizational shifts, capacities and resources does OCHA require to achieve the necessary common data platforms?

2.2. What organizational shifts, capacities, and resources does OCHA require to answer analytic offerings?

2.3 What organizational shifts, capacities, and resources does OCHA require to successfully coordinate the suite of IM services?

Sub-Question

2.10. To what extent does OCHA's capacities and resources achieve the necessary common data platforms for answering analytics offerings and successfully coordinate the suite of Information Management services?

Interview Questions	Lines of Inquiry
What do you consider to be some of the current bottlenecks in the system for IM around data collection, processing, analysis, presentation and utilization?	Fragmentation
What do you see as OCHA's role is in addressing any of these bottlenecks?	Data handling
Do you think there are some organizational shifts that OCHA could do to improve the cohesion, support, and sustainability of corporate systems and infrastructure to manage data/information for timely analysis and decision-making? [INTERNAL]	Appropriate people involved in decision making
How could OCHA configure its setup internally to maximize its IM current capacities? [INTERNAL]	
How could country, regional, and global level IM capacities internally be maximized? [INTERNAL]	
How could OCHA improve or develop, internally at a corporate level, to promote a data-driven culture and have skilled people involved in analytical processes for informed decision-making? [INTERNAL]	

Analysis & Analytical Offerings

Objective Question

3.1 Establish what analytic questions OCHA (internally and externally) needs to answer in the regional and country-level and at HQ.

Sub-Question

3.1 To what extent does OCHA respond to analytical questions of relevance in the territory (CO and ROs) and HQ.

Interview Questions	Lines of Inquiry
How effectively do the analytic questions addressed by OCHA contribute to creating a responsive humanitarian system and providing foresight for guiding humanitarian operations?	Strategic Analysis
What analytical questions or needs do you or your organization have that are unaddressed by the humanitarian system?	Catalytic Financing
What analytical products do you use/find useful?	Access
What improved practices for responsibly handling of data and information can you suggest, including the use of analytical frameworks for prioritized collection and use? <u>[COLLECTS DATA]</u>	IDPs
What do you consider to be the most important analytical offerings to support OCHA's core functions and the humanitarian community at large? <u>[INTERNAL]</u>	Inclusion
Which analytics offerings could be provided by OCHA to provide systematic and predictable leadership on Access, IDPs?	Response
What analytical role should OCHA play in the humanitarian system?	Analysis levels

Leadership & Coordination

Objective Question

4.1. Determine OCHA's role in ensuring a coherent suite of humanitarian data/IM services and products (from OCHA and other actors)

4.2. What are the priority issues in this domain requiring better effort coordination at the country, regional, and global level?

Sub-Question

4.10 To what extent OCHA's divisions roles and responsibilities contribute to ensuring a coherent suite of humanitarian data/IM Services and products?

4.11 To what extent is OCHA coordinating with success of humanitarian data and IM services and products?

Interview Questions	Lines of Inquiry
In your experience, what is OCHA's role in IM leadership and coordination? What OCHA coordination mechanisms facilitate coherence in the organization/aggregation, analysis and use of data at local, regional and global levels? Which functions should OCHA provide itself and which should it coordinate from others? What organizational shifts, capacities and resources does OCHA still require for successfully coordinating externally the IM and data domain? Are you aware of any Guidance on IM platforms and products provided by OCHA? Where do you find the Guidance on IM and products?	Data and information leadership Leadership and Vision: What services and functions should OCHA deliver itself and what functions should it coordinate from others? IM Guidance

Data Platforms	Comments
Additional platforms that were not part of list:	
Analytical Products	Comments
Additional analytical products not on the list:	

Interviews with key informants will be used as an opportunity to double check the knowledge and use of the main platforms and products related to the IM and analysis work. The table below will be completed with key platforms / products and used as discussion points with Kis.

Oral History Exercise

<Internal Platform Owners/Managers> This is to be used with internal stakeholders who can discuss the emergence and evolution of selected illustrative cases of platforms products and tools. Cases will come from categories of flourished, duplicates, and isolates.

Interview Questions	Lines of Inquiry
We'd like to hear more about the emergence of <Insert> and what has happened since. Can you tell us something of this history? First of all, can you tell us a bit about how you heard about/became involved in this intervention? • How was this started? Where did the idea come from? • How was the decision taken to sponsor this exercise? • How have things evolved since the beginning? • What were some of the challenges encountered? How did these get navigated? If you could start this process over again, what should be done differently? How are things going now? What have been some successes? How has sustainability been addressed? Have there been sustainability challenges? Has this intervention led to any other adaptations or changes within OCHA? What do you see as the next steps in this process? How has the overall decision making been involved to ensure that this intervention is part of a coherent suite of tools, products, and systems?	Coordination and leadership Organizational implications and Capacity Data and information leadership Leadership and Vision: What services and functions should OCHA deliver itself and what functions should it coordinate from others? IM Guidance Fragmentation Data handling Appropriate people involved in decision making

Global Online Survey

222. The survey will serve as the tool to gather insights and perspectives from stakeholders across the global humanitarian community, providing a broad and diverse range of inputs into the review process. Utilizing surveys at the global level will enable teams to reach a wide audience, including external partners, UN agencies, NGOs, and other relevant stakeholders.
223. The survey will be designed to collect feedback on various aspects of OCHA's information management and analysis practices, including: the effectiveness of current systems, perceived challenges, and suggestions for improvement.
224. By soliciting input from a diverse array of stakeholders, the surveys will ensure that the review captures a comprehensive understanding of the global landscape and incorporates perspectives from a wide range of actors. Additionally, the survey will allow for a quantitative analysis, enabling the review team to identify trends, patterns, and areas of consensus or divergence among respondents. This data will be instrumental in informing the review's findings and recommendations, providing valuable insights into the strengths and weaknesses of OCHA's IM and analysis efforts at the global level.
225. Sampling Strategy: The sampling approach for the global survey will be designed to ensure representation of diverse perspectives and contexts. Given the usual low response rate for online surveys, a census approach may be adopted.

Introductory Letter

Dear Colleague,

We invite you to participate in the OCHA Information Management and Analysis Organizational Review, which aims to enhance OCHA's IM and analysis products and services to better meet the needs of strategic and operational decision-makers. This review seeks to identify the necessary analysis, information, and data required to support effective humanitarian response and coordination.

Your insights and experiences are crucial to this process. By participating in this survey, you will help us identify strengths and areas for improvement in OCHA's IM products and services. The survey should take no longer than 10 minutes to complete, and your responses will be confidential.

We have designed the survey to gather your feedback on the following areas:

- Utility and effectiveness of OCHA's analytical products.*
- Leadership and coordination in information management.*
- Suggestions for improvements.*

Your participation will provide valuable insights into the global landscape of humanitarian information management and will inform the review's findings and recommendations. We appreciate your time and effort in completing this survey.

Please click the link below to start the survey:

[Survey Link]

If you have any questions or concerns, please contact [contact information].

Thank you for your contribution to improving OCHA's information management practices.

Best regards,

Introduction

The following questions will be used to disaggregate findings to help determine which stakeholders in which geographic locations are providing valuable feedback, and where attention can be focused.

1. What type of organization do you represent? (Single Select) (Mandatory)
 - ☐ OCHA
 - ☐ National or Local NGO
 - ☐ International NGO (operational) (examples DRC, CRS, MSF, etc)
 - ☐ Research organization or Academic (examples REACH, iMMAP, etc)
 - ☐ UN Agency
 - ☐ Donor
 - ☐ National/Local Government
 - ☐ Community-based Organization
 - ☐ Other (Please specify)
2. Gender: Please indicate how you would describe yourself (Single Select) (Mandatory)
 - ☐ Female
 - ☐ Male
 - ☐ Non-binary
 - ☐ Other
 - ☐ Prefer not to answer
3. Disability: Do you consider yourself to have any of the following conditions (Select all that apply) (Mandatory)
 - ☐ A vision problem that prevents reading print even when wearing glasses or contacts
 - ☐ A hearing problem that prevents normal conversation even with a hearing aid.
 - ☐ Difficulty learning, remembering or concentrating?
 - ☐ Other
 - ☐ None
 - ☐ Prefer not to answer
4. Role: What is your role within your organization? (Dropdown list) (Mandatory) (Executive, Managerial, IM Technical, Operational)
5. Where are you located and primarily work? (Single Select) (Mandatory)
 - ☐ Global
 - ☐ Regional Office
 - ☐ Country Office (including sub-offices and in-country hubs)
6. Which country do you work in? (Single Select) (Mandatory)

Products & Analysis

Rate the utility (that is the usefulness and ease of use) of the following products.

7. Within your context, what are the primary products and analytical offerings OCHA offers? (List all that apply)

8. Please rate the collection of OCHA's suite of products and analytical offerings within your context on the four dimensions below.

	Excellent	Good	Fair	Poor	Don't know/N.A.
a. Comprehensiveness of data					
b. Integration of data from multiple sources					
c. Contributions to situational awareness					
d. Responsive to changes in context and operational environment					
e. Support to access					
f. Support to coordination efforts					
g. Support to data-informed decision making					
h. Accessibility of OCHA's IM products to persons facing disabilities.					

9. What are pending data analysis gaps that you still face in your context?

OCHA Leadership and Coordination

10. How would you rate OCHA's **Leadership** in information management at the following levels (please answer for all levels no matter where you are based)?
(Leadership includes in articulating a vision for the future of humanitarian response, and identifying steps to progress toward that vision, throughout the information management cycle i.e., data planning, data collection, data analysis and data presentation)

	Excellent	Good	Fair	Poor	Not enough information to say
Global					
Regional					
Country					

11. For any level you marked as fair or poor, what suggestions can you offer to improve leadership at that level. (Open-ended) (Optional)

12. How would you rate OCHA's **coordination** in information management?

(This includes tactically convening actors, identifying standards, determining gaps and overlaps, and advocating to address those gaps and overlaps across themes throughout the information management cycle i.e., data planning, data collection, data analysis and data presentation at the level you currently work in – Global, Regional and Country.)

	Excellent	Good	Fair	Poor	Not enough information to say
Global					
Regional					
Country					

13. For any level you marked as fair or poor, what suggestions can you offer to improve coordination at that level. (Open-ended) (Optional)

14. What overall suggestions do you have for OCHA to improve its Platforms, Tools, Products and/or IM practices moving forward? (Open-ended) (Optional)

Annex 7. **Persons Interviewed**

226. Due to data confidentiality considerations and recent shifts in the guidance on the ethical treatment of interviewed stakeholders, names and titles are withheld to avoid potential linkages between respondents and reported findings.

Table 22: Persons Interviewed

Type of Interview	Office	OCHA	United Nations	Donors and Govt.	NGOs & Others	Total
Remote Interviews	Global	22	16	7	21	66
	Nairobi (ROSEA)	1	1	0	1	3
	Bangkok (ROAP)	3	1	0	2	6
	Yemen	4	2	1	0	8
	Haiti	2	1	0	1	4
In-Person Visits	Panama (ROLAC)	10	6	0	4	21
	Jordan (ROMENA)	4	5	0	2	13
	Somalia	10	25	1	11	47
	Nigeria	5	5	2	99	21
	Ukraine	6	16	1	10	32
Total		67	78	13	61	219

Annex 8. Quantitative Data

8.1 OCHA IM Inventory Mapping

227. During the inception phase, the review team developed an analytical framework to systematically conduct the analysis of key Services, Platforms, Tools, Products, and Policies/Frameworks for the review. The OCHA data governance committee provided the summary of tools, platforms and services that they are tracking (Table 1).
228. This summary is incomplete, yet as other branches and units maintain their own lists of tools, platforms, and services. During the data collection phase, the additional data from other branches will be collected and integrated with the data governance committee's inventory.
229. The precise definitions of what constitutes a service, platform, tool, or product are not universally shared. For the purposes of this review, the following definitions are used regarding what constitutes IM Services, Platforms, Tools, and Products.

Definition: Information Management Services

230. IM Services refer to the comprehensive suite of activities and processes involved in collecting, processing, analysing, storing, and disseminating humanitarian information. These services ensure that reliable and timely data is available to support strategic, technical, and operational decision-making in humanitarian response. Key components of IM services include:
- Data Collection: Gathering data from various sources, including visits to country and regional offices assessments, reports, satellite imagery, and social media.
 - Data Processing: Cleaning, validating, and organizing data to ensure its accuracy and consistency.
 - Data Analysis: Using analytical tools and techniques to interpret data, identify trends, and generate insights.
 - Data Storage: Securely storing data in databases and repositories for easy access and retrieval.
 - Data Dissemination: Sharing information through reports, dashboards, maps, bulletins, and other formats to support decision-making and coordination.
231. IM services are critical for effective humanitarian response as they provide a foundation for coordination, situational awareness, and strategic planning. They enable humanitarian actors to understand the needs of affected populations, monitor response efforts, and make informed decisions.

232. Example: The Centre for Humanitarian Data functions primarily as an IM Service due to its comprehensive range of offerings that support the entire data management lifecycle in humanitarian contexts. It provides critical support in making data accessible, ensuring responsible data use, building data literacy, and applying data science to humanitarian challenges. These services are integral to improving the effectiveness and impact of humanitarian response through better data management and utilization.

Definition: Information Management Platform

233. IM Platform refers to an integrated digital environment that supports the execution of IM services by providing the necessary infrastructure, tools, and applications for data collection, processing, analysis, storage, and dissemination. An IM platform typically includes:

- Data Management Systems: Databases and data warehouses for storing and managing large volumes of data.
- Analytical Tools: Software for data analysis, visualization, and reporting.
- Collaboration Tools: Applications that facilitate information sharing and collaboration among humanitarian actors.
- User Interface: A user-friendly interface that allows users to interact with the platform, access information, and perform IM tasks efficiently.

234. IM platforms are designed to enhance the efficiency and effectiveness of IM services by providing a centralized, accessible, and scalable environment for managing humanitarian information. They support interoperability, data integration, and collaboration across different organizations and sectors.

235. Example: ReliefWeb primarily functions as an IM Platform due to its comprehensive infrastructure and integration capabilities, supporting the aggregation, organization, and dissemination of humanitarian information. It plays a crucial role in OCHA's IM services by providing a centralized hub for reliable and timely information critical to the international humanitarian community.

Definition: Information Management Tool

236. IM Tool refers to a specific application or software used within an IM platform to perform particular tasks related to information management. IM tools are specialized for various functions, including data collection, analysis, visualization, and reporting. Examples of IM tools include:

- Data Collection Tools: Applications for gathering data from the regional and country offices, such as mobile data collection apps and online survey platforms.

- Data Analysis Tools: Software for analysing data, identifying patterns, and generating insights, such as statistical analysis software and GIS tools.
 - Data Visualization Tools: Applications for creating visual representations of data, including charts, graphs, and maps.
 - Reporting Tools: Software for generating and disseminating reports, such as report writing tools and automated reporting systems.
237. IM tools are essential components of an IM platform, providing the functionality needed to carry out specific IM tasks. They enable humanitarian actors to efficiently manage and utilize data to support informed decision-making and effective response operations.
238. Example: OCHA HPC tools are IM tools designed to support specific functions within the humanitarian programme cycle. When integrated into broader systems, they can also be seen as components of an IM platform. Their use in delivering IM services highlights their role in the comprehensive suite of activities essential for effective humanitarian response.

Definition: Information Management Product

239. IM Product refers to any output generated through information management processes that provides valuable insights, data, or analysis to support decision-making, coordination, and operational activities in humanitarian contexts. IM products are designed to meet the information needs of various stakeholders, including humanitarian organizations, donors, governments, and affected communities. They are tailored to specific audiences and purposes, ensuring that the right information is delivered in a timely and accessible manner.

Characteristics of IM Products

- Purpose-Driven: Each IM product is created with a specific purpose in mind, whether it is to inform strategic decisions, support operational planning, provide situational awareness, or facilitate communication and advocacy.
- Audience-Specific: IM products are tailored to the needs of their intended audience, ensuring that the information is relevant, understandable, and actionable for different stakeholder groups.
- Data-Backed: IM products are based on accurate, comprehensive, and up-to-date data. They undergo rigorous processes of data collection, analysis, and validation to ensure reliability.
- Format and Presentation: IM products can take various formats, including reports, dashboards, maps, infographics, bulletins, and websites. The presentation is designed to maximize clarity and ease of use, often incorporating visual elements to enhance understanding.
- Timeliness: Timeliness is a critical aspect of IM products. They are produced and disseminated in a timeframe that ensures the information remains relevant and useful for decision-making processes.

Examples of IM Products

- *Situation Reports: Regularly updated reports that provide an overview of the current humanitarian situation, including needs, response activities, gaps, and challenges.*
- *Humanitarian Bulletins: Periodic publications that summarize key information and updates on humanitarian operations, funding, and coordination efforts.*
- *Maps and Infographics: Visual representations of data, such as geographic distributions of affected populations, resource allocation, and operational presence of humanitarian actors.*
- *Dashboards: Interactive online platforms that allow users to explore and analyse data through various visualizations and filters.*
- *Needs Assessments Reports: Detailed reports that assess the needs of affected populations, often based on surveys, key informant interviews, and secondary data analysis.*
- *Response Plans: Strategic documents outlining the planned humanitarian response, including objectives, activities, resource requirements, and coordination mechanisms.*

240. The following table organizes the available inventory shared by OCHA during the inception phase for this review. The inventory will be further expanded during the data collection phase as other OCHA units and branches participate.

Table 23: OCHA IM Inventory²⁹³⁰

Internal OCHA or External Public	Category	Description	Duplicates Another Service?	Property Name	Branch or Office
External	IM Tool	Provides documentation about the use of ReliefWeb APIs, which are specific applications for accessing data.		ReliefWeb API Documentation	Information Management Branch

²⁹ This table was provided by OCHA data governance committee. It does not constitute all existing tools, products, or analytical products. The table will continue to be updated throughout the data collection phase as other OCHA units share their internal inventories not yet covered by the data governance committee inventory: [Provided by OCHA 10Jul24_Combined OCHA Digital Inventory.xlsx](#)

³⁰ This information is provided by the OCHA governance committee in their inventory list and is presented as described by OCHA. The two columns added by the Review Team are the Category (based on the definitions described above) and whether to include the specific product in the review.

External	IM Tool	An authentication service used by humanitarian actors.	Yes	Humanitarian ID	Information Management Branch
External	IM Tool	A tool to transform spreadsheets using the Humanitarian Exchange Language (HXL).		Humanitarian Exchange Language Proxy	Information Management Branch
External	IM Tool	Provides information about the Humanitarian Exchange Language, which is a tool for data standardization.		Humanitarian Exchange Language	Information Management Branch
External	IM Tool	A wiki used for documentation and best practices.		Atlassian Wiki	Information Management Branch
External	IM Platform	A comprehensive platform for accessing reports, maps, and infographics.		ReliefWeb	Information Management Branch
External	IM Service	It provides the necessary infrastructure, tools, and resources to support various aspects of humanitarian data management, including data accessibility, ethical use, capacity building, and innovation.		Centre for Humanitarian Data	Information Management Branch
External	IM Tool	Provides information and FAQs about the Humanitarian ID authentication service.	Yes	Humanitarian ID - About and FAQ	Information Management Branch
External	IM Tool	Provides information sharing about controlled vocabularies with APIs.	Yes	Taxonomy Service	Information Management Branch
Internal	IM Tool	A demo site to highlight common design patterns for OCHA sites.		OCHA Brand Portal - Common Design	Information Management Branch
External	IM Platform	A specialized digital service to coordinate information in operations.	Yes	ReliefWeb Response	Information Management Branch

External	IM Platform	A platform for sharing humanitarian datasets.		Humanitarian Data Exchange	Information Management Branch
External	IM Tool	A page for an embedded PowerBI dashboard for tracking who does what and where.	Yes	OCHA 3W	Information Management Branch
External	IM Tool	A page for an embedded PowerBI dashboard for common operational datasets.	Yes	Common Operational Datasets	Information Management Branch
External	IM Tool	A managed platform in partnership for data collection and analysis.		Kobo Toolbox - OCHA Tenant	Information Management Branch
External	IM Platform	A donation site for OCHA-managed pooled funds.	Yes	UN Crisis Relief	Strategic Communications
External	IM Tool	A SaaS site used for campaigns featuring images and short texts.	Yes	OCHA Exposure	Strategic Communications
External	IM Platform	The corporate website for communications.		UNOCHA corporate web site	Strategic Communications
Internal	IM Tool	Manages OCHA branding resources.		OCHA Brand Portal	Strategic Communications
External	IM Tool	Provides information about previous campaigns for World Humanitarian Day.	Yes	About WHD	Strategic Communications
External	IM Product	A platform for sharing reference maps by country.	Yes	Humanitarian Atlas	Operations and Advocacy
External	IM Tool	A wiki for materials on humanitarian, peace, and development topics in Colombia.	Yes	OCHA Colombia Wiki	Operations and Advocacy
External	IM Tool	A dashboard for the humanitarian situation in Colombia.		Monitor Humanitario	Operations and Advocacy
External	IM Tool	An emergency response tracking dashboard for Colombia.		Colombia Emergency Response Tracker	Operations and Advocacy

External	IM Tool	Provides various tools for humanitarian operations.	Yes	Humanitarian Tools	Operations and Advocacy
External	IM Product	An online guide for disaster managers in Asia and the Pacific.	Yes	Disaster Response in Asia and the Pacific	Operations and Advocacy
Internal	IM Tool	A tool for monitoring implementation of preparedness actions.		SARA - Preparedness Tracker	Operations and Advocacy
External	IM Service	Enhances security collaboration between the UN, NGOs, and international organizations.		Saving Lives Together	Operations and Advocacy
External	IM Tool	An online system for tracking preparedness and response actions.	Yes	345W - Preparedness & Response	Operations and Advocacy
External	IM Platform	A communications site specific to the OCHA OPT office.	Yes	UNOCHA oPt country site	Operations and Advocacy
External	IM Product	A platform for sharing reference maps by country.	Yes	oPt Humanitarian Atlas	Operations and Advocacy
External	IM Tool	A platform for tracking Who, What, Where, When, Why for OPT operations.	Yes	oPt 5W Plus	Operations and Advocacy
External	IM Tool	A platform for access coordination for OCHA OPT.		oPt Access Coordination	Operations and Advocacy
External	IM Product	A platform for sharing reference maps by country for the Central African Republic.	Yes	Humanitarian Atlas - CAR	Operations and Advocacy
External	IM Service	Promotes better disaster management in West Africa.	Yes	GECEAO	Operations and Advocacy
External	IM Product	A platform for sharing reference maps by country for West and Central Africa.	Yes	Humanitarian Atlas - ROWCA	Operations and Advocacy
External	IM Platform	An online platform for dashboards related to the Syria response.	Yes	UNOCHA Syria Hub	Operations and Advocacy
External	IM Platform	A tool for accessing basic figures and data related to humanitarian activities in West and Central Africa.	Yes	OCHA ROWCA DataHub Web	Operations and Advocacy

External	IM Platform	A server for storing data related to humanitarian activities in West and Central Africa.	Yes	OCHA ROWCA DataHub Server	Operations and Advocacy
Internal	IM Product	A platform for digital situation reporting for OCHA offices.	Yes	Digital Situation Report	Operations and Advocacy
Internal	IM Tool	A tool for tracking leave and attendance for the OCHA OPT office.		oPt Attendance tracker	Operations and Advocacy
External	IM Product	Provides data on demolitions in the West Bank.		oPt Data on West Bank demolitions	Operations and Advocacy
External	IM Product	An online database for education-related incidents.		oPt Education Related Incidents online database	Operations and Advocacy
External	IM Tool	An online database for tracking Gaza crossings.		oPt Gaza Crossings	Operations and Advocacy
Internal	IM Product	An archive gallery for OCHA OPT.		oPt OCHA Archive Gallery	Operations and Advocacy
External	IM Product	An online database for protection of civilians.		oPt Protection Of Civilians Online Database	Operations and Advocacy
External	IM Tool	An online database for protection of civilians		Yemen YHF BFCM Tracker	Operations and Advocacy
External	IM Tool	A tracking system for Yemen CFM (Complaints and Feedback Mechanism).		Yemen CFM Tracking System	Operations and Advocacy
External	IM Tool	A platform for clusters, accountability, and M&E in Yemen.		Yemen Clusters / Accountability / M&E	Operations and Advocacy
External	IM Tool	A deconfliction notification system for Yemen.		Yemen Deconfliction Notification System	Operations and Advocacy
External	IM Tool	A tool for Multi-Cluster Location Assessment in Yemen.		Yemen MCLA	Operations and Advocacy
External	IM Tool	A tool for Multi-Purpose Cash Assistance in Yemen.		Yemen MPCA	Operations and Advocacy

External	IM Tool	A tracker for Rapid Needs Assessment in Yemen.		Yemen RNA Tracker	Operations and Advocacy
External	IM Tool	A tracking system for Yemen TS.		Yemen TS Tracking System	Operations and Advocacy
External	IM Platform	CLIMAP serves as a comprehensive platform for monitoring and analysing climate impacts, which aligns with the characteristics of an IM Platform as it supports the integration, analysis, and dissemination of data related to climate impacts.		Climate Impact Monitoring and Analysis Platform (CLIMAP)	Operations and Advocacy
External	IM Platform	A data visualization platform for CERF and CBFP.		Pooled Funds Data Hub	Financing and Partnership
Internal	IM Platform	A centralized portal for grant management.		Grant Management System (GMS) Public Portal	Financing and Partnership
Internal	IM Tool	A system for tracking OCHA contributions.		OCHA Contribution Tracking (OCT)	Financing and Partnership
External	IM Platform	A private site for the OCHA Donor Support Group.		OCHA Donor Support Group	Financing and Partnership
External	IM Tool	Manages pooled fund cases.		Partner portal	Financing and Partnership
Internal	IM Tool	Provides API documentation.		CERF Data API Documentation	Financing and Partnership
External	IM Platform	A public site for CERF stakeholders.		CERF	Financing and Partnership
Internal	IM Platform	An exclusive data hub for CBFP.		CBFP Data Hub	Financing and Partnership
Internal	IM Platform	An exclusive data hub for CERF.		CERF Data Hub	Financing and Partnership
External	IM Tool	Provides practical guidance for building an anticipatory action framework.	Yes	Anticipatory Action Toolkit	Financing and Partnership

External	IM Product	A collection of stories showing the impact of OCHA-managed pooled funds.	Yes	Pooled Funds Impact Stories	Financing and Partnership
External	IM Platform	A platform supporting the lifecycle of projects granted by OCHA's Pooled Funds.		One Grant Management System	Financing and Partnership
Internal	IM Tool	Provides API documentation.		One Grant Management System - API documentation	Financing and Partnership
Internal	IM Platform	A space for UN OCHA staff to find wellbeing advice.		UNOCHA Wellbeing	Executive Office
Internal	IM Product	Provides courses for OCHA staff.		OCHA Learn	Executive Office
Internal	IM Product	Archive of the World Humanitarian Summit documentation.		Agenda for Humanity (Archived)	Coordination Division
External	IM Platform	Centralized platform for humanitarian funding flows.		Financial Tracking Service	Coordination Division
External	IM Tool	The Nexus Environmental Assessment Tool (NEAT+), providing project-level environmental screening.		Neat+	Coordination Division
External	IM Tool	An online portal for partner organizations to register projects.		HPC: Projects	Coordination Division
External	IM Tool	Streamlines the creation and monitoring of strategic frameworks for humanitarian responses.		HPC: Response Planning & Monitoring	Coordination Division
External	IM Tool	Provides information on using the Gender and Age Marker.		IASC Gender with Age Marker (GAM)	Operations and Advocacy
External	IM Platform	Official website for the IASC, providing resources and policy formulations.		IASC Inter-Agency Standing Committee	Coordination Division
External	IM Platform	Repository of USAR team classifications and guidelines.		INSARAG	Coordination Division
External	IM Product	Reference tool on the Security Council's practice on the protection of civilians in armed conflict.		Protection of Civilians Aide-Memoire	Operations and Advocacy

External	IM Tool	Utilizes Enketo forms to collect data from operations and clusters.		Humanitarian Coordination Mapping	Coordination Division
External	IM Platform	Official website for the P2P project.		Deliver Aid Better	Coordination Division
External	IM Platform	Virtual OSOCC platform for real-time collaboration and information sharing during emergencies.		Emergency Response Collaboration Platforms (VOSOCC, HNPW, LEP & others)	Coordination Division
External	IM Platform	Public-facing platform visualizing various stages of the HPC.		HPC: Humanitarianaction.info	Coordination Division
External	IM Tool	Brings humanitarian and environmental communities together for sustainable disaster management.		EHA Connect	Coordination Division
External	IM Platform	Facilitates collaboration between the private sector and humanitarian organizations.		Connecting Business Initiative	Coordination Division
External	IM Platform	Provides information relevant to preparedness, prevention, and response to environmental emergencies.		Environmental Emergencies Center	Coordination Division
External	IM Platform	Global resource website for Humanitarian Civil-Military Coordination.		Humanitarian / Military Dialogue	Coordination Division
External	IM Product	Comprehensive resource hub for environmental emergency management.		EEC Learning Centre	Coordination Division
External	IM Tool	Provides policies and procedures on PSEA, with data and awareness-raising materials.		IASC Protection from Sexual Exploitation and Abuse	Coordination Division
Internal	IM Product	Archival site linked through Humanitarian Action for the Global Humanitarian Overview.		GHO 2021	Coordination Division
Internal	IM Product	Archival site linked through Humanitarian Action for the Global Humanitarian Overview.		GHO 2022	Coordination Division

External	IM Platform	Provides a list of UNDAC Refresher Course Selected Reference Library.		UNDAC Resource Center	Coordination Division
External	IM Platform	Hosts JIAF materials such as manuals and communications.		JIAF	Coordination Division
External	IM Product	Supports the work of RCs and HCs in their humanitarian leadership functions.		RC/HC Handbook	Operations and Advocacy
External	IM Tool	Shares documentation around the Humanitarian Programme Cycle and related tools.		Humanitarian Programme Cycle: KMP	Coordination Division
External	IM Platform	Web platform for implementing the JIAF needs analysis. Usage limited to OCHA and cluster focal points.		JIAF Analysis	Coordination

8.2 Quantitative Survey Results

241. **Overview:** The survey targeted global stakeholders utilizing OCHA's IM tools, platforms, and services. Respondents included representatives from OCHA, UN system organizations, international NGOs (INGOs), and other entities. Data collected ranged from user demographics and organizational roles to feedback on specific IM products and tools. As of November 21, 2024, there were 118 answers to the survey.

242. Demographics and Representation:

Most respondents (93% of respondents) work in **country offices** (15 countries in total), reflecting a significant focus on operational levels.

A majority identified their roles as related to **Information Management** (57.26%) and **Analysis** (19.66%) or managerial functions.

The sample was predominantly male (58.97%), with 35.90% female respondents.

243. Usage of IM Products and Tools:

Commonly used tools and platforms include **Relief Web**, **FTS**, **HDX**, and **HNO dashboards**.

The **Access Dashboards** and **Humanitarian Needs Overview (HNO)** were highlighted as frequently utilized analytical offerings.

Usage frequency varied, with responses ranging from **weekly** to **monthly**, depending on the product.

244. Effectiveness and Utility:

Responses on usefulness of products like SitReps, HNO, and dashboards were mixed:

Some respondents found them "Somewhat Useful."

A few rated them as "Not Very Useful," citing limited analytical depth or relevance to their needs.

Data completeness was often rated as "Somewhat Comprehensive," indicating room for improvement in coverage.

Timeliness received similar feedback, with delays in updates cited as a recurrent issue.

245. Strengths:

Tools like **FTS** and **Relief Web** were praised for visibility and accessibility.

The **data sets and visualizations** provided through dashboards and reference maps were noted as helpful for planning and coordination.

OCHA's leadership in providing common operational datasets was acknowledged positively.

246. Gaps and Challenges:

Significant Data Gaps: Incomplete access data, project-level expenditure linkage, and gaps in sub-district-level granular data.

Timeliness Issues: Delays in updates for critical tools like HNO dashboards and population datasets.

Limited Advanced Analytics: Respondents noted that dashboards and other outputs often focus on data compilation rather than actionable analysis.

Integration of Multiple Sources: Fair or poor ratings indicate challenges in integrating cross-sectoral data into coherent products.

Strategic Support and Coordination: Mixed responses: "Good" ratings for coherent humanitarian responses, but lower satisfaction for IDP solutions and strategic risk analysis.

247. Coordination:

Several noted that while tools facilitate collaboration, better integration and standardization are needed to support multi-actor environments.

248. Most common recommendations:

Enhance Timeliness and Coverage: Regular updates and expanded data sets to cover under-represented areas (e.g., sub-district levels).

Advanced Analytics: Move beyond data aggregation to include predictive and thematic analysis.

Improved Training and Support: Capacity-building initiatives to ensure users can fully leverage available tools.

Increased Integration: Develop more interconnected tools to streamline user workflows and decision-making processes.

Table 24: Global Survey - Most Frequent Responses

Question	Most Frequent Response
Organization	UN Agency (63%)
Gender	Male (59%)
Role	IM and Analysis (57%)
Location	Country Office (93%)
Country Location	Cameroon (13%)
Frequency of Use	Monthly (47%)
Usefulness	Very Useful (46%)
Completeness	Somewhat Comprehensive (53%)
Timeliness	Somewhat Timely (51%)
Data Gaps	No (56%)
Quality of Data Comprehensiveness	Good (59%)
Data Integration from Multiple Sources	Good (45%)
Responsiveness	Good (45%)
Supports Decision-Making	Good (36%)
Supports Coherent Humanitarian Response	Good (54%)
Supports Leadership on Access	Good (36%)
Supports Durable Solutions for IDPs	Good (35%)
Supports Catalytic Humanitarian Financing	Good (41%)
Supports Strategic Analysis	Good (42%)
Rating of Quality	3 out of 5 (52%)
Effectiveness of IM	Somewhat effective (54%)

Source: OCHA IM Review Global Survey

Annex 9. Findings to Recommendations Linkages

Table 25: List of Findings, Conclusions and Recommendation

Findings
Finding Overall: The resourcing structure, enabling function of IM and Analysis, and the absence of an IM and Analysis strategy combine to influence the observed findings in all four review questions.
Finding 1. Respondents prioritized OCHA's role in the continuation and improvement of the data quality for basic descriptive analysis while also desiring more higher level analysis support.
Finding 2. Respondents prioritized OCHA's support to needs assessment planning and implementation rather than outcome level monitoring or gathering insights from affect populations.
Finding 3. OCHA should take leadership on six types of data and aggregation for analysis.
Finding 4. In the absence of a strategy for OCHA external coordination, there is less consensus regarding OCHA's relationship with cluster-specific analysis.
Finding 5. Respondent expectations of the ideal state of analytical questions from OCHA focus primarily on the qualities of analysis rather than specific analytical questions.
Finding 6. In the absence of a common analytical framework, resource constraints, and diverse data needs from stakeholders creates a set of five pairs of competing pressures that country offices must navigate individually affecting the quality of analytical services.
Finding 7. Respondents could not articulate a clear conceptual linkage between the analysis questions to be answered and the information embedded in platforms, tools or products
Finding 8. There is evidence of duplications and overlap among existing known platforms within OCHA.
Finding 9. Positive examples of supporting analytical services through tools, processes or platforms supporting analysis exist.
Finding 10. Respondents cited examples of individual initiatives to reduce the proliferation of platforms, products, tools and services.
Finding 11. In the absence of a collective recognized data strategy for OCHA IM and Analysis, the decentralized tool development process and resourcing architecture creates a set of four competing pressures that country offices must navigate individually, leading to the proliferation of tools, and platforms.
Finding 12. Interoperability could reduce the consequences of the proliferation and fragmentation of tools and platforms.
Finding 13. Respondents expect OCHA to take leadership in five dimensions: strategic direction, supporting coordination, supporting rapid deployment, supporting IM capacity building, and overseeing data quality and management.
Finding 14. Respondents distinguish between OCHA's leadership and coordination roles with the former related to data analytics and the latter to analysis and decision making.
Finding 15. In the absence of an external coordination strategy within a humanitarian IM and analysis strategy, individual responses are susceptible to leadership or agency conditions, creating four sets of competing pressures that require individual navigation.
Finding 16: Positive examples of OCHA leadership and Coordination for IM and Analysis are dependent on individual actions in specific responses.
Finding 17. Respondents identified three key areas of focus to enable OCHA to meet the expectations of the humanitarian community.
Finding 18: The evolution of processes and technologies has created increasing and more sophisticated demands on OCHA staff.
Finding 19: The decentralized structure of IM and Analysis within OCHA and the resourcing allocation processes impede the rationalization of strategic planning for IM and Analysis and creating perverse incentives impeding collective action.
Conclusions

Conclusion 1: Challenges for IM and Analysis are persistent across time within OCHA suggesting systemic issues.
Conclusion 2: Fragmentation and proliferation are the natural results of the current OCHA IM and Analysis structure.
Conclusion 3: The lack of an IM and Analysis strategy or framework leads to a diversity of stakeholder expectations for IM and Analysis both within and external to OCHA.
Conclusion 4: There are frequent examples of ongoing individual initiatives to improve IM functioning.
Conclusion 5: The OCHA IM and Analysis functioning in any particular humanitarian response is highly sensitive and dependent on individual leadership, and agency conditions.
Conclusion 6: There is a need to distinguish OCHA's inter-agency obligations from expectations that OCHA should fill gaps left by agencies and clusters.
Recommendations
Recommendation 1: Establish an OCHA cross-branch governance mechanism for Information Management and Analysis (IM&A) under the authority of OCHA senior leadership at the ASG level. This governance mechanism would ensure strategic oversight, coherence, and accountability for IM&A activities across all levels of OCHA, aligning with the OCHA Strategic Plan and the UN Secretary General Data Strategy.
Recommendation 2: Develop an Organizational IM&A Strategy to guide OCHA's IM functions, aligned with the OCHA Strategic Plan and addressing both internal and external requirements. This strategy should ensure coherence, efficiency, and alignment of IM&A activities across all levels of the organization
Recommendation 3: Develop a multi-year IM&A Road Map as a practical implementation tool of the IM&A Strategy, outlining priority initiatives, their sequencing, and the required resources across OCHA at global, regional, and country levels. The road map should serve as a practical implementation tool to address systemic challenges and strengthen OCHA's IM function.
Recommendation 4: Reduce Fragmentation. Continue to further streamline OCHA's data platforms, tools, products and services to reduce fragmentation, enhance efficiency and ensure sustainability.
Recommendation 5: Develop a Unified OCHA IM&A Resourcing Strategy to mitigate resource fragmentation and ensure sustainable, strategic financing for IM functions. This strategy should align PSC and special project initiatives, promoting coherence and addressing systemic gaps.
Recommendation 6: Strengthen inter-agency coordination processes, structures, and agreements for IM&A to ensure coordinated, efficient, and complementary action among stakeholders.
Recommendation 7: Develop an IM&A Strategy for the Humanitarian Community's IM&A Ecosystem to ensure coordinated, efficient, and complementary action among stakeholders. The strategy should identify and address gaps, establish shared priorities and promote effective collaboration.
Recommendation 8: Engage Multi-Disciplinary Analysis Teams at country and regional levels to strengthen humanitarian response by combining operational insights from multiple actors within and external to OCHA including specialist NGOs and UN agencies. These teams will ensure contextually relevant and methodologically sound analyses that align with OCHA's analytical framework.

Table 26: Linkages from Recommendations to Conclusions to Findings

Recommendations	Conclusions
Recommendation 1: Cross-branch governance structure	Conclusion 2: Fragmentation and proliferation are the natural results of the current OCHA IM and Analysis structure.
Recommendation 2: IM&A Strategy	Conclusion 3: The lack of an IM and Analysis strategy or framework
Recommendation 3: IM&A Road Map	Conclusion 1: Persistence across time
	Conclusion 2: Fragmentation and proliferation are the natural results of the current OCHA IM and Analysis structure.

	Conclusion 4: There are frequent examples of ongoing individual initiatives to improve IM functioning
Recommendation 4: Technology Governance Board (TGB)	Conclusion 4: There are frequent examples of ongoing individual initiatives to improve IM functioning
	Conclusion 5: highly dependent on individual leadership, and agency conditions.
Recommendation 5: Resourcing Strategy.	Conclusion 1: Persistence across time
	Conclusion 2: Fragmentation and proliferation are the natural results of the current OCHA IM and Analysis structure.
Recommendation 6: Inter-agency coordination	Conclusion 3: The lack of an IM and Analysis strategy or framework
	Conclusion 5: highly dependent on individual leadership, and agency conditions.
	Conclusion 6: distinguish OCHA's inter-agency obligations from filling gaps
Recommendation 7: IM&A vision for humanitarian community.	Conclusion 1: Persistence across time
	Conclusion 5: highly dependent on individual leadership, and agency conditions.
	Conclusion 6: distinguish OCHA's inter-agency obligations from filling gaps
Recommendation 8: Multi-Disciplinary Analysis Teams	Conclusion 4: There are frequent examples of ongoing individual initiatives to improve IM functioning.
	Conclusion 5: highly dependent on individual leadership, and agency conditions.
Conclusions	Findings
Conclusion 1: Persistence across time	Finding General: The resourcing structure, enabling function of IM and Analysis, and the absence of an IM and Analysis strategy combine to influence the observed findings in all four review questions.
	Finding 4. In the absence of a strategy for OCHA external coordination, there is less consensus regarding OCHA's relationship with cluster-specific analysis.
	Finding 11. In the absence of a collective recognized data strategy for OCHA IM and Analysis, the decentralized tool development process and resourcing architecture creates a set of four competing pressures that country offices must navigate individually, leading to the proliferation of tools, and platforms.
	Finding 15. In the absence of an external coordination strategy within a humanitarian IM and analysis strategy, individual responses are susceptible to leadership or agency conditions, creating four sets of competing pressures that require individual navigation.
	Finding 18: The evolution of processes and technologies has created increasing and more sophisticated demands on OCHA staff.
	Finding 19: The decentralized structure of IM and Analysis within OCHA and the resourcing allocation processes impede the rationalization of strategic planning for IM and Analysis and creating perverse incentives impeding collective action.
Conclusion 2: Fragmentation and proliferation are the natural results of the current OCHA IM and Analysis structure.	Finding General: The resourcing structure, enabling function of IM and Analysis, and the absence of an IM and Analysis strategy combine to influence the observed findings in all four review questions.
	Finding 19: The decentralized structure of IM and Analysis within OCHA and the resourcing allocation processes impede the rationalization of strategic planning for IM and Analysis and creating perverse incentives impeding collective action
	Finding 18: The evolution of processes and technologies has created increasing and more sophisticated demands on OCHA staff.
	Finding 8. There is evidence of duplications and overlap among existing known platforms within OCHA.

Conclusion 3: The lack of an IM and Analysis strategy or framework	Finding General: The resourcing structure, enabling function of IM and Analysis, and the absence of an IM and Analysis strategy combine to influence the observed findings in all four review questions.
	Finding 2. Respondents prioritized OCHA's support to needs assessment planning and implementation rather than outcome level monitoring or gathering insights from affect populations.
	Finding 4. In the absence of a strategy for OCHA external coordination, there is less consensus regarding OCHA's relationship with cluster-specific analysis.
	Finding 5. Respondent expectations of the ideal state of analytical questions from OCHA focus primarily on the qualities of analysis rather than specific analytical questions.
	Finding 7. Respondents could not articulate a clear conceptual linkage between the analysis questions to be answered and the information embedded in platforms, tools or products
	Finding 11. In the absence of a collective recognized data strategy for OCHA IM and Analysis, the decentralized tool development process and resourcing architecture creates a set of four competing pressures that country offices must navigate individually, leading to the proliferation of tools, and platforms.
	Finding 15. In the absence of an external coordination strategy within a humanitarian IM and analysis strategy, individual responses are susceptible to leadership or agency conditions, creating four sets of competing pressures that require individual navigation.
Conclusion 4: There are frequent examples of ongoing individual initiatives to improve IM functioning.	Finding 9. Positive examples of supporting analytical services through tools, processes or platforms supporting analysis exist.
	Finding 10. Respondents cited examples of individual initiatives to reduce the proliferation of platforms, products, tools and services
	Finding 12. Interoperability could reduce the consequences of the proliferation and fragmentation of tools and platforms.
	Finding 16: Positive examples of OCHA leadership and Coordination for IM and Analysis are dependent on individual actions in specific responses.
	Finding 17. Respondents identified three key areas of focus to enable OCHA to meet the expectations of the humanitarian community.
	Finding 1. Respondents prioritized OCHA's role in the continuation and improvement of the data quality for basic descriptive analysis while also desiring more higher level analysis support.
	Finding 3. OCHA should take leadership on six types of data and aggregation for analysis.
Conclusion 5: highly dependent on individual leadership, and agency conditions.	Finding 4. In the absence of a strategy for OCHA external coordination, there is less consensus regarding OCHA's relationship with cluster-specific analysis.
	Finding 6. In the absence of a common analytical framework, resource constraints, and diverse data needs from stakeholders creates a set of five pairs of competing pressures that country offices must navigate individually affecting the quality of analytical services.
	Finding 7. Respondents could not articulate a clear conceptual linkage between the analysis questions to be answered and the information embedded in platforms, tools or products
	Finding 11. In the absence of a collective recognized data strategy for OCHA IM and Analysis, the decentralized tool development process and resourcing architecture creates a set of four competing pressures that country offices must navigate individually, leading to the proliferation of tools, and platforms.
	Finding 15. In the absence of an external coordination strategy within a humanitarian IM and analysis strategy, individual responses are susceptible to leadership or agency conditions, creating four sets of competing pressures that require individual navigation.
Conclusion 6: distinguish OCHA's	Finding 6. In the absence of a common analytical framework, resource constraints, and diverse data needs from stakeholders creates a set of five pairs of competing pressures that country offices must navigate individually affecting the quality of analytical services.

inter-agency obligations from filling gaps	Finding 4. In the absence of a strategy for OCHA external coordination, there is less consensus regarding OCHA's relationship with cluster-specific analysis.
	Finding 7. Respondents could not articulate a clear conceptual linkage between the analysis questions to be answered and the information embedded in platforms, tools or products
	Finding 15. In the absence of an external coordination strategy within a humanitarian IM and analysis strategy, individual responses are susceptible to leadership or agency conditions, creating four sets of competing pressures that require individual navigation.
	Finding 18: The evolution of processes and technologies has created increasing and more sophisticated demands on OCHA staff.

Table 27: Detailed Recommendation Actions

#	Recommendation		
1	Priority: High Internal/External: Internal	Thematic Focus: Governance	Timeframe: Immediate Responsibility: Lead: ASG office Support: IMB, APMB.
	Establish an OCHA cross-branch governance mechanism for Information Management and Analysis (IM&A) under the authority of OCHA senior leadership at the ASG level. This governance mechanism would ensure strategic oversight, coherence, and accountability for IM&A activities across all levels of OCHA, aligning with the OCHA Strategic Plan and the UN Secretary General Data Strategy. 1. Governance & Oversight: ● Mandate: Governance mechanism would oversee the design, implementation, and monitoring of a unified IM&A strategy (recommendation 2) and roadmap (recommendation 3), clarifying roles, responsibilities, and reporting lines across OCHA's branches, regional offices and country teams. ● Leadership & Management: Governance mechanism would operate under OCHA senior leadership at the ASG level, supported by a dedicated senior focal point and/or cross-branch steering team responsible for driving the governance work, and ensuring adherence to the IM&A strategy. ● Integration & Linkages: Formalize relation of the Technology Governance Board into the IM&A governance mechanism, and the relation of OCHA regional and country offices to ensure alignment and minimize redundancies. 2. Responsibilities: ● Strategic Coherence: Support the development and roll out of an OCHA global IM&A strategy, roadmap and resourcing strategy with clear benchmarks and guidelines, ensuring coherence and alignment across OCHA's diverse IM&A functions and levels. ● Cross-Branch Coordination: Serve as a forum and convene meetings to harmonize IM&A priorities and resolve systemic challenges such as resource fragmentation and siloed tool and platform development. 3. Accountability & Monitoring: ● Performance Measurement: Establish measurable Key Performance Indicators (KPIs) to track progress on stated workplan and to assess the effectiveness of the governance mechanism in enhancing IM&A coherence, reducing fragmentation, and improving decision-making support. ● Feedback: Create iterative feedback loops involving country and regional offices, and external stakeholders to refine IM&A priorities and practices continuously.		
2	Priority: High Internal/External: Internal	Thematic Focus: Strategy	Timeframe: Immediate Responsibility: Lead: ASG office Support: IMB, APMB.

Develop an Organizational IM&A Strategy to guide OCHA's IM functions, aligned with the OCHA Strategic Plan and addressing both internal and external requirements. This strategy should ensure coherence, efficiency, and alignment of IM&A activities across all levels of the organization. Core Components of the IM&A Strategy: Vision and Objectives: - Define OCHA's overarching vision for IM and Analysis, highlighting its role as an enabler for coordination, advocacy, and decision-making. - Clearly state the expected outcomes of a unified IM&A approach across OCHA. Roles and Responsibilities: <u>Internal:</u> - Define how OCHA's branches, sections, and levels work together to achieve unified IM&A outcomes. <u>External:</u> - Establish clear roles for IM&A functions externally at global, regional, and country levels, differentiating leadership, coordination, and support/service delivery roles. - Clarify OCHA's role in inter-agency coordination versus its role in addressing gaps when agencies cannot deliver. - Articulate OCHA's support/service delivery role in the broader humanitarian IM ecosystem, emphasizing partnerships and inter-agency collaboration (e.g., what data collection or analysis OCHA should perform and what can others perform). Analytical Framework: - Develop an OCHA analytical framework that defines a clear direction for analysis including roles and coordination with external humanitarian actors including specialist NGOs. - Define the menu of standard analytical needs at country, regional and global levels. - Map explicit linkages between data collection/aggregation efforts and the analytical needs they aim to address. - Align and standardize existing analytical frameworks to analytical needs to improve consistency and usability across humanitarian operations. Standardization & Contextualization: - Identify core areas that require global standardization (e.g., tools, methodologies, and data quality frameworks). - Specify areas that allow for local contextualization to meet country-specific needs data collection (e.g., surveys, drone mapping, chatbots) or analytical tools (e.g., GIS, dashboards). Resources & Capacity: - Identify IM&A resources and capacity needs for implementation. - Develop Unified Resourcing Strategy (see recommendation 5). Accountability & Monitoring: - Develop measurable KPIs to assess the strategy's implementation and performance against outcomes ensuring alignment with OCHA's strategic objectives in its Strategic Plan. - Include a protocol for regular strategy reviews and updates to adapt to emerging challenges and opportunities. This would conducting regular assessments to identify gaps in IM&A capacity, tools, and resources.			
3	Priority: High	Thematic Focus: Plan of Action	Timeframe: Immediate

	Internal/External: Internal		Responsibility: Lead: ASG office Support: IMB, APMB.
	Develop an IM&A Road Map as a practical implementation tool of the IM&A Strategy, outlining priority initiatives, their sequencing, and the required resources across OCHA at global, regional, and country levels. The road map should serve as a practical implementation tool to address systemic challenges and strengthen OCHA's IM function. Key Actions for IM&A Road Map: Prioritize & Sequence Initiatives: - Identify and sequence priority initiatives for IM&A improvements, to implement the IM&A Strategy. - Specify milestones and timeframes for implementation at all organizational levels. Standardize Partnerships with Specialized NGOs: - At a global level develop formal agreements and processes to integrate specialized NGO analytical capacities (e.g., iMMAP, REACH, ACAPS, etc.) into humanitarian responses at country, regional and global levels, ensuring efforts supplement wider IM&A work. Resource Investment & Efficiency: - Assess the resource implications of the IM&A strategy, identifying areas requiring additional or restructured investment to support a cohesive and strategic IM&A function. - Streamline the development and maintenance of tools, platforms, and products to enhance efficiency, predictability, and quality, reducing duplication and fragmentation, e.g., potentially through implementing a centralized service provider model to support business owners. Standardize IMO Responsibilities, Competencies & Staffing: - Review and clarify the responsibilities and core competencies of Information Management Officers (IMOs) at all levels, updating existing IM profiles and operational guidance to reflect evolving needs. - Develop scalable standards for IMO staffing in country offices aligned with varying operational contexts and resource availability. Systematize Capacity Building: - Create a capacity-building framework for IMOs, including standardized training modules and professional development opportunities. - Establish predictable mechanisms for deploying surge IMOs during emergencies to fill critical gaps and support rapid response needs. Accountability & Monitoring: - Develop mechanism to track progress on Road Map's milestones and priorities, incorporating feedback from global, regional, and country levels. Progress should be reported up to the IM&A Governance structure.		
4	Priority: High Internal/External: Internal	Thematic Focus: Reducing Fragmentation	Timeframe: Immediate Responsibility: Lead: IMB
	Reduce Fragmentation. Continue to further streamline OCHA's data platforms, tools, products and services to reduce fragmentation, enhance efficiency and ensure sustainability. Key Actions:		

	1. Universal Inventory and Categorization: - Establish a comprehensive, universal inventory of all platforms, tools, products and services used at global, regional, and country levels. - Develop and apply standardized taxonomy and definitions to for example identify purpose and detect duplication, gaps across OCHA. 2. Business-Case Review and Optimization: - Leverage the Technology Governance Board (TGB) to streamline OCHA's data platforms, tools, products, and services through robust review, standardization, and alignment with organizational priorities. This initiative should aim to reduce fragmentation, enhance efficiency, and ensure sustainability. - Update business cases for retained tools, incorporating operational feedback and technological advancements. - Identify platforms or tools for decommissioning based on duplication or redundancy, or obsolescence, and establish a clear phase-out process. 3. Protocol Development for Decentralized Tool Creation: - Develop and enforce protocols to ensure coherency of the decentralized tool development process and their sustainability ensuring alignment with global standards and strategic priorities. - Include an expanded review and approval process for new tools and products to minimize fragmentation and redundancy. 4. Sustainability through Predictable Resources: - Ensure identified <i>Core Tools and Platforms</i> are funded and maintained through predictable and sustainable mechanisms, such as Programme Support Costs (PSC). - Provide dedicated centralized technical support and periodic updates to keep tools relevant and functional. 5. Accountability & Monitoring: - Assign accountability to the TGB for overseeing the inventory, reviews, and protocol implementation. - Define success metrics to evaluate the impact of these actions, such as reduction in tool proliferation or improved user satisfaction. - Establish regular progress reviews and feedback loops with country and regional offices to ensure alignment and address emerging needs.		
5	Priority: Medium Internal/External: Internal	Thematic Focus: Improving Resource Efficiencies	Timeframe: Medium Responsibility: Lead: ASG office Support: IMB, APMB.
	Develop a Unified OCHA IM&A Resourcing Strategy to mitigate resource fragmentation and ensure sustainable, strategic financing for IM functions. This strategy should align PSC and special project initiatives, promoting coherence and addressing systemic gaps. Key Actions: 1. Unified Resourcing Framework: - Develop a unified IM resourcing framework that integrates funding streams, prioritizes strategic initiatives, and aligns with OCHA's IM&A Strategy.		

	- Identify and address funding gaps in IM&A at global, regional, and country levels, ensuring equitable resource distribution. 2. Strategic Alignment of PSC & Special Projects: - Establish clear guidelines on how PSC funding and special project initiatives can be linked to support IM priorities to ensure predictability and sustainability, reducing reliance on ad hoc or fragmented financing models. - Ensure that PSC funds are allocated to sustain core IM tools, platforms, and products critical to OCHA's operations and strategy. 3. Enhanced Planning & Predictability: - Create mechanisms to forecast IM resource needs and ensure predictability in funding allocations, particularly for core IM functions. 4. Stakeholder Engagement: - Engage donors and internal stakeholders to align funding priorities with the resourcing strategy. 5. Accountability & Monitoring: - The IM&A Governance Structure including the Technology Governance Board should oversee the strategy's implementation. - Develop KPIs to track progress, such as reductions in funding gaps, improved predictability of IM&A financing, and alignment of PSC allocations with strategic priorities. - Conduct periodic reviews to assess the strategy's impact and adapt it to emerging needs.		
6	Priority: Medium Internal/External: External	Thematic Focus: Governance & Coordination	Timeframe: Medium Term Responsibility: Lead: IMB
	Strengthen inter-agency coordination processes, structures, and agreements for IM&A to ensure coordinated, efficient, and complementary action among stakeholders. 1. IMWG: - Transform global Information Management Working Group (IMWG) and its sub-groups into strategic coordination bodies, focusing on joint planning, priority setting, and decision-making, positioning the working group to serve as the centralized coordinating body for humanitarian information management. : - Create and make publicly available a ToR for working group, establishing chairperson(s), scope of work, membership/participation, linkages with other sub-working groups and other working groups/committees/task forces, etc. - Establish or reinforce forums for dialogue and collaboration across global, regional, and country levels to ensure alignment and avoid duplication. - Establish measurable KPIs to publicly report effectiveness of the IMWG, in alignment with how other clusters/working groups measure and report on their performance. - Create iterative feedback loops to refine IM&A priorities and practices continuously. 2. Update Terms of References: - Revise ToRs for country level Humanitarian Country Teams (HCT) and Inter-Cluster Coordination Groups (ICCG) to explicitly include roles, responsibilities, and deliverables related to IM and Analysis functions and linkages to IMWG. - Develop standard but customizable ToRs for country level IMWGs and Assessment and Analysis Working Groups (A&AWGs) that includes, when they are activated, their inclusive membership, responsibilities, and linkages to each other and the ICCG and HCT.		

	- Specify commitments for IASC member agencies to support Information Management Officers (IMOs) and activities of the IMWG and AAWG at global, regional, and country levels. 3. Support & Resource Allocation for IM Functions: - Ensure IASC member commitments include predictable resources and capacity-building support for IMOs to sustain their roles in the cluster system. - Promote mechanisms to deploy surge IMOs and technical support during emergencies to fill gaps in cluster systems. - Reinforce IMWG and AAWG functions by formalizing their integration into cluster decision-making processes. 4. Implementation and Monitoring: - Assign responsibility for implementing and monitoring to a designated body, such as the IMWG or an oversight entity within the IASC. - Establish mechanisms to monitor compliance and measure improvements in resource allocation, and effectiveness of IM and Analysis components in cluster systems.		
7	Priority: Medium Internal/External: External	Thematic Focus: Strategy	Timeframe: Medium Term Responsibility: Lead: IMB
Develop an IM&A Strategy for the Humanitarian Community's IM&A Ecosystem to ensure coordinated, efficient, and complementary action among stakeholders. The strategy should identify and address gaps, establish shared priorities and promote effective collaboration. Key Components of the Strategy: 1. Strategic Vision & Objectives: - Define a shared vision for the humanitarian IM and Analysis ecosystem, aligning with global frameworks such as the UN Secretary General Data Strategy. - Articulate key outcomes and priorities, including data sharing, interoperability, and inter-agency analytical services. 2. Agreements & Complementarities: - Facilitate agreements among stakeholders to delineate roles, responsibilities, and areas of complementarity, minimizing overlap and improving efficiency. - Address systemic issues such as resource gaps, surge capacity, and integration of specialized NGO analytical capacities into the broader ecosystem. 3. Implementation Road Map - Sequence priority initiatives for IM&A improvements, to implement the IM&A Strategy for the Humanitarian Community. - Specify milestones and timeframes for work components of the IMWG. 4. Resourcing - Develop advocacy and resource mobilization plan to highlight planned IM&A initiatives and funding gaps, encouraging pooled funding for IM initiatives. 5. Sustainability and Implementation: - Embed the strategy into broader humanitarian coordination frameworks to ensure its relevance and long-term sustainability. - Include mechanisms for monitoring progress and adapting the strategy based on feedback and evolving needs.			

8	Priority: Medium Internal/External: Internal	Thematic Focus: Relevant Analysis	Timeframe: Medium Term Responsibility: Lead: IMB.
Engage Multi-Disciplinary Analysis Teams at country and regional levels to strengthen humanitarian response by combining operational insights from multiple actors within and external to OCHA including specialist NGOs and UN agencies. These teams will ensure contextually relevant and methodologically sound analyses that align with OCHA's analytical framework. Key Components: 1. Formation & Composition: • Create internal analysis Units at country and regional levels, integrating HAOs and IMOs as core members. • For external analysis, include additional and diverse expertise from specialized NGOs with strong analytical capacities (e.g., iMMAP, MapAction, REACH, ACAPS, NORCAP secondees) as needed to address specific analytical demands. 2. Leveraging Expertise: • Ensure HAOs contribute deep contextual knowledge of humanitarian operations, including access, needs, and local dynamics. • Engage IMOs for technical expertise in data collection, management, and analysis to ensure methodological rigor and data quality. • Actively collaborate with the UN Resident Coordinator's Office (RCO) to leverage specialized analytical expertise in peace and development sectors. 3. Standardized Workflows & Tools: • Equip teams with standardized workflows, templates, and analytical tools to streamline their outputs and align with OCHA's core objectives. • Develop protocols for conducting cross-sectoral and inter-agency analyses, ensuring consistency and comparability across responses. 4. Integration with Coordination Mechanisms: • Align the work of these teams with existing coordination structures i.e., IMWG/A&AWG, ICCG, and HCT to ensure their outputs inform decision-making processes. 5. Capacity Building and Sustainability: • Provide targeted training to HAOs and IMOs to enhance their analytical skills and familiarize them with standardized tools and methodologies. • Align training and resource allocation for analysis teams with broader IM capacity-building efforts (recommendation 3). 6. Implementation and Monitoring: • Pilot the approach in select country and regional offices to refine workflows, team composition, and operational protocols. • Develop metrics to evaluate the Unit's impact on decision-making, analytical quality, and inter-agency coordination.			

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³¹ Not all listed documents have public links.

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Annex 11.

Acronyms

AAWG	Assessment and Analysis Working Group
API	application programming interface
APMB	Assessment, Planning and Monitoring Branch
ASG	Assistant Secretary General
BCP	Business Continuity Plans
BHA	Bureau of Humanitarian Affairs
CBFP	Country-Based Pooled Funds
CD	Coordination Division
CERF	Central Emergency Response Fund
CFM	Complaints and Feedback Mechanism
CHD	Centre for Humanitarian Data
CHD	Centre for Humanitarian Data
CO	country office
CRAF'd	Complex Risk Analytics Fund
DCO	Development Coordination Office
DSS	Digital Services Section
ERC	Emergency Relief Coordinator
FAO	Food and Agriculture Organization
FIS	Field Information Services
FTS	Financial Tracking Service
GBV	gender-based violence
GEWE	Gender Equality and Women's Empowerment
GHO	Global Humanitarian Overview
GMS	Grant Management System
HAO	Humanitarian Affairs Offices
HC	Humanitarian Coordinator
HCT	Humanitarian Country Team
HIC	Humanitarian Information Centers
HNO	Humanitarian Needs Overview
HNRP	Humanitarian Needs and Response Plan
HOO	OCHA Head of Office
HPC	Humanitarian Programme Cycle
HQ	headquarters
HRP	Humanitarian Response Plan
IAHE	Inter-Agency Humanitarian Evaluations
IASC	Inter-Agency Steering Committee
ICCG	Inter-Cluster Coordination Group
ICVA	International Council of Voluntary Agencies
IDP	internally displaced person
IFRC	International Federation of Red Cross and Red Crescent Societies
IM	Information Management
IMB	Information Management Branch
IMO	Information Management Officers
IMU	Information management Units
IMWG	Information Management Working Group
IOM	International Organization for Migration
IR	Inception Report
ISS	Information Services Section
JIAF	Joint and Intersectoral Analysis Framework
KIs	Key Informants Interviews
KIs	Key Informants

NA	not applicable
NGO	Non-Governmental Organizations
NY	New York
OAD	Operations and Advocacy Division
OCHA	Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs
ODSG	OCHA Donor Support Group
OIOS	Office of Internal Oversight Services
PiN	People in Need
PPT	PowerPoint
PSC	programme support costs
QA	Quality Assurance
RC	Resident Coordinator
RM	Review Manager
RO	Regional Office
RT	Review Team
SC	Steering Committee
TL	Team Leader
ToR	Terms of Reference
UN	United Nations
UNCT	United Nations Country Team
UNDSS	United Nations Department for Safety and Security
UNEG	United Nations Evaluation Group
UNGA	United Nations General Assembly
WG	Working Group